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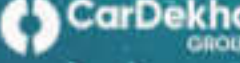


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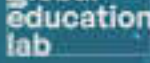
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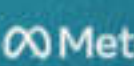
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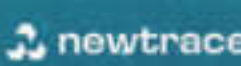
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Yemeni govt forces drive out Houthis from Bab el-Mandeb

Reuters
October 5

SAUDI-BACKED Yemeni government forces staged a lightning advance on Monday to retake the coast around the Bab el-Mandeb Strait up to the city of Mocha, the government said, pushing the Iran-backed Houthis out of most of the areas they seized last month.



Houthis seek to control the vital Bab el-Mandeb Strait

The forces of the internationally recognised government, backed by heavy Saudi air strikes, reached the outskirts of Mocha late on Monday and Houthi fighters were retreating into the highlands, four government sources said. The Defence Ministry said the city had fallen.

The government forces had already taken key positions including an airstrip in the Dhubab district at the mouth of the strait, a vital oil route whose seizure by the Houthis last month sent shockwaves through energy markets.

Reuters could not independently verify the extent of the government gains. The Houthis, who have controlled many of Yemen's more populous areas including the capital Sanaa since 2014, said the Saudi-backed government's claims were baseless.

While recapturing the coastal area around the strait would make it harder for the Houthis



Students raise slogans outside the Lycee Turgot high school in Paris on Monday. REUTERS

Hundreds of French schools stay closed ahead of nationwide day of student protests

Dominique Vidalon
Paris, October 5

HUNDREDS OF French high schools will begin a second week of closures on Monday as protests over dilapidated schools and classrooms, overcrowding and teacher shortages precede a nationwide day of demonstrations on Tuesday.

The nationwide demonstrations and blockades underline a fraught social atmosphere as France's government embarks on trying to pass a deficit-narrowing 2027 budget. France's 10-year bond yield briefly topped 5% last week, its highest since 2002, as the protests compounded investor concerns over the country's fiscal outlook.

About 400 to 500 high schools are expected to remain completely or partially closed on Monday in France, out of a total of 3,700, Education Minister Edouard Giffeyray said on Sunday evening.

The protests began in late September at a high school in a Paris suburb over teacher short-

ages before spreading nationwide.

“Our priority is to restore order,” government spokeswoman Maud Bregeon told CNews television on Monday.

Geffray said that 24 schools had been burned or ransacked and that 78 teaching staff had been injured since the beginning of the demonstrations.

On Monday, BFMTV showed images of police and students clashing in Lille in northern France, tear gas being used in Toulouse in the southwest and of a fire being lit as people tried to break into a school in central Paris.

Carole Zerbib, head of the vandalised Lycee Vauquelin in the 13th district of Paris, said her school had been attacked by a “very determined” group wearing hoods and masks who tried to break through the school's entrance door and then lit a fire. Police and firefighters quickly put out the fire and the school was evacuated and classes were suspended.

REUTERS

DECISION COMES ONE WEEK AFTER SUSPECTED TERROR PLOT AT FAIRFORD BASE

US bombers moved from UK to ‘protect our guys’: Vance

Kate Holton
& Jonathan Landay
London, Washington, Oct 5

US VICE President JD Vance said on Monday that the decision to move B-1 bombers from a British airbase was done out of an abundance of caution after a suspected Iranian plot at the site last week.

The planes had been stationed at RAF Fairford, the preferred European base for US bombers, and had recently been used in US strikes on Iran. Last week, five British men were arrested near the base - which Iran's Revolutionary Guards previously said was a legitimate target — on suspicion of preparing terrorist acts.

“So, what you saw there is the Secretary of War, out of an abundance of caution, trying to protect our guys,” Vance said as he left Washington for a trip to Alaska. “We do feel with some confidence that the Iranians are, you know, they're trying to do what the Iranian state has done for 49 years, which is engaged in acts of terrorism against the



A B-1 bomber takes off from RAF Fairford airbase on Sunday. REUTERS

United States (and others), so we are being extremely cautious, and that's all I'd say about that.”

Earlier, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said there was no direct link between the sudden removal of the bombers and the suspected Iranian plot. He said the Pentagon is “constantly reallocating resources where they need to be.”

A NATO military source had said on Monday: “It is still believed that Iran poses an acute

threat to US assets in the UK”.

While much about the incident remains unexplained, British PM Andy Burnham said any plot was likely backed by Iran.

Iran has said accusations that it was involved in any plot are baseless, and Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi wrote on X: “I can confirm Iran's belief that releasing supposed terrorists working for foreign states really says it all. You're barking up the wrong tree.”

Russia quarantines hospital after plague institute worker dies of ‘unknown’ cause

Associated Press
Moscow, October 5

RUSSIAN AUTHORITIES have quarantined a hospital and are monitoring contacts of an employee at a plague research institute in Siberia who contracted pneumonia of an “unknown” cause. Local state TV said the woman died last week.

Russian authorities said they found no evidence that her illness was caused by any of the pathogens she worked with. But the case has raised alarm in Russia after unconfirmed media reports suggested she might have died of pneumonic plague — a less common but severe form of plague that can spread from person to person.

The woman worked at the Irkutsk Anti-Plague Research Institute of Siberia and the Far East in Irkutsk, southeastern Siberia. A state TV station in Irkutsk reported Monday that she died last week in a hospital

US monitoring situation: Rubio

THE UNITED States is closely monitoring the case involving a laboratory worker who died at a plague research institute in Siberia, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Monday.

“We're watching and monitoring it closely,” Rubio told reporters before leaving for a trip to Europe. “I don't think it's cause for alarm, but it is cause for focus and a cause just to keep an eye on it.”

A laboratory worker at the Irkutsk Anti-Plague Research Institute of Siberia and the Far East fell ill and died in undisclosed

circumstances, prompting authorities to quarantine dozens of people, and the head of Russia's health watchdog to fly to the region. There were conflicting reports about how and where the laboratory worker, whose age was given as 28, had fallen ill, but the authorities said she had died of pneumonia.

Rubio, citing what Russians have released about the death, said it seemed there was a worker in the lab who was infected and there was concern the disease may have spread internally. REUTERS

in Shelekhov, a town just outside Irkutsk.

The hospital has been placed under quarantine, Mayor Maxim Modin said Friday, no longer admitting or discharging patients, and its laboratory halted carrying out routine tests.

Nigeria military chopper crashes with 32 aboard

Reuters
Brasilia, Sao Paulo, Rio De Janeiro, October 4

RIGHT-WING BRAZILIAN Senator Flavio Bolsonaro will face leftist President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva in a runoff of the presidential election later this month, after he exceeded expectations in Sunday's first-round vote with a slight lead over the incumbent.

The minister, Festus Keyamo, said in a statement that controllers lost contact with the aircraft at 0813 GMT and were unable to re-establish communication before its disappearance was reported. The wreckage was later located near a naval base in the coastal town of Igbokoda, and search and rescue operations were underway, he said. REUTERS



Flavio Bolsonaro

ald Trump.

Bolsonaro's stronger-than-expected performance, at 47% of votes versus Lula's 45%, is expected to buoy his campaign and may bolster Brazil's currency and stock market, which have risen on the prospects of

came into contact with the woman is under medical supervision. He didn't identify the infection and called it a suspected case of “a particularly dangerous infection.” Rospotrebnadzor was implementing “a full range of anti-epidemic measures,” he added.

Rospotrebnadzor said Sunday the woman was diagnosed with “pneumonia of unknown etiology,” and said “extensive” testing found “no microorganisms associated with the patient's professional activities.”

Independent local news outlet *Lyudi Baikala* quoted sources it did not identify as saying the woman died from pneumonic plague and that several Irkutsk hospitals were placed under quarantine.

Asked Monday to comment on the case, Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said the public and media should follow official statements from Rospotrebnadzor, rather than “rumors or speculation.”

Bolsonaro beats projections, will face Lula in Brazil runoff

the business-friendly challenger. Private surveys in the run-up to the election had forecast Lula leading the first-round vote by around 3 percentage points.

“Brazil wants change and I am very happy with the results,” Bolsonaro told reporters in Brasilia after nearly all tallies were reported, heralding “the end of the era of (Lula's) Workers' Party.”

The senator, son of right-wing former President Jair Bolsonaro, who is serving a 27-year sentence for plotting a coup after losing the 2022 election, now heads to an October 25 showdown with the leftist Lula.

• BRIEFLY

ITALY

Meloni seeks to trademark her voice to combat AI deepfakes



Italian Premier Giorgia Meloni. AP

condition of anonymity because they were not authorised to speak publicly. Meloni has warned that deepfakes can “deceive, manipulate and harm anyone,” urging users to verify online content before sharing it. REUTERS

CONGO

Boat collision on Congo River kills at least 30

TWO BOATS collided over the weekend on the Congo River, killing at least 30 people and leaving dozens missing, local Congolese authorities said Monday. The motorized wooden boats crashed into one another on Sunday near the Ngombe-Lukolela area in the province of Equateur, according to the provincial interior minister, Crispin Mputu. The reason for the crash was not clear. The minister said the 30 killed have already been buried. AP

IRAN

2 men executed over January 2026 protests

IRAN EXECUTED two men arrested over January protests in Isfahan in connection with the deaths of four police officers, the judiciary's *Mizan* news agency reported on Monday. It Alireza Sepahi and Alireza Raeisi were sentenced to death on charges including “membership in an armed rebel group, waging war against God through carrying weapons and creating fear and insecurity, corruption and incitement to war and killing.” REUTERS

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

NEPAL

Authorities wrap up Rasuwa flood search operation

NEPAL ON Monday concluded the search and rescue operation launched after the devastating August 26 flash floods, which claimed at least 1,455 lives, and is now shifting its focus to rehabilitation and reconstruction, officials said. The decision was taken at the 21st meeting of the National Council of the NDRRMA chaired by PM Balendra Shah at the Singha Durbar Secretariat here, the PMO said. The meeting directed concerned agencies to expedite rehabilitation and reconstruction. AP

PAKISTAN

Imran Khan's supporters start march to capital

THOUSANDS OF supporters of Pakistan's jailed former PM Imran Khan have started a long march to Islamabad to demand his release, his party said on Monday, amid deep divisions with the Pakistani leadership. The rally began on Sunday in north-western Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, which is ruled by Khan's Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf party, with stops planned at several places before reaching Islamabad. Khan, 74, a former cricket star, has described himself as a political prisoner. REUTERS

Trump corrects himself after referring to Brazil's election as India's polls

Press Trust of India
Washington, October 5

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump on Monday corrected an earlier post on social media in which he referred to Brazil's presidential election as India's to claim that the electoral process in the US was “corrupt”.

In a glaring factual error, Trump, in a post on Truth Social on Sunday, claimed that “125 million people voted in India's Presidential elections and the results came out shortly after the vote closed”.

Trump then used the faster

counting example to target Democratic-run cities and states such as Detroit, Philadelphia and California.

“In Detroit, Philadelphia, California, and numerous other US Cities and States, the results, with much smaller numbers, will often take weeks to Rig, I mean, calculate,” Trump said.

Later, he corrected himself to say that “25 Million People voted today in the first round of Brazil's Presidential Election. The results came out shortly after the vote closed, on the SAME DAY!” Brazil, not India, went to the polls on Sunday.

• FALLING ENROLMENT ACROSS GREECE THIS YEAR PROMPTS AUTHORITIES TO CLOSE 75 SCHOOLS AND EXTEND SUSPENSION OF CLASSES AT MORE THAN 400 OTHERS

On a remote Greek island, empty classrooms signal enrolment crisis across Europe

Lefteris Pitarakis
& Derek Gatopoulos

Kalamos (Greece), October 5

CHRYSSA NTALAKA'S classroom has become an object lesson in subtraction.

The sole teacher in the last school on the idyllic Greek island of Kalamos has a shorter list of students every fall. This year, just two. On September 23, the sixth graders sat at Ntalaka's table beneath the whiteboard, in front of rows of unused desks and benches.

When they head to middle school on Greece's mainland next year, her school will be mothballed. Toys and picture books still sit on shelves in the

nearby kindergarten since it was shuttered three years ago.

“Usually, teachers are placed on these islands against their wishes,” Ntalaka told The Associated Press. “Whereas for Kalamos there are teachers and kindergarten teachers, as far as I know, who want to come — but there are no children.”

Falling enrolment across Greece this year prompted authorities to close 75 schools and suspend or extend suspension of classes at more than 400 others.

It's a situation playing out across Europe and beyond. The region has 16 of the world's top 20 oldest nations, particularly in Southern Europe, according

to the independent World Population Review.

And its remote communities act as an early warning system: Mountain villages and small islands are among the first places where schools and services disappear in a deepening cycle of population decline. Some 17 million people live on more than 4,000 islands across the European Union; Greece has about 200 of them.

“Closing schools leads to young people not staying and to them leaving,” said Byron Kotzamanis, co-founder of the Institute of Demographic Research in Athens. “Leaving means fewer and fewer people — fewer and fewer births. It



A music teacher with two students of Kalamos Primary School

means depopulation and dead settlements that will become nursing homes.”

Kalamos' year-round popu-

lation is just 80. A decade ago, it had 40 children in local schools and public daycare.

“It was very nice. We played

together every day. We went to (primary) school every morning,” Antonis Aivaliotis, a high school senior, said during a ferry ride in the predawn light.

Aivaliotis is among Kalamos' seven teenagers who today make a choppy crossing to school on the mainland. They miss class on days when strong winds pose a risk.

He spent several years as a student of Ntalaka's class, which at the time was a single room with children of all ages.

Ntalaka has often been the lone teacher during her 20 years at remote schools. Half that time was in Kalamos, located not far from Odysseus' home island Ithaca in “The

Odyssey.”

She fell in love with Kalamos' “unspoiled beaches that are a magnet for yacht tourists. She learned to dive and became an accomplished spearfisher. But she will have to leave.

All it would take for her school to remain open would be the arrival of two families. She and town officials have desperately sought to spread the word, but there's no sign of any comers.

“We're very welcoming and we're trying. That's what we want to do, even right now — for someone to hear us,” Ntalaka said. “The sooner, the better.”

As for Aivaliotis, he sees

moving away after graduation as an inevitability.

“Of course I would like to stay here,” he said. “I love Kalamos. It is my home. But there's no development at all.”

In June, the EU announced it would develop a strategy for islands, aiming to address the problem of shrinking populations, among others.

Themis Christophidou, director-general for regional and urban policy at the European Commission, told AP in an email that the EU has spent 146 million euros (\$164 million) over the past five years to modernize schools on four Greek island clusters, specifically to counter demographic decline. AP



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GST process reforms pin hope on data, tech to ensure compliance

Siddharth Upasani & Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, October 5

THE GST Council's meeting on Thursday will take up the second half of the reform exercise that was kicked off with the Goods and Services Tax (GST) rate cuts announced in September 2025. Officials said the process reforms on the agenda will cement the indirect tax regime for the next half a decade or so and "systems built on technology and good quality data" can help ensure correct behaviour from businesses without "onerous compliance".

"GST rates were cleaned up last year. Now, the focus is on moving towards a stable tax system with predictability, as was the demand from the industry. It may take a year or two to stabilise and then the GST regime will only require minor tweaks for the next 5-6 years," an official said. "If the proposals are approved by the Council, then the framework will be set," the official added.

A key proposal in the process reforms that will be discussed in the Council meeting on October

8 is going to be the removal of the power to arrest by GST officers, as reported by *The Indian Express* on Sunday. This power, officials said, has led to the creation of unnecessary leverage over businesses even before the actual arrest stage is reached.

"Tax disputes will be resolved through civil consequences, namely recovery of the tax, interest for the delay, and penalty," the official said. However, prosecution will remain available, with the GST Council expected to discuss some tweaks. Additionally, the threshold for prosecution is likely to be increased from Rs 1 crore to Rs 5 crore.

The sentencing provisions are also proposed to be softened, with the minimum sentence likely to be removed altogether. This, officials said, means courts won't be bound to impose a term of imprisonment regardless of circumstances. Also, a fine will be available as an option in every case. Furthermore, it is proposed that no notice will be issued at all where the amount involved is below Rs 10,000. Crucially, this change is expected to apply to new cases as well as those pending, whether in adjudication or



The GST Council last met in September 2025. REUTERS

in the appeal phase.

"Such cases are about a fifth of all cases by number and a negligible part of the money. For a small business, a notice of this size costs more to answer in fees and time than the amount in dispute. Removing that category will be a real relief, and will free up officers for matters of substance," the official said.

The GST Council will deliberate on a wide variety of issues on October 8 that encompass all the tax dealings of an entity during its lifecycle—getting regis-

GST Council to now meet on Thursday

New Delhi: The 57th meeting of the GST Council has been rescheduled to Thursday from Wednesday, an office memorandum said, citing "unavoidable circumstances". This will be the Council's first meeting after it announced an overhaul of Goods and Services Tax rates in early September 2025. This week's meeting is expected to focus on process reforms. ENS

tered, filing returns and correcting them, claiming refunds, and answering demands.

"All four processes are proposed to be redesigned on a single principle, namely that the system should do what can be done from data and the officer should be left with what needs judgement," an official said.

One major process change is set to be for the export of services, which will help align GST laws with the practice on ground. Citing the example of a testing laboratory which receives a proto-

type from a foreign client, tests it, sends back the report, and is paid in foreign exchange, the official explained that the place of supply followed where the work was performed. "It will now follow the location of the customer, and such work therefore qualifies as an export. This opens the whole field of testing, certification, repair, calibration, research and analysis to export treatment, and India has substantial capacity in all of them."

Wednesday's meeting comes over 13 months after the last one in September 2025 which announced the major rate overhaul that saw the number of tax slabs being reduced to 5% and 18%, with a 40% rate for demerit goods. "There have been no meetings of the GST Council in the interim, but discussions have been ongoing to bring all stakeholders on the same page, and that takes time. What has helped is that there have not been any major concerns about revenues being adversely impacted by the rate rationalisation exercise of September 2025. This has made it easier to go ahead with the process reforms discussions at this week's GST Council meeting."

As RBI rate hike looms, a move beyond 25 bps seems a minor possibility

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 5

THE RESERVE Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) began its three-day meeting on Monday. And while most economists are predicting that a 25-basis-point increase in the policy repo rate to 5.5% will be announced on Wednesday, talk has emerged that a larger hike could be possible.

"It's not a debate that there will be a rate hike on Wednesday. But considering the MPC is now acting from behind the curve, it could even be a 50 bps increase," said a senior economist who did not wish to be named.

While the six-member MPC had unanimously left the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% on August 5 and offered rather sanguine commentary to go along with it, minutes of its meeting, released two weeks later, struck a different note. Governor Sanjay Malhotra, for instance, said while headline retail inflation had averaged only 2% in 2025-26 — when the repo rate was brought down to 5.25% — there were signs it was now normalising. This "may suggest a recalibration of policy rate."

Meanwhile, Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta noted "a case for a hike may emerge during the course of the year".

According to Soumya Kanti Ghosh, State Bank of India's Group Chief Economic Advisor, the RBI may "raise rates by 25 bps AT LEAST" (emphasis Ghosh's). Meanwhile, Madhavi Arora and Harshal Patel of Emkay Global Financial Services said that "a 50 bps hike cannot be ruled out as a potential policy catch-up".

The RBI last increased the repo rate way back in February 2023. As such, any rate hike on Wednesday will be the first in over three-and-a-half years.

The headline inflation rate, based on the Consumer Price

• NORMALISATION OF MONETARY POLICY

THE RBI last increased the repo rate way back in February 2023. As such, any rate hike on Wednesday will be the first in over three-and-a-half years

WHILE MOST economists are predicting that a 25-basis-point increase in the policy repo rate to 5.5% will be announced on Wednesday, talk has emerged that a larger hike could be possible

THE LAST time the repo rate was 5.25% or lower was in mid-2022,



when the RBI was in the midst of reversing the extraordinary measures taken to help the economy hit by the coronavirus pandemic

Index (CPI), rose to 4.82% in August, as per latest data. And while this is comfortably within the RBI's mandated range of 2-6%, it was the third month in a row that it had come in above the medium-term target of 4%. The RBI's most recent forecasts also show inflation rising to an average of 5.9% in the last three months of 2026, before cooling to 5.5% and 5.3% in the first two quarters of 2027.

Long rate hike cycle?

To be sure, the market overwhelmingly expects the repo rate to be raised by only 25 bps on Wednesday. However, many who do so have not only brought forward their prediction of a rate hike from December to October but also think the RBI may end up raising interest rates significantly.

Morgan Stanley economists led by Upasana Chachra see the RBI on Wednesday kicking off a run of four consecutive rate hikes of 25 bps each, or 100 bps in total, which will take the repo rate to 6.25% in April. "We view the rate hike cycle primarily as policy normalisation rather than disruptive tightening," Morgan Stanley said in a report last week.

The word 'normalisation'

has found several takers, with some even suggesting the first 50 bps of increase in interest rate will only lead to some normalisation of monetary conditions.

The last time the repo rate was 5.25% or lower was in mid-2022, when the RBI was in the midst of reversing the extraordinary measures taken to help the economy hit by the coronavirus pandemic.

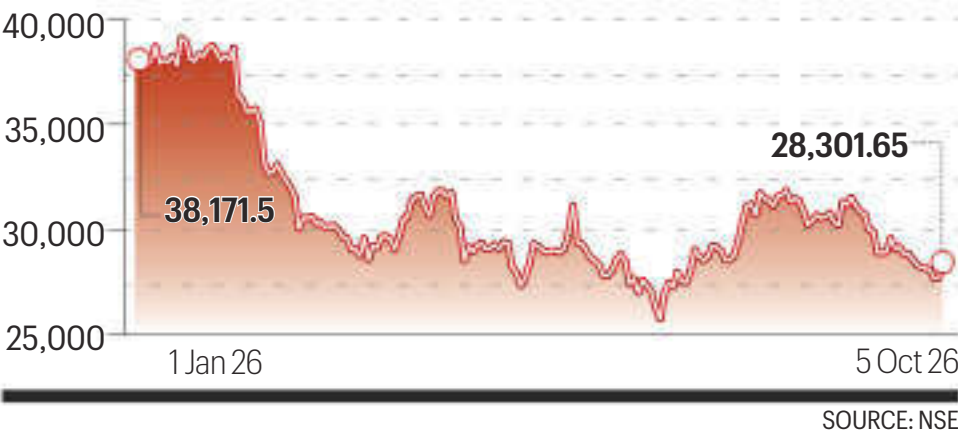
Barclays' Rahul Bajoria and Smriti Mehra have not only brought forward their rate hike call of 25 bps to this week from December but also doubled their prediction of total tightening to 100 bps from 50 bps. According to them, the balance of risks is shifting away from accommodation to tightening.

"This essentially is no longer just about reversing the incremental cut that the RBI had delivered last December but actually taking away the monetary punchbowl before inflation risks become entrenched amid a large inflow of liquidity." While inflation is under 6%, there are signs of price pressures broadening: 314 of 358 items in the CPI saw higher prices in August against July.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Accenture forecast lifts IT stocks, but near-term outlook remains hazy

• Nifty IT is down sharply so far in 2026



Akash Mandal
Mumbai, October 5

A HANDFUL of Indian IT stocks were among the best performers in the stock market on Monday after global technology major Accenture's better-than-expected revenue forecast for the year lifted sentiment across Indian bourses.

Big names such as Tata Consultancy Services Ltd (TCS) and Wipro Ltd gained up to 2%. Smaller names like Persistent Systems Ltd and Mphasis Ltd also added up to 3%. However, not all IT stocks rose, as Infosys Ltd and HCL Technologies Ltd fell 1-3%. In fact, the latter two were briefly in the green early in the session before swiftly falling into the red. Others that ended higher also lost some steam by the end due to profit booking. This led to Nifty IT, which had gained nearly 1.6% earlier in the session, eventually ending flat compared to its previous close.

Overall, the benchmark Sensex gained 472.77 points or 0.7% to end at 72,382.47. Nifty 50 also added 0.6% to close at 22,555.75. Many sectors, including banking, financial services and fast-moving consumer goods, also saw strong buying, helping lift the benchmarks. A handful of banks and IT majors have a big weightage on both indices.

This follows a lean patch for the markets as the two key indices extended their losing run for the eighth straight week — the longest such losing streak in 25 years. "Markets staged a recovery, supported by softer-than-expected US jobs data and a moderation in crude oil prices, providing some relief to investors assessing the near-term interest rate outlook," said Vinod Nair, Head of Investments at Geojit Investments.

Irish major Accenture's earnings for the June-August quarter beat analysts' estimates on Thursday. However, the bigger talking point was the higher-than-expected guidance provided by the company for FY27. As the markets remained shut on Friday on the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti, this exuberance was seen on Monday.

"Accenture's 4QFY26 revenue of \$18.68 bn (+7% y-o-y in constant currency or c terms) exceeded its top end of guidance band of \$18.4 bn. It guided for 3-6% growth in cc (with inorganic contribution at 2-2.5%) terms for FY27E, which was higher than the Street expectations of 2-5%, and expects no effect from currency movements in FY27E," noted Nomura.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

IndiGo hikes fuel charge amid high jet fuel prices, higher airfares likely

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, October 5

WITH JET fuel prices remaining elevated on a sustained basis amid the West Asia crisis, IndiGo on Monday announced hikes in its distance-based fuel charges for domestic and international flights from Tuesday (October 6). The hikes in fuel charge are bound to lead to a further increase in airfares, which have already been high due to the impact of the West Asia war. Jet fuel is a major cost element for airlines as it accounts for over 40% of their operating expenses.

While the increases on domestic flights range from Rs 100 to Rs 350 per sector, a large number of international passengers will face substantially larger increases compared with the fuel charges announced by the airline in April. The fuel charges for international flights have been hiked by up to Rs 2,500 per sector. The revised fuel charges will apply to all bookings made from 00:01 am on Tuesday, which means that booking already made will be unaffected by the charge revision.

"ATF prices have remained

IndiGo fuel charges (DOMESTIC ROUTES)		
Route distance (km)	Revised fuel charge (₹)	Increase (₹)
0-500	375	100 (36.4%)
501-1,000	600	200 (50%)
1,001-1,500	900	300 (50%)
1,501-2,000	1,150	350 (43.8%)
Above 2,000	1,300	350 (36.8%)

volatile in recent months, especially following geopolitical issues in the Middle East. The continuous rise in the fuel prices, with the latest month-on-month increase exceeding 14%, has taken ATF costs to levels that are amongst the highest in the last decade. Given that Aviation Turbine Fuel makes up a significant share of airline's operating costs, this rise is expected to impact airlines' cost structures and network economics, including those of IndiGo," said the country's largest airline, which operates over 2,200 flights a day.

IndiGo described the latest increase as a "measured and relatively modest adjustment", saying a significantly larger increase would have been required

to fully offset the rise in fuel costs. The fuel charge was introduced in March, in the early days of the West Asia war, and was last revised on April 1.

"IndiGo regrets the additional burden these revised fuel charges may place on its customers. However, the decision reflects the sustained increase in operating costs and the evolving market environment. IndiGo will continue to monitor the situation and make relevant adjustments as and when appropriate. IndiGo remains committed to giving wings to the nation by offering affordable, convenient and consistent travel to customers," the airline said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SEBI chairman urges investors to avoid finfluencers, unregulated products

Chandigarh: Launching its nationwide investor-awareness initiative, Project Jagrook, from Chandigarh on Monday, SEBI chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey urged investors to be aware of investment frauds and use regulated products, channels and entities instead of relying on anonymous tips, finfluencers or exaggerated claims about returns.

Pandey advised investors to

follow five basic habits: invest only in products they understand, start early and stay invested to allow compounding to work, diversify their investments and not mistake fixed returns for risk-free investments.

"Instead of asking, 'Which product gives the highest return?', first ask, 'What am I investing for?'" he said.

Stating that "more savers are becoming investors", Pandey

said mutual fund assets have grown sharply from Rs 12 lakh crore in 2015-16 to around Rs 87 lakh crore today, at an average annual growth rate of about 21% over the past 10 years. Referring to a large-scale survey on awareness of securities-market products and actual market participation, Pandey said only 36% of investors had high or moderate knowledge of the securities market. ENS

Only 9% use public transport to go to work

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 5

THE STATISTICS ministry's first-ever household travel survey has found that only 9% of Indians use public transport to go to work, with 43% using two-wheelers. A mere 3% use cars. The survey's results also seemingly back the decision by several states to offer free bus travel to women, with more than a fifth of urban women using this mode of transport to go to work, three times as high as urban men.

Further, people in urban areas spend as much as Rs 1,044 per month to commute to work, 71% more than the Rs 612 spent by people in rural areas. Nationally, the average monthly ex-

penditure to go to work is Rs 785. As per the survey, buses are used by 6.7% of people who reported travelling more than 1 kilometre to reach their place of work. Another 2.1% said they used monorail or tram, while 0.2% said they travel by rail.

"While monorail, metro, suburban rail, and trams account for 5% of urban worker commutes nationally, usage surges in Maharashtra (20.7%), West Bengal (16.5%), and Delhi (14.4%)," the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) said on Monday. Train, monorail, and tram include metro rail and local trains.

The findings of the National Household Travel Survey (NHTS), conducted from July 2025 to June 2026, are based on



Over a fifth of urban women take buses to work. REUTERS

responses from 20 lakh people across 14,274 villages and 10,377 urban blocks. MoSPI said the survey's main objective is to generate data-driven insights that can be used in regional transport planning and infrastructure de-

velopments as well as identify gaps, optimise transport routes, and improve service frequency and scheduling.

The survey's results back the decision made by several states to offer free bus travel for women, with 21.7% of urban women who travel more than 1 km for work taking a bus. For urban males, this figure is just 6.9%.

In certain states, the fraction of urban women commuting to work by bus was significantly higher than the national average: 46.8% in Kerala, 41.1% in Tamil Nadu, 34.9% in Karnataka, and 28.9% in Telangana. The 'bus' category includes public, private, company, and inter-city buses.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Honda to rework India strategy, target cost cuts

Mumbai/Tokyo: Honda Motor aims to cut costs by as much as a fifth and halve development times under its new partnership in India with Tata Technologies, as per two people familiar with the matter, as pressure from rivals forces the Japanese automaker to rethink its go-it-alone approach.

Reeling from electric vehicle (EV)-related losses that it expects to reach more than \$12 billion, Honda is pivoting to gasoline-electric hybrids and slashing expenses. Last month, *Reuters* reported that it is seeking to cut more than \$9 billion in costs over the next four years and has told suppliers to drastically reduce prices. In May, engineering firm

Tata Technologies said it was selected to develop vehicles for a Japanese automaker. It declined to name the partner, but the two people and another person familiar with the matter said it was Honda.

Under the outsourcing agreement, Tata Technologies will develop cars for the Indian market, while Honda expects to see up to 20% in cost reductions and halve its development times from around five years at present, two people said. Honda decided to bring in Tata Technologies after the automaker's Japanese and Indian managers failed to agree on which suppliers to use for upcoming vehicles in India, two of the people said. REUTERS

• MARKETS

Sensex 72,382.47 472.77 0.66%	NIFTY 22,555.75 133.80 0.60%	Gold ▲ ₹1,48,198	US Dollar ▼ ₹96.30
		Silver ▲ ₹2,24,157	Oil ▲ \$120.73

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 2, 2026

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 6, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

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● **DEFENCE MINISTER** Rajnath Singh will lay the foundation stone for new facilities linked to the Shakti engine at Hindustan Aeronautics Limited in Odisha's Koraput district.
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OPPOSES BAIL TO FOREST OFFICIALS

Karnataka CID probe puts forest dept in the dock over killing of three 'poachers'

Cites autopsy reports, red-flags absence of weapon at site, removal of bodies



Anthony Swamy, John Rose Peter and Sebastian David Kumar were shot dead in Karnataka's Cauvery Wildlife Sanctuary on August 15.

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, October 5

A CID investigation into the killing of three alleged poachers in Karnataka's Cauvery Wildlife Sanctuary, bordering Tamil Nadu, by forest officials in the early hours of August 15 this year, has raised several questions: autopsy reports indicate shots were fired at close range; videography of crime scene does not show weapon alleged

to have been found with the victims; bodies were removed and crime scene not preserved.

The CID has cited some of these findings, based on forensic and field evidence, in its plea to the Karnataka High Court for cancellation of anticipatory bail granted to the three forest officials — Shivaraja Sasalavada (29), beat forester to whom the shotgun used in the killings was issued by the forest

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



President Droupadi Murmu and Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Swiss President Guy Parmelin and his wife Caroline Merotto at the Rashtrapati Bhavan on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Ukraine or West Asia, India backs all meaningful peace efforts: PM

Started talks after Indian seafarers killed in attacks, says Jaishankar

Shubhajit Roy & Divya A
New Delhi, October 5

IN HIS first remarks since India initiated a proposal to end the war between Russia and Ukraine, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Monday that India has "consistently supported every meaningful effort towards peace".

INSIDE **PAGE 9**
INDIA, SWITZERLAND INK NUCLEAR SECTOR, DEFENCE PACTS

In his statement after the bilateral meeting with visiting Swiss President Guy Parmelin, Modi said: "Both India and Switzerland believe in democratic values, the rule of law, dialogue and diplomacy. We will continue to work together for global peace and stability. Whether it is Ukraine or West Asia, India has consistently supported every meaningful effort towards peace".

His statement came a day after External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said that India has got a "little more involved beyond advocacy" and is having conversations with both Russia and Ukraine, trying to be "helpful" on the safety of shipping in the Black Sea, grain and energy exports and on "non-attack possibilities".

Last week, Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha had said that India has put forward a "comprehensive" and "broad" proposal to end the war, for the first time since the war began in February 2022.

Elaborating on the context

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NOTICES DIRECTED AT THE CEC, ECs SANDHU AND JOSHI

Did not clear Form 6 change... can annul unilateral decisions: SC sends notice to EC

Declines to pass interim order to suspend CEC Gyanesh Kumar

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 5

THE SUPREME COURT on Monday issued notice to the Centre and the Election Commission of India (ECI) on a petition accusing Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar of acting in violation of the law that governs his terms of office by functioning in a unilateral manner and seeking his removal.

The notice issued by a three-judge bench, presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, was also directed at the CEC, Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, Deputy Election Commissioner Maneesh Garg and ECI Director General (Information Technology) Seema Khanna.

The petition, filed by Patna resident Rakesh Kumar Singh, is

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THE EDITORIAL PAGE
THE KNOCK ON THE SUPREME COURT'S DOOR **PAGE 10**



The Indian Express investigation published on September 23

Will like to see who has modified what in records: Top court

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 5

THE SUPREME COURT said on Monday that it had not approved any "modified" version of Form 6, which is used to enroll new voters, and will examine Election Commission of India (ECI) records to know whether any change had been made and, if so, by who.

The apex court was responding to a petition, which argued that a "modified" Form 6 was used for the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The matter is being heard by a three-judge bench

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

Form in focus

This year, the ECI added a declaration to the online Form 6, for new voters, which requires applicants to answer if they or their parents/ grandparents were on the rolls of the previous SIR. Form 6 is prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, and only the Government can change it by amending the rules — a point two Election Commissioners flagged to the CEC.

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



HOW SCIENTISTS USED LIGHT TO CONTROL BRAIN CELLS

EXPLAINED, PAGE 12

Give detailed plan on relocating 135-yr-old library: SC to Centre



The Supreme Court took suo motu cognizance of The Indian Express report published on September 30

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 5

THE SUPREME COURT on Monday sought a detailed affidavit from the Centre on its plans to relocate the Central Secretariat Library (CSL), currently housed in Shastri Bhavan which is set to be torn down as part of the Central Vista revamp plan.

Taking suo motu cognizance of The Indian Express report on the issue, a bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva issued notice to the Centre and sought an "affidavit with full details of the area which would be allotted for housing the library along with actual layout plans".

The court also asked the Centre to indicate "whether this library (proposed one) will be sufficient to house not only the books which are presently stored in Shastri Bhavan, but also the books which are stated to be lying in R K Puram."

On September 30, The Indian Express reported that the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs and Central Public Works Department are yet to find space for the 135-year-old library which houses more than 8.5 lakh books.

The report said that in January, the Directorate of Estates allotted two rooms, with an area of 300 square metres, at

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

RS polls: Union Ministers Hardeep Puri, B L Verma not in BJP's UP list

Lalmani Verma & Jatin Anand
Lucknow, New Delhi, Oct 5

THE BJP Monday announced eight candidates for the October 16 Rajya Sabha elections from Uttar Pradesh, leaving out Union Ministers Hardeep Singh Puri and B L Verma, whose terms in the Upper House are set to end next month.

Puri is currently the Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas. Verma is the Minister of State for Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribu-



Union Ministers Hardeep Singh Puri and B L Verma

tion, and Social Justice and Empowerment.

With their Rajya Sabha terms ending on November 25 and the BJP not renominating

J&K sends 150 'Bangla immigrants' on IAF aircraft to Bengal for deportation

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, October 5

AS MANY as 150 Bangladeshi nationals who were allegedly living illegally in Jammu and Kashmir were airlifted Monday to West Bengal's Bagdogra, from where they will be deported. The 150 are among 500 people

who were detained from different parts of the Union Territory during a survey to identify illegal immigrants and kept in a facility manned by the police.

From Bagdogra, the 150 will be deported to Bangladesh, officials said.

This comes two months after a high-level committee on

them, they can continue as the Union ministers for up to six months without being a member of either House of Parliament, as per the constitutional provisions.

The omission of the two ministers' names was seen as an indication that there could be a reshuffle of the Union ministry in the coming months.

The BJP's list of Rajya Sabha candidates from UP comprises three OBC faces, two Brahmins, two Dalits and one Thakur

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS exclusive

Dozen Bengal Tribunal judges flag their EC portal: 'Can't serve notices, hold hearings or restore deleted voters'

3 months after polls, on Aug 11, Tribunals put on record challenges in SIR appeal process; sent to EC, Calcutta HC Chief Justice

Damini Nath & Atri Mitra
New Delhi, Kolkata, October 5

JUDGES OF more than a dozen Tribunals appointed in West Bengal on the orders of the Supreme Court to process SIR appeals, including of 27 lakh deleted electors, have highlighted glaring gaps in a digital portal set up for them by the Election Commission of India's IT division.

Official records show they complained that the portal did not allow them to serve notices to parties, slowing down the disposal of appeals. It did not

allow the Tribunals to upload additional documents from voters who filed appeals, or hold virtual hearings, or restore a deleted voter. It didn't even let the appellants download Tribunal orders, the judges said.

These concerns form the minutes of a meeting of over a dozen Tribunal judges on August 11 — there are 19 in all — and were conveyed to the Election Commission of India and the Chief Justice of the High Court of Calcutta, The Indian Express has learnt.

An investigation by

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 9

● TOTAL CHEETAH POPULATION GOES UP TO 60, INCLUDING 41 BORN IN INDIA

Father from Botswana, mother from India: 5 cheetah cubs at Kuno usher in new lineage

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, October 5

AN INDIAN-BORN cheetah has given birth to five cubs at Kuno National Park after mating with a Botswana Cheetah — ushering in the Botswana lineage of India's cheetah population.

KJP21, a 32-month-old female born in India, gave birth to the five cubs on Monday.

Their father is a male cheetah brought from Botswana, making the newborns the first representatives of the Botswana lineage to be born in India, Union Environment, Forest and Cli-

mate Change Minister Bhupendra Yadav said.

The births take India's cheetah population to 60, of which 41 have been born in the country. KJP21 is the third female cheetah born in India to reproduce, after Mukhi and KGP12.

"With the arrival of these five cubs, the cheetah population in India has reached 60, including 41 Indian-born cheetahs. Importantly, these cubs also mark the beginning of the Botswana lineage in India, as their father is a Botswana male cheetah — adding a new genetic lineage to India's growing cheetah popu-

lation," Yadav said.

The development comes just months after India brought a fresh group of cheetahs from Botswana to strengthen the genetic base of Project Cheetah.

Nine cheetahs — six females and three males — arrived at Kuno from Botswana in February this year. They were the third group of cheetahs brought to India, after eight from Namibia in 2022 and 12 from South Africa in 2023.

The decision to bring cheetahs from Botswana followed a fresh round of government-to-government discussions that began in December 2024. The Union government formally



The cheetah cubs at Kuno National Park. @BYADAVBJPX

approached Botswana as it looked to expand the genetic base of Project Cheetah beyond the animals already brought from Namibia and South Africa.

Yadav took up the proposal with Botswana's then Environment and Tourism Minister Boipuso Wynter Mmolotsi. Botswana agreed to partner

with India after considering the country's detailed Action Plan for Cheetah Reintroduction.

The partnership received a political push during President Droupadi Murmu's state visit to Botswana in November 2025. During her visit, Murmu and Botswana President Duma Gideon Boko witnessed the symbolic release of eight cheetahs, captured from the Ghanzi region, into a quarantine facility at the Mokolodi Nature Reserve.

The choice of Botswana was significant because the country has one of Africa's largest remaining wild cheetah populations. The first batch from Botswana was transported from the

Mokolodi Nature Reserve to Gaborone and then flown to India with the assistance of the Indian Air Force, before being taken by helicopter to Kuno.

After the November handover, the animals underwent quarantine, and the two sides worked through the necessary permissions, including export and CITES clearances, veterinary requirements and arrangements for transporting the animals to India.

A three-member Botswana delegation, including veterinarians and an anti-poaching expert, subsequently visited both Kuno National Park and Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary

and held discussions with National Tiger Conservation Authority officials in Delhi.

Last month, as Project Cheetah completed four years, an Indian-born cheetah gave birth to four cubs at Kuno National Park, marking a milestone for a programme that began with the translocation of animals from Africa and is now seeing successive generations born in India. The birth was particularly significant because KGP12, the mother, is itself a product of the reintroduction programme. It was born in India to Gamini, one of the cheetahs brought from South Africa.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

SC sends notice to EC

based on the findings of an investigation by *The Indian Express* published on September 23 that Sandhu and Joshi had objected on record 14 times in 10 months to steps taken by the Commission under the CEC — from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names.

The plea urged the bench, also comprising Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and V Mohana, to seek the “complete original and primary records” relating to the matter from the Election Commission. It also prayed that the ongoing exercise be declared illegal.

The CJI assured that the court would examine the records and ensure that any decision taken without unanimity will have to go. “We can always annul any decision,” the CJI said.

Justice Bagchi said that after examining the records, if the court finds that some decisions were taken neither by unanimity nor by majority, “we will in-

junct those decisions...we will say these decisions are ultra vires...”

The bench, however, declined to pass any interim order to suspend CEC Kumar or direct that the poll body should take decisions unanimously till it finally decided the matter.

Appearing for the petitioner, Senior Advocate Vikas Singh said some interim directions are necessary. “I am wanting an interim order today to suspend the CEC immediately...Today there are elections happening...or divest him of the authority to act as CEC,” he said.

Justice Bagchi, however, asked “who will conduct the election” in such a scenario. Singh responded that the two Election Commissioners can, and added that in the interim, the court should also restore the position of the ECI as it had made the CJI a member of the selection committee for CEC.

“We are dealing with a very grave situation today. A grave situation which can undermine

the very basis of our democracy. Today, our democracy is vibrant and known all over the world because of the way we are able to conduct the elections. This election...has been conducted for 76 years, with the ECI having a certain amount of respect,” Singh said.

He said that while there have been earlier occasions where one or two decisions of the ECI may be questioned, “today we are having a situation where the very CEC as a constitutional body is acting in a manner which is completely contrary to the statute under which he is appointed.”

Pressing for interim relief, Singh said: “...today Your Lordships will pass some orders. Otherwise this country will burn today...The elections were conducted with the ECI having some respect. But today we are having a situation where the CEC is acting in a manner which is completely contrary to the statutory framework. Your Lordships have to take some interim measures here. Because otherwise the very credibility of the electoral process is so undermined that every citizen

of this country is feeling unsafe.”

When the court expressed its disinclination to issue any order to suspend the CEC, Singh sought a direction that the ECI will decide things unanimously till the court hears the matter next.

Referring to *The Indian Express* investigation, Singh pointed out that the ECI had not denied the report. “There is a press release (on September 26) by the Election Commission, which has not denied the newspaper report. The press release is in the vaguest of language.”

The CJI said: “(The) newspaper report may be 100 percent correct, it may be partially correct, it may be partially incorrect. We cannot really pass an order today on that basis. But we would definitely like to have their response. And then whatever correctional requirements are needed, will issue them.”

When Singh insisted that the court pass an interim order directing that the ECI act unanimously till the next date of hearing, the CJI said: “...going by the law, they are expected to take

firstly a decision by unanimity and if there is no unanimity, by majority. Now if there is a decision which is neither unanimous nor by majority, (then) that is subject matter (of challenge)...”

The CJI said, “There is a mandatory law. We will accept that they follow it. And if ultimately we find there are instances it has not been followed, you know the (consequences).”

Accusing the CEC of violating the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, the petition said: “If the power constitutionally vested in the Election Commission as a multi-member body can, in fact or in substance, be exercised by one office within it without the participation of the Constitution and the 2023 Act... then decisions that determine who is on the electoral roll, and therefore who may vote, raise a serious constitutional question as to whether such decisions are being taken by the constitutional authority the Constitution created for that purpose.”

Will like to see who has modified what: SC

headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, and also comprising Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and V Mohana. The court’s observation comes after the ECI issued a statement on September 26 that the Form 6 would revert to the original version as per Registration of Electors Rules, 1960. “The declaration attached to Form 6 for SIR has been upheld by the Hon’ble Supreme Court. For non-SIR period, the Forms applicable as per Rules (the Registration of Electors Rules 1960) will be used,” the ECI had said in its statement.

The ECI was responding to the findings of an investigation by *The Indian Express* published on September 23 that two Election Commissioners in the three-member ECI objected on record 14 times in 10 months to steps taken by the Commission under Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar — from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names.

The Indian Express had first reported in July that the online Form 6 on the ECI’s ECINet portal has started asking applicants whether they, or their parents or grandparents, were on the electoral roll of the last SIR — and that the form could not be submitted without an answer.

On September 23, this newspaper reported that Election Commissioner Vivek Joshi had recorded on May 16 that the form “cannot be altered without making amendments in the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960”, and his colleague Sukhbir Singh Sandhu concurred on May 19 — the change in the portal went ahead regardless.

On Monday, appearing for

petitioner Shailendra Mani Tripathi, Senior Advocate Menaka Guruswamy told the bench: “Let me give you an illustration...since it pertains to most recently, for instance, Delhi. Let us see how the SIR was conducted in Delhi. Form 6 has two new conditions added. Those Forms 6 were circulated. Neither the petitioner is now allowed to be on the roll. I got a notice also...based on this new Form 6, which cannot, under the schedule, be modified.”

The CJI said: “Let’s be very clear. The modified Form 6 has not been approved by us...Let us also be clear that when the record will be produced, we will like to see who has modified what.” The reference was to a related plea by Patna-resident Rakesh Kumar Singh who sought the summoning of original records of the ECI in this regard.

Referring to *The Indian Express* investigation, Tripathi’s plea raised “unprecedented Constitutional fractures and illegalities committed within the Election Commission of India under Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar as exposed by documentary records published”. The plea sought “probe by an independent, high-powered judicial inquiry commission or a special investigation team headed by a retired judge of the Supreme Court” into the CEC’s actions.

“These illegal acts include: Unilateral & Illegal Alteration of Statutory Form 6... Centralisation and Usurpation of Statutory Powers: Depriving decentralised Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) of their statutory authority under Section 13B, 22, and 23 of the Representation of

the People Act, 1950, and centralizing electoral roll management under the Director General of IT (DG-IT) in Delhi,” the petition said. The plea also listed “disenfranchisement due to software failures”; “unauthorised subversion in West Bengal” by “filing over 16.10 lakh unauthorised appeals in the name of ECI to purge citizens restored by 700 Judicial Officers, without the knowledge, authorization, or sanction of the other two Election Commissioners or the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of West Bengal”. It raised the issue of “bureaucratic usurpation and subversion of oversight” and “subversion of multi-member decision making”.

The plea contended that “defying this binding majority, respondent number 3 (CEC Gyanesh Kumar), acting in concert with respondent number 6 (DG-IT), altered Form 6 digitally on the ECINet portal in July 2026”.

Referencing *The Indian Express* investigation, the plea said that on “August 13, 2026, Commissioner Sandhu formally recorded that this alteration was ‘unauthorised and illegal’ and was causing arbitrary harassment to young, eligible first-time electors, ordering its immediate withdrawal. Despite this, the unauthorised form was kept live on the portal.”

In May, in its judgment upholding Bihar SIR, the SC had said that ECI had residual powers to formulate appropriate documentation work to meet the needs of a special revision of electoral rolls, provided it was not arbitrary. “Such authority, however, is not unbounded,” the court had said then.

Rajya Sabha elections

nominee. The list increases the share of OBCs and Dalits because the eight seats falling vacant had two OBCs, two Thakurs, two Brahmins and one Dalit and one Sikh.

Among the OBC candidates this time is Dharampal Singh, the BJP MLA from Bareilly’s Aonla and a minister in the Yogi Adityanath-led government, where he holds the Animal Husbandry and Dairy Development portfolio. Singh is a Lodhi, with his nomination seen as a replacement for Verma who also belongs to the community.

The Lodhi group is influential in the Bundelkhand and Rohilkhand regions of UP, which has traditionally backed the BJP. Its support for the party is also linked to former UP CM late Kalyan Singh, a Lodhi leader who was one of the BJP’s tallest OBC leaders.

The other two OBC nominees in the BJP’s list are Prakash Pal, state president of the party’s OBC Morcha who hails from Kanpur district, and

Shruti Gangwar of Bareilly. Shruti, an IIT graduate, is the daughter of Jharkhand Governor Santosh Gangwar. She has been politically active in the Bareilly-Baheri region.

The two Brahmin nominees are Radha Kant Ojha, a lawyer from Prayagraj and younger brother of former minister Shivakant Ojha, and Gopi Krishna Pandey of Kanpur, who has worked in the party’s farmer and youth wings.

The BJP’s Dalit candidates are former Barabanki MP Priyanka Singh Rawat, a state party vice-president, and Vidya Sagar Sonkar from Jaunpur, former MLC and state party general secretary.

The eighth nominee Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan, former MLA from Agra, is a state BJP general secretary in charge of the western region. He has been involved in several key party campaigns.

Upper House contest

UP’s 10 Rajya Sabha seats

falling vacant have had eight BJP members — Hardeep Singh Puri, Arun Singh, Geeta Shukla, Neeraj Shekhar, Brij Lal, B.L. Verma, Dinesh Sharma and Seema Dwivedi. Dinesh Sharma vacated his seat last month following his appointment as the Andaman and Nicobar Islands Lieutenant Governor. The BJP has not renominated any of the remaining seven MPs.

The principal Opposition Samajwadi Party (SP) has renominated veteran leader Ram Gopal Yadav, uncle of party president Akhilesh Yadav, whose current term is also ending next month. The party has fielded Reliance executive Dhanraj Nathwani as its second Rajya Sabha candidate.

The SP has enough strength in the UP Assembly to get its two candidates elected for the Upper House.

Nathwani, 40, is the son of Parimal Nathwani, Director, Corporate Affairs for Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL), who was re-elected to the Rajya Sabha from Jharkhand as an NDA-backed Independent in the June 2026 election, securing

his fourth consecutive term in the Upper House.

Another Rajya Sabha seat from UP is falling vacant due to retirement of Ramji Gautam, currently the lone BSP representative in Parliament.

The BJP and the SP have the numbers to smoothly win seven and two seats respectively. However, a contest is likely to take place for the remaining one seat, with the SP planning to field a third candidate. The contest would take place in the run-up to the high-stakes UP Assembly elections slated for February 2027.

Currently, there are 396 MLAs in the 403-member UP Assembly. Each Rajya Sabha candidate, therefore, will require 37 first-preference votes to win.

The SP has 101 MLAs. However, its effective strength is 100 as Chail MLA Puja Pal, who continues to figure in the House records as an SP member, has switched to the BJP and is currently its state vice-president.

With the support of two Congress MLAs, the SP has 102 votes, nine short of the first-

preference votes required to ensure the victory of its third candidate.

The BJP has 255 MLAs with its NDA allies adding another 33 members: Apna Dal (S) 13, RLD 9, SBSP 6, and NISHAD Party 5. With the support of Puja Pal, unaffiliated MLAs Manoj Pandey, Rakesh Pratap Singh, and Abhay Singh who were expelled from the SP in June 2025 for cross-voting in the 2024 Rajya Sabha polls; and two MLAs of the Raja Bhairava-led Jansatta Dal (Lok-tantrik), the NDA’s effective tally could reach 294, two short of the required 296 (37 for each) first-preference votes to ensure a win for its eight candidates.

The BJP is placing its bets on MLAs Rakesh Pandey, Vinod Chaturvedi and Ashutosh Maurya, who had also cross-voted in 2024 but still continue to be listed as SP members in the Assembly records as Akhilesh had not expelled them citing their “good conduct”. Chaturvedi told *The Indian Express* that he would vote in favour of a BJP candidate in the Rajya Sabha polls.

Modi

and rationale behind India’s move. Jaishankar said on Monday that Delhi started the latest round of conversations with Russia and Ukraine in July this year, after commercial ships came under attack from both sides in the Black Sea.

Speaking at an interactive session at the Kautilya Economic Conclave in New Delhi, Jaishankar said: “In the month of July, there were attacks on civilian shipping by both Russia and Ukraine. And in the course of those attacks, some Indian sailors were killed, some were injured. We regard these attacks as completely unacceptable, whether it is in the Black Sea, the Red Sea, or the Gulf. So we protested very strongly to the Russians, to the Ukrainians. I myself took it up with the foreign ministers of both countries. And we started getting active initially to secure the maritime shipping and the mariners involved in that.”

Jaishankar said those conversations brought out the nature of the cargo being carried. And there was concern over grain exports which had come to

a halt in the Black Sea. “So the conversation developed into whether non-attack on shipping is good, but is there a possibility of facilitating the shipment of grain... So it got linked to energy. So it became a somewhat broader conversation,” he said.

He said “those conversations are ongoing” — including during Modi’s meeting with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek on August 31, after which Jaishankar went to Kyiv to meet Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy in early September, followed by another discussion between Modi and Putin in New Delhi on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit on September 11-12.

“We still keep in touch with both sides. It’s obviously not an easy situation. It’s not something which anybody can say with a high degree of confidence that something is going to come out. But it seems definitely an effort worth making,” Jaishankar said, adding that resolving concerns pertaining to grain, fertiliser and fuel are in the interest of India, as well as the Global South.

“We have the interests of the parties themselves, that if they can even agree on something of a limited nature, we feel that in the given circumstance that’s a

big positive,” he said.

From the very beginning, he said, India has held the view that this conflict is unlikely to be resolved on the battlefield. “Therefore, it was important to have negotiations between the parties... there were actually negotiations in the early stages of the conflict.”

“Though we have been maintaining for some time that both parties should come to the table, and there were a number of conferences where countries gathered to express their support for peace, but often they would gather in the absence of Russia,” he said, in a reference to initiatives like the Swiss peace conference.

However, he said, India has always believed that there wasn’t any point “of having a gathering dealing with the Ukraine conflict where Russia is not there”.

On October 1, Putin had said that Modi “constantly raises the question about putting an end to the conflict” and has “very good ideas”. Later that day, speaking to reporters in Kyiv, Ukraine’s Foreign Minister Sybiha had said, “We have four proposals. The most comprehensive is India’s proposal. For the first time, India has signalled its willingness to play a role.”

Building in Bastar, once a security camp, now houses 150 tribal students

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, October 5

UNTIL RECENTLY, this building in Chhattisgarh’s Bastar region used to house a security camp, aiding the forces’ fight against Maoists.

Since August, instead of paramilitary personnel, it has been home to students from nearby Maoism-hit areas, including Abujmahad that has seen over a 100 Maoists, including top leaders, being killed in the last two years. Hundreds of others have surrendered.

The Bhatpal campus currently houses two hostels for Scheduled Tribe boys studying in pre-matric and post-matric levels. “The objective was to address one of the key challenges faced by children from distant and difficult-to-access areas — access to safe

accommodation close to school. Previously, this particular area (Bhatpal) had no post-matric boys’ hostel, making it difficult for tribal students to pursue higher education,” said Narayanpur collector Namrata Jain.

“With the establishment of a post-matric hostel for tribal youths for the first time, students from remote areas can now continue their education with access to safe accommodation and better educational opportunities,” said Jain, who recently visited the Bhatpal hostel kitchen and reviewed the quality of food.

The pre-matric hostel caters to students from Class 6 to 10 and is currently accommodating 114 students. The post-matric hostel, for students of Classes 11 and 12, with a sanctioned capacity of 50 students,

is currently accommodating 39 students. Going by response to the boys’ hostels — the pre-matric one is running beyond its sanctioned capacity of 100 students — the authorities are planning to set up more such accommodations.

The next one is coming up in Kurushnar, at the entrance of Abujmahad (or Maad, as it is locally known) from the Narayanpur end.

In 2011, a residential school was built here after “permission” from Maoists who demanded the school be made without a concrete ceiling or a high boundary wall to ensure forces do not start camping there. With the Maoists now gone, the security camp established less than a decade ago is being turned into a girls’ hostel, which is expected to be ready in a few days.

Give plan on library relocation: SC

Kartavya Bhavan-2 for the CSL. The Ministry of Culture, which administers the CSL, rejected this, replying that the space allotted was far from sufficient.

Following the publication of the report, the Ministry, in a post, said: “It is clarified that space for the Central Secretariat Library has been provided for in the Kartavya Path redevelopment plan. The necessary process for construction of the library is underway.”

The Indian Express also reported that around 2 lakh books in the regional languages section have remained locked up in boxes in an office complex in R K Puram for the past 15 years after this section was “closed temporarily” in 2011 for Metro construction.

Taking up the matter on Monday, Justice Kumar said: “Credit where it’s due. This issue was flagged by one of my former colleagues, a retired

judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court who is as fond of paper as he is now appreciative of AI and all that it has to offer.”

Addressing Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, who represented the Centre, he said: “Going by this newspaper report, this is a library which dates back to 1891 with writings of 1702. Very well to say that we should cut down on paper, but that doesn’t mean that you don’t take care of the valuable papers that you already have. You are allotting two rooms in that Kartavya Bhavan, that’s it?”

Bhati said that after the issue was flagged, she had taken instructions, and handed over a report to the bench. She said the report was signed by the Director, Central Vista. “Please see what is planned,” she said.

Justice Kumar, however, sought a proper reply from the

Centre, with an affidavit giving an undertaking. He asked if the space proposed to be allocated was “leaving out the 2 lakh books which are lying in R K Puram... cartons which have not been opened since 2011.”

Bhati responded that “bigger space across two floors is being planned”, and the proposed area was more than the current area. Justice Kumar expressed doubt on whether this would include the 2 lakh books. The bench said the Centre must produce detailed plans “because if you are having conference rooms etc, the actual storage area for these books... you have to tell us is there enough area, because if you have all these trappings there, then the area for actual book storage would go down drastically”.

The court fixed the next hearing for November 16.

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‘NO MALAFIDE INTENTION’

Gurugram police chief concedes ‘lapses’ before SC in Delhi man’s cremation

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, October 5

GURUGRAM COMMISSIONER of Police (CP) Sibash Kabiraj has “conceded” that the local police committed “procedural lapses” while handling the unidentified body of Delhi-based real estate professional Yuvraj Manchanda who was allegedly killed by his former colleague and her partner last month, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

A compliance affidavit, filed in the Supreme Court on October 1, has the Gurugram CP tendering an “unqualified apology for the lapses”.

The affidavit acknowledged that it was found that information regarding the unidentified body “was not entered promptly in CCTNS form IIF-10,” that “intimation was not given to the Executive Magistrate within 24 hours” and that the control room in-charge was “negligent in performance of her duties for having relayed the information with regards to the discovery of the dead body only to local police stations and not to adjoining states”.

The police chief, however, maintained that there was “no malafide intention involved on the part of the local police”.

Police said a PCR call was received around 4:05 pm on September 10 regarding a body in an open field near a drain in Sector 70. As per police, a team reached the spot to find that the body was “bloating” and “decomposed”, “rendering fingerprint collection impossible and detailed on-site examination for external injuries infeasible”. It was shifted to a mortuary, and after an autopsy on September 14, it was cremated as an “unidentified individual”, police said.

As per the affidavit, officers at Badshahpur police station uploaded a recovery entry on



Yuvraj Manchanda. FILE

Crime and Criminal Tracking Network & Systems (CCTNS) form, IIF-10, on September 15.

An order dated September 17, issued by Deputy Commissioner of Police (Headquarters) Dr Anshu Singla, put investigating officer ASI Sahun Khan under suspension and ordered a joint regular departmental enquiry against him and Badshahpur police station SHO Rajesh Kumar. The order observed that ASI Khan made “no effective efforts” to establish the identity of the deceased, failed to publish an advertisement in local newspapers, omitted uploading details onto the Zonal Integrated Police Network (ZIPNET) portal, and failed to record complete particulars in CCTNS Forms IIF-10 and IIF-11, police said.

The DCP Headquarters noted that an abduction case had already been filed at Delhi’s Lajpat Nagar police station, remarking that “had the information regarding the unidentified dead body been uploaded on the ZIPNET portal in accordance with the prescribed procedure, there was a possibility of establishing the identity of the deceased”.

Inspector Kumar was deemed prima facie liable for “gross negligence”.

A second departmental enquiry against Kumar and Khan was initiated via an order dated

September 30. This order cited a report by the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Badshahpur, that had found that the SHO and the IO “failed to call/seek the presence of the Executive Magistrate at the spot,” in direct violation of BNSS Section 194 as well as the police commissionerate’s SOP.

Through a communication dated September 18, the DCP HQ recommended departmental action to the Superintendent of Police, Telecommunication (H), against ESI Hasina, who was on duty as Control Room In-charge on September 10.

The Gurugram Police Commissioner issued fresh instructions on September 28, mandating that control room personnel must immediately flash particulars of every unidentified body to adjoining districts and neighbouring states.

Meanwhile, a comparative analysis of affidavits filed by Delhi CP Anurag Kumar (dated October 3) and his Gurugram counterpart reveals some differences in the accounts.

CP Kabiraj asserted that on September 15, the Delhi Police approached the district police regarding the FIR, and “on their request, the entire case property and the documentation was handed over to them”.

The Delhi Police affidavit, however, stated that its officers were tracking the suspects in Uttarakhand on September 15-16, arrested them on September 17, and only discovered the recovery and cremation of the body on September 18 while inspecting the drain.

While the Gurugram police chief claimed that all records were handed over on September 15, Delhi Police documented that inquest papers and the post-mortem report were produced at Lajpat Nagar police station only on September 21.

DAY FOUR OF PROTEST AGAINST CEC GYANESH KUMAR:SIX FIRs FILED,18 ARRESTED

Journalist detained 2 days after she alleged sexual harassment by police

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

THE PROTEST against the Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the alleged irregularities in Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls entered its fourth consecutive day on Monday, with the Delhi Police registering six FIRs and arresting 18 people in connection with the alleged instances of violence that broke out during a NSUI demonstration and for circulating AI generated poster of policemen, officers said on Monday.

Among the six FIRs, four were related to violence, vandalism and rioting during the NSUI march, one tied to an alleged attack on a CISF personnel and another related to circulating a fake poster that showed an officer allegedly sexually assaulting a woman.

Meanwhile, one of the three women journalists who had alleged sexual assault by Delhi Police personnel while covering the anti-CEC protest has been detained along with 16



At the site of the protest near Jantar Mantar. FILE

others on Monday, for camping overnight outside Parliament Street police station, demanding action against the officers.

The same day also saw a CISF constable allegedly getting attacked with a knife by a protester amid an NSUI demonstration at Jantar Mantar.

The developments came amid continued demonstrations near Jantar Mantar and

growing demands for a probe into the allegations made by three female journalists, who have accused police personnel of sexually assaulting them while they were reporting on the stir on October 3.

A senior officer said restrictions under prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) had been imposed



ABHINAV SAHA

DJB’s cashless medical plan

CM Rekha Gupta with PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh and others at the launch of DJB’s cashless medical facility for pensioners, Monday.

AFTER HC RAP OVER WATER LEVEL DEPLETION

Gurugram plans borewell phase-out, pushes for treated water in industries

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, October 5

FOLLOWING SCRUTINY from the Punjab and Haryana High Court over the rapid depletion of groundwater and unchecked extraction across the district, Gurugram authorities on Monday drew up an action plan directing government departments to gradually discontinue the use of borewells and push industrial units to switch to tertiary-treated wastewater for operational needs.

At a high-level review meeting chaired by Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA) Chief Executive Officer P C Meena on Monday, departments currently reliant on groundwater were instructed to identify alternative supply channels and phase-out tube wells, officials said.

“All concerned agencies have been given a deadline of October 6 to submit detailed roadmaps outlining measures to cut extraction and scale up rainwater recharge. The district administration was also tasked

with framing a comprehensive enforcement strategy to identify and seal unauthorised borewells across the city” GMDA spokesperson Neha Sharma said.

Addressing the meeting, Meena highlighted the need to replace fresh groundwater usage with tertiary-treated wastewater from sewage treatment plants (STPs). Currently, the GMDA supplies 10 million litres per day (MLD) of treated effluent to the textile industry. Now, authorities plan to bring other industrial clusters under the treated water distribution network.

“To ensure accountability at the local level, the Haryana State Pollution Control Board (HSPCB) was directed to monitor the functioning of captive STPs in group housing societies to ensure compliance with discharge standards. Directives were also issued to mandate separate electricity connections for these treatment plants and strictly enforce the zero-liquid discharge policy in residential complexes”, Sharma added.

The meeting saw authorities resolve to shift focus toward re-

taining rainwater within the urban catchment rather than allowing run-off to discharge into storm-water drains, officials said. This strategy includes re-activating water bodies facing degradation, clearing encroachments, lowering green-belt levels to trap surface run-off, and converting designated neighbourhood parks into bioswales.

The HC in ongoing proceedings concerning the city’s shrinking groundwater reserves had said it expects the authorities to examine the issues and to suggest appropriate measures to tackle the “worsening situation of ground water in Gurugram”, noting that if the situation continues unabated then “the future generation would have to face disastrous consequences.”

In an effort to refill underground water supplies, the GMDA, in partnership with Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), is also carrying out a feasibility study to construct a large underground rainwater retention reservoir beneath the football ground at the Tau Devi Lal Stadium in the city, officials said.

Drug drop in Capital leads police to Rs 50-cr heroin in Lucknow

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 5

HEROIN WORTH around Rs 50 crore was seized on Sunday from a drug manufacturing unit in Lucknow, which the supply chain led Delhi Police to after it intercepted a drug delivery in Delhi’s Rohini on September 16.

On the night of September 16, a team of police from Rohini’s Special Staff division had stopped a white SUV in Sector 32 of the Begumpur area. In the car was 58-year-old Laxman Hooda who was carrying

300 grams of heroin to deliver to a client, said police.

Officers said that they had received a tip-off about this delivery and were waiting there for Hooda.

“300 grams of Heroin and ₹3 lakh cash were recovered from his Grand Vitara car, which was also seized,” said DCP Shashank Jaiswal.

According to police, Hooda told them about his supplier, a resident of Delhi’s Raghuraj Nagar named Anil, alias Bhola, who was on the run. Police traced him to Haryana’s Sonapat and arrested him there,

seizing yet another 500 gram package of heroin from him.

Then, police said, Anil told them that he was getting his supply from a man he identified as Bablu from Lucknow. It took police another 15 days to zero in on the identity and location of this supplier. When they found him, they also found over 6 kg of heroin.

“On the basis of technical surveillance and human intelligence, on October 4, a raid was conducted at a heroin manufacturing facility in Sita Colony, Jankipuram, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, and

Bablu, was apprehended,” said DCP Jaiswal.

“During the raid, 6.275 Kg of freshly manufactured heroin was recovered,” he added.

This quantity of heroin, police said, is valued at about Rs. 50 crores in the international market. Inside the Sita Colony house, a whole cache of drug mixing supplies was found: 2.504 kg Sodium, 787 grams Acetic Anhydride, one tub, gas cylinder, mixer grinder, utensils, polythene, an electronic weighing machine, and a wooden basket.

Police said that Bablu told

them during interrogation that all the supplies had come from Bareilly, from a man he identified as Ruksar Ali.

“Ruksar Ali @ Raju, the main source supplier/owner of the manufacturing facility, was traced and apprehended from Bareilly, UP after a prolonged and intensive pursuit of 120 km,” said DCP Jaiswal.

This was the second big heroin bust in Rohini this year.

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‘IMPORTANT IS TO PREVENT A CRIME, NOT WHAT YOU DO AFTER A CRIME IS COMMITTED’

Create fear in miscreants: SC on crime against women

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

UNDERLINING THE need to prevent crimes against women and not just arrest the accused after an offence is committed, to ensure that the National Capital Territory remains safe even during late hours, the Supreme Court Monday asked the Delhi Police to put in place a 24-hour monitoring cell for continued surveillance in vulnerable areas.

Justice J B Pardiwala, presiding over a two-judge bench, said, “... create fear in the minds of all these criminals. Something goes wrong, you are

doomed. You need to prevent this at any cost,”

“What is happening today is you catch hold of the culprit. Undoubtedly, you have that skill, you have that promptness, expertise; you will apprehend him, he will be arrested, put behind bars. That is not the solution. What is important is to prevent the crime and not just obey the orders.”

He said that “these goons, these miscreants, these anti-social elements will be at high” during the upcoming festivals.

On September 28, the bench, also comprising Justice K Vinod Chandran — taking suo motu cognisance of inci-

dents of alleged rape of a minor in August on a sleeper bus that travelled nearly 47 km from Greater Noida to Old Delhi’s Kashmere Gate, the alleged gangrape of a 17-year-old at Astha Kunj Park in South Delhi by three men posing as policemen on September 21, and an alleged gangrape and murder in Northwest Delhi earlier last month — had issued a series of directions for “examining the broader institutional failures” that may have led to the crimes.

On Monday, the bench said there appears to be a feeling that women are not safe in the national capital, especially in

“There appears to be a feeling that women are not safe in the city, particularly in vulnerable pockets. Deficiencies, if any, should not lead to, or facilitate commission of a crime,” says SC

vulnerable pockets.

“Let’s try our best to ensure that these types of crimes are not committed repeatedly ...

there appears to be a feeling that women are not safe in the city, more particularly some vulnerable pockets of the city ... So, we need to deliberate a little ... the only concern is that the deficiencies, if any, should not lead to, should not facilitate the commission of a crime,” said Justice Pardiwala.

“What is important is to prevent the crime, not what you do after the crime is committed. We have to work together. We must ensure that every young girl, every woman in the NCT of Delhi ... should feel safe even at 10 o’clock, 11 o’clock in the night, whether she is travelling by Metro, whether she is walk-

ing on the streets,” he added.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who appeared for the Centre said, “We are doing this for our daughters ...”, adding: “Mere system being there is not enough. We will have to show that it’s functioning and it is giving results.”

The court Monday also sought information on the working status of CCTV cameras installed at vulnerable locations. Referring to the incident at Astha Kunj Park, it sought the status of CCTV cameras and lights installed there and whether security personnel had been deployed. “It has been said people warned you

about these people (criminals) even in this unfortunate case,” the court noted.

Addressing the Delhi Police, Justice Pardiwala said, “People should not run away from you. People should come forward to meet you, to talk to you and your response should be such that would repose confidence in a common man.”

Referring to the September 28 order, Justice Pardiwala said, “We impress upon them (Delhi Police) to take steps as fast as possible so far as these measures which we have suggested. Our immediate concern is to prevent crimes relating to women.”

“Don’t let us down. Rise to

the occasion, please. Every woman, every girl molested is our sister, our mother. So, it is a huge challenge for the police department of the NCT. Take it up as a challenge,” the judge also told the police.

Justice Pardiwala added, “It is not just installation of CCTV cameras that is going to help you. There has to be a cell. A 24-hour cell, which keeps monitoring what is happening.”

The bench said it would pass a detailed order in the matter and that the authorities would be given 4 weeks to act on its directions. The top court posted the matter for hearing next on November 16.

Eye on student housing regulation, Govt holds meet with PG owners

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

AS THE Delhi government works on a regulatory framework for students’ housing accommodation in the Capital, Education Minister Ashish Sood on Monday held consultations with PG owners, operators and managers. Regulating private PGs, addressing safety concerns and expanding student housing have emerged as key components of the Delhi government’s proposed ‘Paying Guest Accommodation Regulation and Safety Bill, 2026’, officials said on Monday.

The law was proposed two days after a five-storey boys’ private PG building collapsed in Southwest Delhi’s Satya Niketan on September 6, killing seven people including five Delhi University students.



Education Minister Ashish Sood during the meeting with owners and operators of PG facilities on Monday. ANI

tee was constituted to examine the shortage of student housing in Delhi, safety standards and regulation of student accommodation. It is responsible to draft new laws and regulations on PGs, officials said.

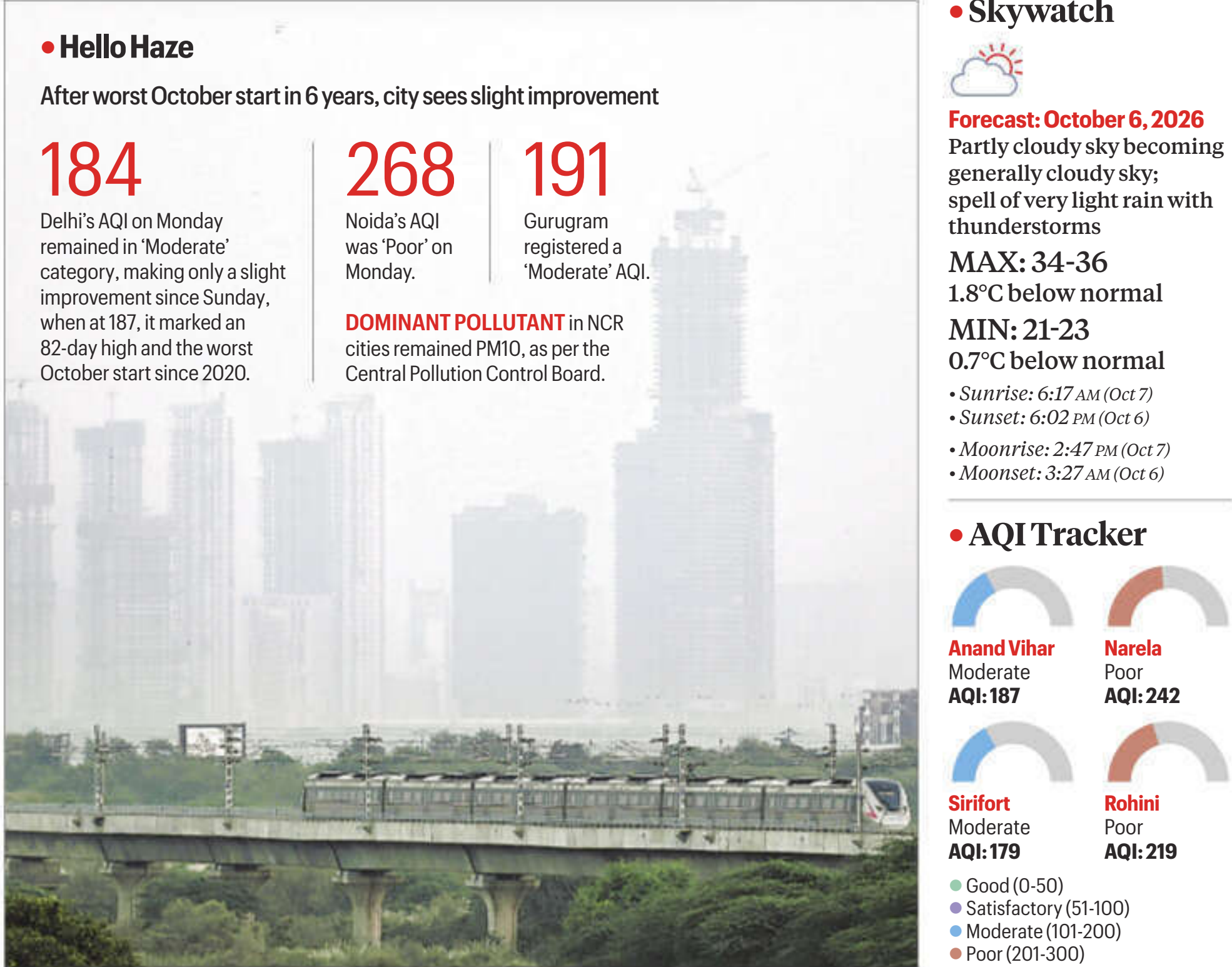
At its September 15 meeting, the committee discussed mandatory registration and a central database for institutional and private PGs, regulation of lease agreements, curbing arbitrary electricity surcharges and introducing zone-wise rent bands. It also proposed mandatory structural and fire safety audits, emergency evacuation protocols and regular mock drills for PG operators and students.

A centralised digital grievance mechanism was also proposed, through which students would be able to report overcrowding, building safety hazards and lease violations for time-bound resolution.

The committee had decided to develop a portal for PG owners to register their facilities and provide details such as the age and size of the building and fire-safety measures, officials said. A separate portal was proposed to map student data across universities and educational institutions in Delhi.

The committee, which has a 60-day deadline to submit its recommendations, also would examine the shortage of university hostels and the possibility of allowing higher floor area ratio for expansion of accommodation on campuses. The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and Urban Development Department have been tasked with identifying suitable land parcels for new hostels, while under-utilised government and DDA properties are also to be examined for possible conversion into student housing.

Sood said the government’s aim was to ensure that students had access to safe and affordable accommodation.



HC junks petitions seeking probe into 2020 Delhi riots, 2019 Jamia violence

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 5

A DIVISION bench of Justices Vivek Chaudhary and Manoj Jain of the Delhi High Court on Monday junked 15 petitions, some of which sought an independent probe, including a judicial inquiry, into alleged police excesses against students at Jamia Millia Islamia (JMI) during the 2019 protests against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act and National Register of Citizens (CAA-NRC), as well as compensation for the injured students.

Refusing to issue any direction on petition seeking regulation of police action during public protests, the bench observed that the “police did not enter the University premises at the outset to deal with an otherwise peaceful assembly confined to the campus” and entered the campus “after the situation outside and around the University had escalated and the crowd had moved into the campus.”

The court also dismissed pleas seeking the registration of criminal cases against politicians for alleged hate speeches



Police deployment outside Jamia Millia Islamia. FILE

made during the 2020 North-east Delhi riots, ruling that there was no “exceptional circumstance” warranting such action. Among the leaders against whom action was sought were BJP leaders Parvash Verma and Anurag Thakur, as well as Congress leaders Sonia Gandhi, Rahul Gandhi and Salman Khurshid, among others.

Jamia violence

On the allegations of police excesses within JMI, the bench ruled that the petitioners had failed to provide any material showing circumstances of “actual or demonstrable institutional bias, malafides, deliberate suppression of material, failure to investigate material allega-

tions, or such other defect as would render the existing process fundamentally unreliable”.

Noting that six years had passed since the riots, the court reasoned that “a fresh inquiry at this stage would necessarily involve reexamination of events and material which have already formed part of statutory and judicial processes,” and therefore refused to order any independent probe.

On why it declined to issue directions regulating police action during public protests, the bench observed:

“Once a gathering ceases to remain peaceful and the circumstances disclose violence, commission of cognizable offences or a threat to life or property, the police cannot be expected to remain inactive or as mute spectator merely because the gathering is taking place within a University campus...Where the situation requires immediate intervention, the police cannot be expected to remain outside merely because the premises belong to an educational institution.”

“Thus, we are of the con-

sidered opinion that no fresh guidelines for regulation of police action during protests within educational institutions are required to be framed,” the court concluded.

Hate speech

Similarly, the bench declined to issue any direction regarding the alleged hate speeches made during the riots. It recorded that since “investigations in the incidents have substantially progressed and have culminated in the filing of charge-sheets in a large number of cases and numerous prosecutions are presently pending before the competent criminal courts, while several have culminated in judgments...It would neither be appropriate nor necessary for this Court...to issue any general directions regulating matters pending before competent courts.”

“...The present case, in our considered view, does not disclose any such exceptional circumstance warranting a further direction for registration of criminal cases,” the court observed

Nearly 1/3rd of electors in Capital issued SIR notices now verified

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, October 5

AS THE Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process continues in the Capital, nearly one-third of the electors (around 31%) who had to prove their eligibility to stay on the electoral rolls, have been verified, data from the office of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) showed on Monday, with over 55 days left to dispose of the rest of notices and objections.

This is a sharp uptick in the number of notices disposed of compared to a week back. In the period from August 31 to September 29, only 4.01 lakh notices had been disposed. Over the next one week, more than six lakh notices were disposed of, with the total figure reaching 10.28 lakh on Tuesday.

Election officials have attributed this increase to exemptions from in-person hearings for voters who received notices, changes in the portal in which they had to upload documents, additional deployment of officials and special camps.

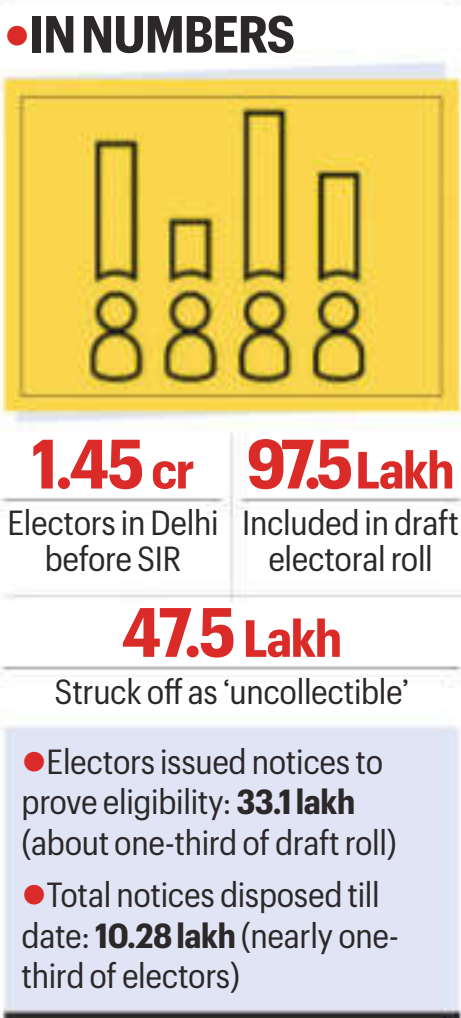
Delhi had around 1.45 crore electors before the SIR process of voter rolls began in the Capital. Among them, 97.5 lakh were included in the draft electoral roll, while around 47.5 lakh electors were classified as “uncollectible” – after the Booth-level officers (BLOs) found them absent, shifted, dead or having duplicate entries, among other reasons – and were struck off the roll.

Among the 97.5 lakh who did make it to the draft roll, one-third or around 33.1 lakh electors were classified as “uncollectible” (BLOs) found them absent, shifted, dead or having duplicate entries, among other reasons – and were struck off the roll.

Among the 97.5 lakh who did make it to the draft roll, one-third or around 33.1 lakh electors were classified as “uncollectible” (BLOs) found them absent, shifted, dead or having duplicate entries, among other reasons – and were struck off the roll.

On the new changes, an Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) said, “Now, I don’t need to call hundreds of people to my office everyday for hearings, right? BLOs are going house to house and where needed, electors can also forward their documents to the BLO on Whatsapp also.”

After its first meeting since *The Indian Express* reported on the rupture within the Election Commission, the poll panel had said last week that electors who were issued notices will not be required to attend hearings to



prove their eligibility.

“BLOs will visit the homes of such persons for collection of documents and thereafter upload them on the ECINet, for decision by the ERO. Such persons need not be called for hearing to ERO/AERO office,” a statement from the ECI said.

Some BLOs, however, expressed disappointment with the deadline for disposal of notices getting extended to November 30. “I am also working in the school for 5-6 hours, after which now I have to again go door-to-door to collect documents. The deadline has also been increased by another month. It was supposed to be a three month exercise, but now it will last five months. Should we leave school work and do this full time only?” a BLO said.

The deployment in the number of Assistant EROs, who are often school principals and can also dispose of notices like EROs, was also increased in Delhi. On September 24, the number of AEROs was increased from 297 to 902, an increase of 605.

An ERO pointed out that the change in the ECINET portal which lets EROs dispose of notices without conducting a hearing is one reason behind the uptick in notices being disposed of.

“Especially for notices for very minor logical discrepancies, if a BLO has verified the elector and is satisfied, we don’t need to trouble the electors for documents. I cleared hundreds of notices in one night after this became available,” an ERO said.

● ACTION COMES AS THE MILLENNIUM CITY GRAPPLES WITH 1,200 TONNES OF MUNICIPAL WASTE A DAY AND MILLIONS OF TONNES OF LEGACY WASTE

Delhi waste dumped in Gurugram: 10 arrested, interstate syndicate under scanner

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, October 5

A WASTE trail from Delhi to Gurugram has led to 10 arrests and the seizure of seven vehicles, with police alleging that an interstate network was bringing in municipal and plastic waste to dump, segregate and sell in the state.

“As of now, we have found that the dumping work was operating like a syndicate, where they would also segregate useful items they’d find and sell those,” a senior police officer said.

Senior officers said the enforcement drive on Sunday evening was launched follow-

ing a Friday review meeting chaired by Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, who directed authorities to ensure the city is not turned into a dumping ground and ordered strict action against vehicles bringing in garbage from outside.

Following the directives, police initiated suo motu action rather than waiting for formal complaints, officials said.

Four FIRs have been registered across three border-adjacent police stations: two at Bajghera, and one each at Udyog Vihar and Rajendra Park. “This is the first of its kind police operation; earlier we would only get complaints of it happening on a small scale,”

said an officer.

Inside the op

Gurugram Police spokesperson, Assistant Sub-Inspector (ASI) Sandeep Kumar, said the drive was carried out under the directions of the Commissioner of Police and the supervision of the Deputy Commissioner of Police (West).

“Police teams conducted checking and naka-bandi at several locations. Vehicles bringing garbage and plastic waste from Delhi were intercepted, leading to the arrest of 10 accused and the recovery of seven vehicles, including canters and tractor-trolleys,” Kumar said.



Trucks seized by police at Bajghera in Gurugram. EXPRESS

Questioning revealed that the waste was being transported into Gurugram through a coordinated network linked

to Delhi, ASI Kumar. Once brought across the border, the plastic waste was separated from the general refuse and

segregated before being dispatched to buyers elsewhere, he added.

ASI Kumar said that investigators are scrutinising ownership records of the seized fleet. “Police teams are gathering information regarding the arrested accused and vehicle owners. If the involvement or role of any vehicle owner is established during the probe, strict legal action will be taken against them as per law. Strict action for environmental protection will continue,” he said.

A senior police officer said notices have been sent to truck owners to join the investigation. “We will check if the vehicles belong or are under any

government or private body from Delhi,” he said.

So far, no prima facie link with any Delhi civic body has been found, officers said.

Police said further investigation is underway to track the waste supply chain back to its collection points in the national capital and identify all intermediaries involved in the transport and recycling network.

Gurugram’s waste woes

The operation assumes importance given the scale of the city’s garbage problem.

Millennium City generates roughly 1,200 tonnes of municipal solid waste daily, as per civic body data, while strugg-

ling to fully clear millions of tonnes of legacy trash at the oversaturated Bandhwari landfill.

The landfill site is under persistent National Green Tribunal (NGT) scrutiny over alleged groundwater contamination, toxic leachate, and frequent fires.

Garbage is currently not segregated at the time of collection from most residents. The city’s garbage collection and processing has been addressed only through stopgap arrangements and short-term tenders for over two years, when the work order of the previous contractor was scrapped due to poor performance.

Mayawati reinstates Akash with a caution, caveat

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, October 5

A MONTH after Mayawati removed nephew Akash Anand from BSP's national convener post, saying he needs to be "more mature" for significant responsibilities, the party supremo on Monday reinstated him, replacing his younger brother Ishan.

The BSP chief's latest flip-flop comes days after Akash apologised to Mayawati in a social media post on October 2, calling her "Bua Maa" and seeking a second chance to serve the party.

In a long post in Hindi on "X", Mayawati on Monday said there have been some reasons concerning Akash in recent days due to which necessary changes in the party organisation had to be made several times; and ultimately, his father-in-law, Ashok Siddharth, was also compelled to retire from politics.

Since then, people have been observing changes in Akash's personality, work style, and so on — evidence of which was a post he recently wrote on X regarding his return to the party, Mayawati stated.

The BSP chief added that most people in the party believed that Akash should be given the opportunity to resume work in the party along with his previously assigned responsibilities.

According to Mayawati, Akash's brother, Ishan, has "expressed his wish to continue working as a worker".

'I have not signalled Akali Dal and BJP alliance for Punjab polls'

WITH THE Assembly elections in Punjab just over four months away, Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD)'s lone MP **Harsimrat Kaur Badal** is holding at least three meetings a day as she leads her party's women-focused Mawan Dhiyan Insaaf Yatra against drugs across the state.

In an interview with **Raakhi Jagga**, the four-time Bathinda MP spoke about the drug problem in the state, her party's vision for Punjab, speculation surrounding her entry into state politics, and the buzz about the SAD-BJP alliance, among other issues. Excerpts:

Your anti-drug campaign, which is focused on women affected by the drug problem, is in contrast to the AAP's Mawan Dhiyan Satkar Yojana. Does this make your outreach difficult?

I do not intend to compete with anyone through my programme, which is about feeling the pain of women who are the worst-affected by the drug menace in Punjab. Women tell me that they are scared to send their children to schools and colleges.

The AAP government's scheme (Mawan Dhiyan Satkar financial aid scheme for women) is mere symbolism. Instead of providing an aid of Rs 60,000 over a five-year period, they started the scheme just six months before the polls.

Women affected by drugs are attending my programmes voluntarily.

Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann blames the previous



HARSIMRAT KAUR BADAL
BATHINDA MP, SHIROMANI AKALI DAL

SAD-BJP govt between 2007 and 2017 for the drug problem...

When we were in power, drugs were not being sold openly on the streets of Punjab nor were youngsters seen with syringe-poked arms. The AAP is just trying to defame the BJP-SAD tenure but the fact remains that *chitta* (heroin) is being sold like toffees in Punjab today.

Complainants in cases of drugs are being threatened and punished rather than drug suppliers. We often find policemen accused of selling heroin. There is a nexus between drug suppliers and the police. How can someone who was in power 10 years ago be responsible for today's problems?

The CM often takes a dig at Nanhi Chhan, your NGO which also campaigns against drugs.

Nanhi Chhan is very close to my heart. I started it decades ago when I was not active in politics.

I have empowered over 14,000 women.

With regard to Mann's criticism, what else can I expect from a "Guru Dokhi" (anti-Guru) CM, who has not empowered a single woman... His speeches show how much he respects women. I brought AIIMS to Bathinda. He has not brought a single project for the state during his tenure.

What is the Mawan Dhiyan Di Fauj campaign about?

Mawan Dhiyan Di Fauj is to identify drug traffickers and their godfathers across the state. We will empower our women to become the catalysts of change. I have released a form and it would be distributed in every village. I urge women to fill the form... Women should record all acts of drug trafficking around them with names of the traffickers and peddlers as well as those who were patronising them. The forms would be forwarded to a special anti-drug task force headed by a woman

DGP for speedy action when the SAD govt comes to power.

What is your response to the buzz that your political activity has increased as you may enter state politics and could be projected as SAD's CM face?

These are rumours being spread by our rivals. I have always been in the state as I belong to a regional party. We understand the pain of Punjab and Punjabis. This is my state.

So far, I have covered 14 Assembly constituencies through my yatra and will cover more...

What are your views on the possible alliance between the SAD and the BJP?

Contrary to perception, I have not given any indication about this possible alliance. When asked (in August) by our constituency in-charge of Longowal about an educational institution in the area, I had said if SAD comes to power, the constituency will see development.

I was just referring to former CM Parkash Singh Badal's abilities to get projects for Punjab through his goodwill irrespective of who was ruling at the Centre. My statement was misinterpreted.

How do you see SAD's chances in the 2027 Assembly polls?

The Congress won in 2017 after being out of power for 10 years. I firmly believe that public support can bring SAD to power as people no longer want Delhi to govern them. Ours is a party of Punjabis and for Punjabis.

'TARIFF HAS BECOME WEAPONISED'

India-US trade talks have hit a plateau, says Sitharaman

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, October 5



Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman. EXPRESS FILE

FINANCE MINISTER Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday said that the India-US trade deal talks have hit a plateau, beyond which "giving or taking might be very, very difficult".

This comes days after United States Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer said that signing the deal is not "imminent" as both countries have identified a "universe of items that are sticking points".

India-US trade relations are undergoing a fresh challenge ever since US President Donald Trump signed into law the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, giving him the authority to impose tariffs up to 100% on countries, including India and China, that continue to purchase Russian oil and gas. Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal has been in the US since September 29 for the G20 trade ministers' meet and bilateral trade deal negotiations.

"One thing about the US agreement, which is yet to be finalised, is that it's been a hard and very rigorously negotiated agreement. The agreement negotiations are still ongoing, although we'd like to believe that both the sides have reached a plateau beyond which giving or taking might be very, very difficult.

But maybe if there is room to operate from, both sides could do it," Sitharaman said at the Munich Security Conference (MSC) here.

Sitharaman said the predominant feature of the trade relations between India and the US is that the trade balance is in India's favour, adding that India is facing a steep imbalance in its trade with China. "Negotiation used to be the only platform through which countries could highlight the discrepancies... now, the imbalance has been sought to be addressed through other means, where... tariff has become weaponised. Tariff was an instrument of negotiation," she said.

The Finance Ministry in its latest Monthly Economic Review had noted that "trade relations with the United States remain unsettled with the passage of the Graham Bill through the Congress and its Presiden-

tial assent."

On Friday, a day after meeting Goyal, Greer had said the talks were constructive and that India and the US were in their final phase. "At the same time, I don't think there's something imminent, but we truly have identified the universe of items that are sticking points. We're working diligently toward them. My sense is that the President, the Prime Minister, may have another call, very soon on this, just to assess progress in where we are," Greer had said at a press briefing.

Apart from the Russia-related tariffs, India is also awaiting a decision on an investigation launched by the US under yet another tariff mechanism — Section 301 of the Trade Act of 1974. The investigation is expected to establish if India has excess industrial capacity and is hurting American companies with its output. The first set of Section 301 tariffs resulted in 10% tariffs.

With the new set of Section 301 tariffs expected to come in, Indian exporters have said the uncertainty is changing the nature of orders coming from the US. US buyers are no longer placing bulk orders and are diversifying imports. This could mean lower export orders for Indian businesses in the long term till the deal is not signed.

GRAFT ALLEGATIONS BY ENFORCEMENT DIRECTORATE

HC orders CBI probe against Mann's OSD, others

Express News Service
Chandigarh, October 5



ED has sought registration of a criminal case against CM's OSD Rajbir Ghuman

THE PUNJAB and Haryana High Court on Monday ordered the CBI to register an FIR and investigate allegations of corruption against senior Punjab government officials, including an OSD to Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, saying the material shared by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) prima facie "substantiated" the commission of cognizable offences.

A Bench comprising Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra and Justice Rohit Kapoor said it was "not impressed by the manner in which Punjab Police has acted so far" and directed the CBI to proceed with the investigation "forthwith" and submit a report within two months. The state government and Punjab Police have been directed to extend all assistance to the CBI.

"The material shared by ED

Will move SC against HC order: Govt

Chandigarh: The Punjab government will move the Supreme Court against the Punjab and Haryana High Court order handing over a probe to the CBI into the corruption allegations against officials of the state government, Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema said on Monday. "We will challenge this matter in the Supreme Court," Cheema said. ENS

The ED has sought registration of a criminal case against Rajbir Ghuman, an officer on special duty to the CM, his associate Nitin Gohal and others, alleging that they influenced transfers and postings of officials, facilitated arms-licence

approvals, leaked confidential government documents and secured government approvals in return for alleged monetary and other benefits. According to the ED, Gohal acted as an intermediary between interested persons and Ghuman. Both Ghuman and Gohal had earlier denied the allegations.

The petitioner had alleged a wider nexus involving senior state officials in what he described as "cash for transfers", "cash for getting favourable policies" and "cash for tenders", and alleged that Punjab Police had failed to act despite the ED sharing information.

The court noted that the ED communication, dated July 30, was received in the DGP's office on August 3 and marked to the Punjab Bureau of Investigation. Yet, no FIR was registered.

The Bench noted that the Bureau had examined the communication, issued notices to several persons and sought in-

formation from 29 departments, but subsequently asked the ED to provide legible copies of its material.

It said that once the material disclosed the commission of cognisable offences, "an FIR ought to have been registered and investigation ought to have proceeded".

Questioning the police's conduct, the Bench said it was unclear how notices could have been issued to persons named in the ED material if the documents were not legible. The delay in seeking clearer copies, it said, "lends credence to the petitioner's contention that time is being bought only to formulate strategies to save guilty and manipulate the available evidence".

The ED's communication to the Punjab Police arose from a money-laundering probe linked to alleged submission of fake consent letters for obtaining Change of Land Use (CLU) in a housing-society case.

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, October 5

THE WEST Bengal government has finally joined the Union civil aviation ministry's UDAN scheme by signing a memorandum of understanding to set up four new airports in the state—at Chharra in Purulia, Balurghat, Hasimara, and Kalaikunda.

Chief Minister Suwendu Ad-

hikari, Union Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Rammo-han Naidu, and senior officials from both the state and the Centre attended the event at Nabanna where the agreement under the Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik (UDAN) scheme was signed on Monday.

At a press conference, Adhikari sharply criticised the previous Trinamool Congress government, accusing it of

delaying the state's airport and infrastructure development.

The state government will provide required land and basic infrastructure, while the Centre and the Airports Authority of India will oversee the airport development.

The chief minister said the government planned to set up a modern pilot training centre at Behala in southwestern Kolkata.

DMK gets court permission to sue TVK ministers over Veeramani case remarks

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 5



R Veeramani is facing multiple child sexual abuse cases

THE MADRAS High Court on Monday granted the DMK permission to pursue a defamation suit against two Tamil Nadu ministers and the ruling TVK's information technology wing over statements allegedly accusing the party of shielding granite businessman R Veeramani, who is facing multiple child sexual abuse cases.

The DMK, which was in power when the allegations first came to light, is seeking Rs 1.01 crore in damages from Ministers Aadhav Arjuna and CTR Nirmal Kumar, and the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam's IT wing. It has also sought an order restraining the ministers from making statements it describes as defamatory. Justice K Govindarajan Thilakavadi allowed the party's application for leave to institute the suit. Monday's order concerns permission to bring the proceedings, and it does not decide whether the disputed statements were defamatory or establish the merits of either side's account.

The application, argued by senior counsel J Ravindran, sought the court's permission because the TVKIT wing's office and the headquarters of social media companies named in the proceedings — X Corp, Meta Platforms and YouTube — were outside the HC's territorial jurisdiction.

DMK, which was in power when the allegations came to light, is seeking Rs 1 crore in damages from Ministers Aadhav Arjuna and CTR Nirmal Kumar

ceeded according to law and the evidence available, and that it neither interfered in the inquiry nor had any connection or connivance with the accused. Those assertions form part of its case before the court.

The DMK also alleges that the ministers' remarks were intended to secure political advantage ahead of the Madurantakam and Dharapuram by-elections and to divert attention from what it calls the current government's failures.

The ministers opposed the application on procedural grounds. They argued that, because they had been sued in their official capacities as Cabinet members, the DMK should have served notice under Section 80(1) of the Code of Civil Procedure or obtained permission under Section 80(2) to dispense with that requirement.

At an earlier hearing two weeks ago, the judge had directed the defendants to file a counter-affidavit and listed the matter for Monday.

EXPRESS Careers

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Applications are invited from eligible Indian citizens for the following posts on Contract basis:

Name of Post	Vacancy	Age (As on 31.07.2026)	
		Min	Max
Deputy Vice President (Analytical Marketing & Campaign)	1	33	45
Deputy Vice President (Digital Marketing)	2	33	45
Content Specialist	1	25	40

Advertisement No.: CRPD/SCO/2026-27/25 (Contractual Position)

Name of Post	Vacancy	Age
Head Sales	1	40-52
Central Research Team (Product Lead)	2	30-45
Manager (Business Process)	1	30-40
Project Development Manager (Technology)	1	25-40
Central Operations Team (COT) Support	1	30-40

For eligibility criteria (age, experience, job profile etc.), vacancy details, requisite fees, other details and for online submission of application as well as online payment of application fees log on to Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/current-openings>. Refer detailed advertisement to ensure eligibility and other details before applying and remitting fees. For any query, please write to us through link "**CONTACT US**" → "**Post Your Query**" which is available on Bank's official website (<https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/post-your-query>)

• DATE FOR FILING ONLINE APPLICATION & PAYMENT OF FEES: FROM 30.09.2026 To 21.10.2026.

Place: Mumbai
Date: 30.09.2026
General Manager (RP & PM)

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ADVERTISEMENT FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POSTS OF FACULTY (GROUP - A) ON DIRECT RECRUITMENT /DEPUTATION BASIS IN VARIOUS DEPARTMENTS OF AIIMS MANGALAGIRI

Advt. I - No. AIIMS/MG/Admin/Recruitment/03/Faculty/2026/01 dated 11.08.2026

Date of Publishing on Website	11.08.2026	Opening Date of Online Application	28.08.2026
Closing Date of Online Applications	12.10.2026	Last date for receiving hard copy	22.10.2026

Details of Vacancies: Post, Department and Category-wise

Sr. No	Name of the department	Professor	Additional Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	Anaesthesia	-	-	-	02 UR, 01 OBC *
2.	Burns & Plastic Surgery	01 UR	-	-	02 SC
3.	Cardiology	-	01 UR#	01 UR	-
4.	Cardiothoracic and Vascular Surgery	01 SC	01 OBC	-	01 UR, 01 OBC
5.	Dermatology	01 UR	-	-	01 UR, 01 ST
6.	Endocrinology and Metabolism	-	-	01 SC	01 UR, 01 ST
7.	Gastroenterology	01 UR	01 UR	-	01 UR
8.	General Medicine	01 OBC	01 UR	-	01 OBC
9.	Medical Oncology	-	-	-	01 OBC
10.	Medical Haematology	-	-	01 UR	01 SC
11.	Microbiology	-	-	01 OBC	01 UR
12.	Neonatology	01 OBC	-	01 UR	-
13.	Nephrology	-	-	01 UR	01 OBC, 01 ST
14.	Neurology	01 UR	01 UR	-	01 SC
15.	Neurosurgery	01 UR	-	-	-
16.	Nuclear Medicine	-	01 SC	01 UR	01 UR
17.	Obstetrics and Gynaecology	-	01 OBC	-	01 UR
18.	Ophthalmology	01 SC	-	01 UR, 01 OBC	01 SC
19.	Paediatric Surgery	-	-	01 ST	-
20.	Paediatrics	-	01 UR	01 OBC	-
21.	Pathology	-	-	-	01 UR, 01 SC
22.	Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation	-	-	-	01 OBC
23.	Physiology	01 SC	-	-	01 UR
24.	Pulmonary Medicine	01 OBC*	-	01 OBC	01 ST
25.	Psychiatry	-	-	-	01 UR
26.	Radiology/ Radio Diagnosis	-	01 ST	01 OBC	02 UR
27.	Radiotherapy/ Radiation Oncology	01 UR*	-	-	-
28.	Rheumatology & Clinical Immunology	-	-	-	01 OBC
29.	Surgical Gastroenterology	01 UR	01 OBC	01 OBC	01 SC
30.	Surgical Oncology	01 OBC	-	-	-
31.	Transfusion Medicine and Blood bank	01 SC*	-	-	01 UR
32.	Trauma & Emergency Medicine	01 UR	-	-	01 UR, 02 OBC
33.	Urology	01 ST	01 UR	-	01 UR
Total		17	11	14	37
Grand Total		79 Posts			

Advt. II - AIIMS/MG/Admin/Recruitment/03/Faculty/2026/02 dated 17.09.2026

Date of Publishing on Website	17.09.2026	Opening Date of Online Application	17.09.2026
Closing Date of Online Applications	02.11.2026	Last date for receiving hard copy	12.11.2026

Details of Vacancies: Post, Department and Category-wise

Sr. No	Name of the department	Professor	Additional Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	General Surgery	-	-	01 OBC	-
2.	Neurosurgery	-	-	01 OBC	-
Total		-	-	02	-

* 4% horizontal reservation posts are reserved for Person with Benchmark Disability (PwBD).
Anticipated Vacancy

Sd/-
Administrative Officer (I/c)
AIIMS, Mangalagiri.



Say Cheese

SWITZERLAND IS famous around the world for its wide varieties of cheese, but Swiss President Guy Parmelin got to taste three unique cheese flavours — from Gultmarg, Konark and Yeoor — on Monday as he began his three-day State visit to India. Prime Minister Narendra Modi gifted him the three special Indian cheese varieties while showcasing India's growing tradition of cheese-making and regional craftsmanship. The Konark variety won Gold at the 2023 World Cheese Awards in Norway and Silver in Switzerland in 2025.

For a Change

DELHI POLICE Commissioner Anurag Kumar has renamed the force's fortnightly crime review meeting as the law and order meeting, months after taking charge and re-viewing its functioning. The change reflects the broader scope of the meeting, which assesses not only crime trends and investigations but also the overall law and order situation in the Capital. The new name has now replaced the earlier title in all official Delhi Police documents.

Jail Jeevan Mission

UP CONGRESS leader Anil Yadav, who spent six days in Agra prison after allegedly defacing the ancestral residence of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, has come out of jail with a list of undertrials, who, he claims, are struggling to secure bail due to financial constraints. Yadav is learnt to have shared the list of prisoners with senior lawyers in Delhi and Lucknow and is trying to arrange legal aid for them. During a meeting with his party colleagues, Yadav also spoke about the "terrible" condition of the Agra prison and expressed concern over the situation of the inmates.

RS polls: SP's 3rd candidate today

Lucknow: The Samajwadi Party on Monday said it will field a third candidate for the October 16 Rajya Sabha polls on Tuesday, the last day for filing nominations. The BJP and the SP are gearing up for the RS elections for 10 vacant seats in Uttar Pradesh, with the BJP having direct numbers for seven seats.

The SP has already fielded party veteran Ram Gopal Yadav and Reliance Industries executive Dhanraj Parimal Nathwani.

● PARTY LEADERSHIP HAS ISSUED STERN WARNING TO RAWAT OVER HIS STATEWIDE YATRA, MAKING IT CLEAR THAT 'INDIVIDUAL CAMPAIGNS WILL NOT BE TOLERATED'

Harish Rawat defiance of AICC deals a blow to Uttarakhand Cong

Vidheesha Kuntamalla & Lalmani Verma
Dehradun, Lucknow, October 5

CONGRESS VETERAN and former Uttarakhand chief minister Harish Rawat's decision to continue with his "Dhanyawad evam Jansamvad Yatra" despite a directive from the party high command to call it off has deepened rifts within the state party unit. The All India Congress Committee (AICC) leadership has warned that his independent outreach could undermine efforts to present a united front ahead of the Assembly elections.

The Congress leadership issued a stern warning to Rawat Monday evening, making it clear to him that individual campaigns would not be toler-

HC asks EC: If citizens are being removed, what is purpose of SIR?

Bombay HC is hearing petition against deletion of names of 6 members of a Goa family from rolls after their applications for address change were rejected

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, October 5

STATING THAT the Election Commission has an obligation to ensure all citizens are in the electoral rolls, the High Court of Bombay at Goa on Monday asked what was the purpose of "this entire SIR process" if citizens are being removed from the voters' list.

"If citizens are excluded, what will we do with SIR?" the HC asked.

Hearing a petition where names of six members of a family had been deleted from the electoral rolls after their Form 8 applications for a change of address were rejected, the HC said the voter is

facing "a Catch-22 situation" in this matter.

A division bench of Justices Amit S Jamsandekar and Valmiki Menezes said, "If a gentleman comes and says 'I have shifted, I am giving you [ECI] Form 8 [for change of address]'. You cannot tell him 'I will not hear you'...You can't do that... because the roll that is being referred to in Rule 21 [Registration of Electors Rules, 1960] is the existing roll, not the draft roll."

It said, "Everything must be seen qua the existing roll, otherwise the voter has absolutely no way out of this... look at this complete Catch-22 situation before him. If he gives Form 6, it is a false declaration.

He gives Form 8...you say 'I cannot accept it and you must give the enumeration'. He says 'I don't want to give the enumeration'. But [Rule] 21 says you have to hear him before removing his name... not from the draft, from the original roll."

The bench said the ECI has an obligation to ensure all the citizens are on the list. "If citizens are excluded, what will we do with SIR? If citizens are being removed from the list, then what is the purpose of this entire SIR process?" it asked.

The petitioners — Paresh Salgaonkar and five members of his family — had moved to a new house in the same Santa Cruz Assembly constituency eight years ago and were instructed by the booth-level officer (BLO) to submit Form 8 for change of address.

The petitioners submitted that the Assistant Electoral Registration Officer informed them that their EPICs (Elec-

tors Photo Identity Cards) had been deleted from the rolls and consequently, their Form 8 applications could not be processed. The only recourse available was to submit Form 6 (which is for new voters) since there was no option in ERONET for reviewing or restoring the deleted EPICs.

'No voter should sign a false declaration'

"...in the enumeration form, the declarations are such that I have to declare in a pre-filled form for a ward, where I used to reside...I have to make a declaration that please include me in that same place, and I state that I am not there in any other place. How will a person make such a declaration when he knows he is in another place? The moment he makes such a declaration, he is open to prosecution," the court said.

"We are asking this. Why will he sign this? This is a false statement...Why should he

give a false declaration? No voter should sign this," the bench said.

The Election Commission of India (ECI) told the court that the guidelines clearly state that if someone has not submitted the enumeration form, their name is liable to be deleted from the roll.

"In case an elector is unable to submit their filled-in enumeration form within the specified time, they may fill Form 6 along with declaration for inclusion during the claims and objection period... Ordinarily, Form 8 is by a person whose name is there in the draft roll, but says I am no longer residing here and I have shifted. He submits his Form 8 because it refers to an existing residence on the roll," the counsel for ECI said.

So, if you are not there on the draft roll only, what entry am I transferring under Form 8? I can't transfer a non-existent entry," the counsel for ECI added.



Polling for six seats today

Polling officials check EVMs and other polling materials at a distribution centre on the eve of the Nagaon Lok Sabha bypoll on Monday. Five Assembly constituencies in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu and Puducherry will also go to polls on Tuesday. ANI

Telangana CEO orders action against Form 7 misuse to delete eligible voters

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, October 5

THE CHIEF Electoral Officer of Telangana, C Sudarshan Reddy, has issued an order to the Commissioner of the Greater Hyderabad Municipal Corporation, the District Education Officer, Hyderabad, and all collectors and DEOs of districts across the state, asking them to "take appropriate action" against individuals who submitted Form 7s to falsely delete eligible voters from the electoral rolls during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

The CEO's memo, issued on Monday, reads, "It has come to the notice of this office that there have been instances of filing bulk applications in Form 7 before the EROs (electoral registration officers) and it is also alleged that such forms are not

genuine."

The memo added that officials, including collectors, DEOs and EROs, should "take action against the applicants, who have made knowingly false statements or declarations in writing in form 6, 6A, 7 and 8 as per the provisions of section 31 of the Representation of People Act 1950". The memo further states that such action shall be preceded by an inquiry under Rule 20 of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

The CEO's instructions come against the backdrop of the Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee's (TPCC) electoral office filing a complaint with the Commissioner of Police, Hyderabad, seeking FIRs over alleged Form 7 misuse.

The first alleged instance of bulk Form 7s in Hyderabad surfaced on October 1, 2026, in Musheerabad constituency.

Pre-printed applications were allegedly filed by a booth-level agent (BLA) of the BJP, seeking the deletion of 31 electors, including a Congress BLA and his family members, the Congress claimed.

In another case, a pre-printed Form 7 surfaced in Bahadurpura constituency. This, too, was flagged by the TPCC. The third instance brought to the notice of the commissioner was from Goshamahahal assembly constituency's booth number 173. "In the Goshamahahal case, the BLO [booth-level officer] refused to accept the bulk pre-printed forms," a TPCC leader claimed.

The Congress is in power in the state. Speaking to *The Indian Express*, a BLO who refused to take in pre-printed Form 7s said, "I was only doing my duty. I brought it to the notice of the ERO."

Right to vote – heart of our democracy – is at great peril, says Rohinton Nariman

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

FORMER SUPREME Court judge Justice Rohinton Fali Nariman has said that the removal of 90 lakh voters from West Bengal's electoral rolls in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and the way the Election Commission functions put the right to vote at "great peril."

"So the first issue I wish to flag today is that the common man today under our Constitution, and if I may say so, the heart of our Constitution, the heart of our democracy, which is the right to vote, is at great peril. And I hope that the Apex Court, an institution to which I once belonged, steps in immediately and rectifies these things. You cannot have an Election Commission which functions or malfunctions like this. It's something amazing," he said.

Justice Nariman was speaking on the subject "The Constitution and the Common Man" at an event at Rajkumar College in Gujarat's Rajkot on Sunday.

"All of you have seen that in the West Bengal election, 90 lakh voters—it's an astounding figure—were disenfranchised," he said. Justice Nariman criticised the Supreme Court for not staying the SIR process. "Now 90 lakh voters getting disenfranchised didn't somehow move the Supreme Court enough to stay this, so that these 90 lakh voters were out when the Bengal election took place," he said. On appeals filed by those left out of the voter list, he said: "Out of those who were disenfranchised, some 22 lakh voters actually filed appeals; the others have all seemed to have accepted — they must be poor people, they must be people who don't have the wherewithal or the access to justice that the others had. And of these 22 lakh voters, some one lakh voter appeals were decided, 93% in favour of the voter."

"So can you imagine, this was a completely illegal knocking out the common man, the citizens of India, in order that a government obtains what it wants, and the result as you saw in West Bengal was something that upset the government of the day and brought in the government of the centre. These are very disturbing," he said.

In his speech, Justice Nariman also referred to *The Indian Express* investigation into the "rupture" inside the Election Commission. "We discover now, thanks to *The Indian Express*, that the two gentlemen on either side of the Chief Election Commissioner voiced objections to



Justice Rohinton Fali Nariman

whatever was going on fourteen times, and somehow or the other they didn't press their right...to say that look, between the three of us, it's the majority vote that counts. So the two of us prevail over you, Chief Election Commissioner. They didn't do that. They were also appointees of the present government," he said.

"Today's newspaper tells us that there is some patch-up between these three gentlemen, to the nation's great detriment, where they have come out with some common statement saying, 'yes, some of the objections you people took seem to be correct, we revert to the old Form 6', and so on and so forth," he said.

An investigation by *The Indian Express* reveals that questions were raised on SIR-related issues within the three-member Election Commission (EC) on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months. The objections were raised by Election Commissioners, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi. The issues raised by the two Commissioners included changes to electoral forms and the handling of documents and data related to the revision of electoral rolls. Gyanesh Kumar is the Chief Election Commissioner.

Justice Nariman said the Constitution's design of the Election Commission is part of the problem. "This Chief Election Commissioner had a fixed tenure of five years, could not be removed unless by impeachment in the same manner as a Supreme Court judge, which meant that you required a two-thirds majority in both Houses (of Parliament) present and voting in order to get rid of him. So it becomes difficult to get rid of, but the difficulty is if the appointment is in the hands of the government of the day, then this removal procedure doesn't add very much to independence or impartiality. This is the first conundrum that we face."

He said the two other commissioners "are also appointed by the government of the day, and they can only be removed with his concurrence, with the Chief Election Commissioner's concurrence."

Student politics returns in Odisha with campus polls after eight years

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, October 5

CAMPUSES ACROSS Odisha are bracing for a fresh bout of political activities after the state government announced the return of students' union polls in degree colleges and universities after eight years on Monday.

Student wings of major political parties such as the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), Biju Chhatra Janata Dal (BCJD) and National Students' Union of India (NSUI) swung into action, reviving their campus networks and stepping up outreach activities.

The students' union polls are also being closely watched by all three major political parties, which see the event as an opportunity to connect with the Gen Z voters, understand their concerns and cultivate their support.

For political parties, success in the campus polls could also be viewed as a measure of their acceptance among young voters and an indication of the extent of support they enjoy among the student community.

According to a notification issued by the state higher education department on Monday, students' union elections will be held in all colleges on Oc-

tober 15. The state's higher education minister, Suryabanshi Suraj, announced the decision following a meeting with chief minister Mohan Charan Majhi.

"The decision to hold campus polls is a key step towards nurturing youth leadership in our state. Reviving campus polls was also one of our major promises in the election manifesto. After our party formed the government, it took us some time to review the situation on campuses. This year, the poll will be held across campuses," said the higher education minister.

The decision to complete the entire process within 10 days has been taken to prevent violence on the campuses, said officials. Campus polls in Odisha were last held in 2017.

The students' wings of various political parties were also demanding the revival of student body polls, with the National Student Union of India — the students wing of the Congress — meeting the higher education minister to demand student body polls.

The decision has also triggered a political slugfest, with BJP spokesperson Anil Biswal criticising the former BJP government for not holding campus polls for a long period.



Rajnath to lay foundation stone for Shakti engine facility in Odisha

Press Trust of India
Koraput, October 5

DEFENCE MINISTER Rajnath Singh is scheduled to lay the foundation stone on Tuesday for a Rs 218-crore new facility linked to Shakti engines at Hindustan Aeronautics Limited's (HAL) Koraput unit in Odisha, an official statement said.

He will also inaugurate a function marking the delivery of the 2,000th aero-engine by HAL Koraput division in the Sunabeda area, it said.

The event, which will also be attended by Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi, will mark nearly six decades of HAL Koraput division's contribution to the country's aerospace and defence manufacturing capabilities and operational readiness of the armed forces, the statement said.

The establishment of a second production line for Shakti engines will add to the capacity of the HAL Koraput division, it said. The Shakti engine programme is a joint Indo-French initiative between HAL and Safran Helicopter Engines.

Bihar SHO suspended after video shows him pointing his service pistol at flood victims

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, October 5

DAYS AFTER a man died during an airdrop of flood relief material from a helicopter in Saran, another video from the district shows the Maker SHO allegedly displaying his service pistol during the distribution of relief material.

The officer, Sangram Kumar Singh, has been suspended with immediate effect, with the police ordering an inquiry into the purported circumstances captured in the video.

The video circulating on social media shows Singh standing on top of one of two pickup vehicles as people appear to queue up in front of the vehicle. At one point, when a person appears to try to pull a bag out of the pickup, the SHO is seen jumping onto the vehicle, warning people to stay back, then briefly pulling out his pistol and pointing it at the group.

In an order issued on October 4, the Saran Senior Superintendent of Police cited the video and said it prima facie re-

ONE NATION, ONE ELECTION BILLS

SC gave its nod on Sept 22, but cancelled meet with House panel later: Chairman

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

THE CHAIRMAN of the Joint Committee of Parliament on One Nation, One Election Bills, P P Chaudhary, on Monday said the Supreme Court on September 22 wrote to the committee confirming a meeting with its members at 4.30 pm on October 6, before deciding to cancel it on October 1 following objections raised to the proposed meeting.

The committee was scheduled to visit the court for a "local study visit", including an "informal discussion" with Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and other judges of the Supreme Court "on the issue of simultaneous elections", as per the programme circulated to the panel members.

Controversy over the proposed meeting erupted last week when Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal addressed a press conference on October 1, calling the meeting "unconstitutional" as the Bills being deliberated by

the committee could someday come before the court for adjudication.

The Supreme Court wrote to the committee on October 1 afternoon, cancelling the meeting, saying the matter was discussed among senior judges and it was felt that it would not be desirable to have the discussion as the Bills may become a subject of judicial review.

Speaking to reporters after a meeting of the Parliamentary committee on Monday, Chaudhary said the meeting was fixed by the Supreme Court after it was suggested by DMK MP and lawyer P Wilson. He said after the Supreme Court wrote to the committee on September 22, fixing the time of the meeting, all members were informed. Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal submitted "material" to the court; the lists of members and officers who would take part in the meeting were also shared.

"After eight or nine days, when some issues were raised publicly, the Supreme Court



PP Chaudhary

felt... it would not be proper to have the meeting, so we also informed the members. If it is not appropriate, then we should not pursue the matter," Chaudhary said. He added that committees of Parliament had interacted with the Supreme Court in the past.

Earlier in the day, the matter is learnt to have come up in the meeting of the committee. Wilson is learnt to have read out a letter explaining the matter. The DMK MP is learnt to have said that he had suggested the meeting with the court in the interest of broad-based consulta-

tion. He is learnt to have noted that the meeting could not take place due to political objections.

Wilson is learnt to have said that seeking the judges' informal views cannot amount to seeking adjudication from the court. He is also learnt to have cited past examples, including when the draft Constitution was circulated to seek views from judges in 1948, as well as some recent examples, including meetings of Parliamentary committees with judges regarding the Mediation Bill, virtual courts and National Legal Services Authority.

Congress MP Manish Tewari is learnt to have said the decision to consult the Supreme Court was a grave error, given that the Bills could end up before the court. After Wilson made his point that such meetings had been held in the past, Tewari is learnt to have asked why then was the meeting cancelled.

The committee is also learnt to have held interactions with Chief Economic Advisor V An-

antha Nageswaran, Chairman, Economic Advisory Council to Prime Minister, S Mahendra Dev and Vivekananda International Foundation chairman S Gurumurthy. They are learnt to have supported the idea of simultaneous elections. The CEA, it is learnt, told the committee that frequent elections bring the focus on revenue expenditure instead of capital expenditure, and can lead to policy paralysis. Gurumurthy is learnt to have flagged that frequent elections lead to the creation of paid party workers and use of money power in elections, as opposed to voluntary cadres.

The committee is examining the Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024, and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024, that were introduced in December 2024. The Bills provide for a one-time curtailment of terms of state Assemblies to align with that of the Lok Sabha to pave the way for a simultaneous election to the Lok Sabha and all Assemblies.

1 killed in strike on Turkish vessel with Indian crew

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

AT LEAST one person was killed while 11 were rescued from a Turkish-owned civilian cargo vessel following a Russian drone strike in the Black Sea. The vessel was carrying Indian and Azerbaijani citizens, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Monday.

"A horrific strike by two Russian drones on a civilian vessel in neutral waters carrying corn and owned by Turkiye," he said

in a post on X. "Azerbaijani and Indian citizens were on board. As of now, unfortunately, we know that the ship's captain was killed. My condolences. The fate of one other person is still being established," he said. Zelenskyy said 11 crew members were rescued; one of them was injured.

He said Ukraine has repeatedly proposed concrete steps to de-escalate the situation and ensure security in the Black Sea. "Pressure is needed to restore global food security," he said in the post.

The Indian embassy in Romania posted on X: "We have learnt of an attack today on commercial vessel MV ROYAD MAMMADOV in the Black Sea." "As per preliminary information, there have been 2 casualties (foreign nationals) while some crew members have been injured and are undergoing medical treatment in Romania. It is further

reported that there are three Indian nationals among the crew members," it said.

The Mission is in close contact with the relevant authorities to ascertain further details about the safety and welfare of the Indian nationals, it said.

The Black Sea is a critical global trade choke point facing severe disruption due to escalating attacks.

IN REMEMBRANCE

Corps of Signals salutes its Signallers who left us for their heavenly abode during the month of Sep 2026.

(1)	JC-391212P	Subedar	Yeshbir Singh
(2)	15703841M	Hav	Pankaj Kumar

Deeply mourned by Lt Gen Vivek Dogra, SM, SO-in-C, Col Comdt and all ranks of Corps of Signals.

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL, MEDICAL EDUCATION & TRAINING

2nd Floor, Kisan Bazar, Vibhuti Khand, Gomitnagar - 226 010, UP

No. ME-3/II/817622/2026 Lucknow, Dated: 05.10.2026

THE SCHEDULE OF "THIRD ROUND" OF ONLINE COUNSELING FOR UP NEET MDS-2026

In continuation of the time-table issued by Medical Counseling Committee (MCC), New Delhi for counseling of NEET MDS course, the time-table of third round of online counseling for admission of state quota seats of MDS course in Government / Private Dental Colleges / Universities of the State is as follows:

Sl#	Description	Dates
1.	Date of online registration	06 October, 2026 (From 11:00 am) to 08 October, 2026 (Till 11:00 am)
2.	Date of depositing registration and security Fee	06 October, 2026 (From 11:00 am) to 08 October, 2026 (Till 02:00 pm)
3.	Date of Declaration of Merit List	08 October, 2026
4.	Date of Online Choice Filling	08 October, 2026 (From 5:00 pm) to 12 October, 2026 (Till 11:00 am)
5.	Date of Declaration of result of seat allotment	12 October, 2026
6.	Downloading allotment Letters and Admission Process	13 October, 2026 to 17 October, 2026

All information related to UP NEET MDS 2026 counseling will be uploaded on Departmental website <https://upneet.gov.in> and www.dgme.up.gov.in

Help Line Numbers: 8189011696, 8189011697, 8189011698, 8189011699, 8189011700

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN on the instructions of our client who intends to acquire from M/s MSS Infracon Private Limited ("Owner") the commercial premises situated on the (i) Upper Ground Floor measuring 1703 square feet (covered area) and (ii) Lower Ground Floor measuring 27,090 square feet (covered area) in aggregate measuring 28,793 square feet ("Premises") situated at Tower A and B ("Building") known as "Bliss Homes and Bliss Square" ("Project") - constructed on Plot No. ML-1 measuring 12,620 Sq. Mtrs, Karpooti Puram, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh ("Plot") ; along with (A) right to exclusively use (i) the designated car parking spaces which includes 10 (ten) stack parking spaces (i.e 10*2 = 20 parking spaces) and 20 (twenty) single parking spaces and 45 (forty five) bike parking spaces in First Basement of Tower A and Tower B (ii) designated car parking spaces which includes 20 (twenty) stack parking spaces (i.e 20*2 = 40 parking spaces) and 55 (fifty five) bike parking spaces in Second Basement of Tower A and Tower B in aggregate 180 (One Hundred And Eighty) parking spaces (ii) Loading and Unloading Area on Upper Ground Floor (iii) Hoarding and Signages at designated places (iv) Exclusive 4 Lifts including 3 Nos Goods Lift and 1 Nos Passenger Lift (v) Exclusive ODU Space at designated Place (vi) Bin Wash Area (vii) Designated Loading/Unloading Parking Area (viii) Uninterrupted Entry/Exit and (B) rights to use in common with other occupants of the Building, the (i) Common Parking Areas in the basements (ii) Common entry/exit points (iii) Common Escalator (iv) Common Driveway (v) Common Atrium (vi) Common Corridor (vii) Common Ramp (viii) Common Staircases (ix) Common Lift (x) Common Driver's Toilet (xi) Common Area and (xii) Existing Otia and other common areas of Building ("Said Appurtenant Areas") along with (C) the undivided and impartible proportionate share in the Plot and (D) undivided rights and share in the Common Areas of the Plot along with all rights and easements whatsoever necessary for the enjoyment of the Building. The Premises and Said Appurtenant Areas are collectively referred to as "Said Property"

The Plot is butted and bounded as follows:
On or towards north- 12 meters wide road;
On or towards south- Others' Land
On or towards west- Delhi Marathoma School
On or towards east- 45 meters wide road.

Any entity / person having or claiming any right, title, claim, benefit, demand or interest with respect to the Said Property or having any objection to the title over the Said Property of the Land owner or if any entity / person has any knowledge of or is party to any sale, agreement, exchange, assignment, charge, gift, license, lease, tenancy, inheritance, maintenance, lien, mortgage, hypothecation, encumbrance, pending litigation, possession, easement, trust, contract/agreement, development rights, partnership, family arrangement/settlement, decree or order of any Court, acquisition by Government or any other entity, prohibition or any other impediment or restriction with respect to the Said Property, then such entity / person should inform us in writing with documentary proof on the address mentioned below within a period of 14 (Fourteen) days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it shall be presumed that no adverse right, title, interest, share, claim, benefit or demand of any nature whatsoever exists in or upon or in respect of the Said Property and the Landowner is in unencumbered possession of and is vested with absolute, clear and marketable right, title and interest to the Said Property.

Dated: October 6, 2026

M/s Desai & Diwanji
Advocates & Solicitors
16th Floor, Tower C, Building No.5 (DLF Epitome)
DLF Phase - III, Gurugram - 122002

Centre clears the elevation of three High Court Chief Justices as SC judges

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, October 5

THREE NEW judges were appointed to the Supreme Court on Monday, taking its working strength to 37, one short of the sanctioned 38.

According to Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal, Justice Sunita Agarwal, Chief Justice, Gujarat High Court; Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya, Chief Justice, Delhi High Court; and Justice Aparesk Kumar Singh, Chief Justice, Telangana High Court, have been elevated as top court judges. Meghwal made the announcement in a social media post.

The Supreme Court Collegium had recommended the names on September 28.

While the current working strength of the apex court is 34, once the three new judges formally take the oath, its effective strength will go up to 37.

The top court's sanctioned strength is 38 judges, including the Chief Justice of India.

With Justice Sunita Agarwal's appointment, the number of women judges in the top court has gone up to three, including Justice B V Nagarathna, who has been a judge in the top court since August 31, 2021, and Justice Venkita Subramani Mohana, who was appointed on June 2, 2026.

While Justice Agarwal and Justice Nagarathna have a background of serving in high courts, Justice Mohana was elevated directly from the Bar. She had been a Senior Advocate of the Supreme Court. Justice Nagarathna will also become the Chief Justice of India for more than a month in 2027.

Of the three judges appointed on Monday, Justices Agarwal and Upadhyay are originally from the Allahabad High Court, while Justice Singh originally belongs to the Jharkhand HC.

GOVERNMENT OF NCT OF DELHI
DELHI SUBORDINATE SERVICES
SELECTION BOARD (D.S.S.S.B)
FC-18, INSTITUTIONAL AREA, KARKARDOOMA,
DELHI-110092
Website: <https://dsssb.delhi.gov.in>

No.F.1(452)/P&P/DSSSB/2026/Advt./5122 Dated: 30.09.2026

VACANCY NOTICE
ADVERTISEMENT NO. 04/2026

Online Applications are invited from the eligible candidates for the posts of Senior Personal Assistant, Personal Assistant, Junior Judicial Assistant, Process Server & Peon/ Orderly/Dak Peon under District & Sessions Courts and Family Courts as detailed below: -

Total number of Post Codes /Vacancies	04 Post Codes/641 Vacancies
Date of Commencement of Online Applications	6th October, 2026
Last date of Online Application Submission	4th November, 2026

The eligible candidates are advised to visit DSSSB's website <https://dsssb.delhi.gov.in/dsssb-vacancies> to check the detailed advertisement and confirm their eligibility for the above vacancies based on the Recruitment Rules of the indenting department. Candidates must apply online through the website <https://dsssonline.nic.in/>. The closing date for submission of online application is up to 04/11/2026 (Till 11:00 PM) after which the link will be disabled.

Sd/-
Deputy Secretary (P&P)

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Email Id-ed-abpmjay@jharkhandmail.gov.in

राज्यकर्मि स्वास्थ्य बीमा योजना
(पैंशनर / बोर्ड -निगम / विश्वविद्यालय संबधित कैटेगरी "B" के लिए आवश्यक सूचना)
सूचना संख्या - 03 (चिठ) AB-MMJAY-04/2025-1040 राँची / दिनांक:-01-10-2026

राज्यकर्मि स्वास्थ्य बीमा योजना अंतर्गत बीमा वर्ष मई 2026 से अप्रैल 2027 तक बीमा योजना का लाभ प्राप्त करने हेतु योजना के कैटेगरी "B" अंतर्गत आने वाले सभी लाभुकों के लिए योजना में Enrollment करने हेतु योजना संबंधित पोर्टल <https://sehis.jharkhand.gov.in> को सूचना प्रकाशन की तिथि से 01 माह तक सक्रिय किया जा रहा है। अतः इच्छुक लाभुक योजना के पोर्टल पर अपना Enrollment कर सकते हैं। आवेदक के संबंधित DDO/ Verifying Officer के द्वारा Online सत्यापन होने के पश्चात् निर्धारित प्रीमियम का भुगतान योजना के पोर्टल पर Online Payment के माध्यम से किया जा सकता है।

वैसे पैंशनर लाभुक जो पिछले वर्ष योजना में सम्मिलित थे परन्तु इस वर्ष में अभी तक अपने दैनिक प्रीमियम का भुगतान नहीं किया है, वैसे लाभुक भी अपना दैनिक प्रीमियम जमा कर सकते हैं। प्रीमियम राशि 6,000 रुपये (एकमुश्त) योजना पोर्टल <https://sehis.jharkhand.gov.in> पर Payment Gateway के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन उक्त निर्धारित समय तक किया जा सकता है। अधिक जानकारी के लिए योजना के पोर्टल से प्राप्त की जा सकती है साथ ही टोल फ्री नं० 1800-3455-027 पर भी सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

हठ / -
अपर कार्यकारी निदेशक,
जसार्स

PR 391156 Jharkhand State Arogya Society (26-27) D"

MADHAVA MENON MEMORIAL LECTURE

Justice Nath: 'A judge must be impartial, but never indifferent'

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

JUDGES ARE not appointed to be charitable, and compassion in adjudication "is not favour and it is not leniency," Supreme Court judge Justice Vikram Nath said while delivering the second Prof. (Dr) N R Madhava Menon Memorial Lecture in New Delhi on Monday.

He said, "Impartiality and indifference are not the same thing. The blind fold on Lady Justice does not mean she cannot see. It means she does not look at who stands before her before deciding what is right. She still weighs and weighs with care. A judge must be impartial but never indifferent."

Justice Nath, who is also the executive chairman of the National Legal Services Authority, delivered the annual lecture on the topic 'Judging with Compassion: Human Understanding in the Practice of Law'. Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant inaugurated the session.

Justice Nath also said courts must pay attention to how those who pass through the system experience justice.

"For the survivor made to relive her trauma in the witness box, or the litigant who cannot follow the language of the proceedings, the process is what justice actually feels like," he said. "We must ask whether, for too many, it has itself become a trauma," he said.



Justice Vikram Nath

The SC judge also highlighted that courts must see the gap between "formal equality" and "experienced equality." He gave the example of undertrial grants bail on identical conditions, where one walks out and another stays in prison because he cannot furnish sureties. "On paper, the law treated them equally. In life, it did not."

During his address, CJI Kant underlined the importance of legal scholarship saying that while courts hear individual disputes, research helps show how judicial decisions affect people's lives long after a case is over.

"The scholar who follows the victim beyond the courtroom, asking whether the compensation is actually paid, whether a brief family receives the support it needs, and whether victims are truly hurt...it is scholarship that gathers those 10,000 orders into one picture...and shows us whom our well-meant judgments may have left behind," CJI Kant said.

MUMBAI PORT AUTHORITY
मुंबई पोर्टन प्राधिकरण
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

RFP No. CET - 77/2026 | GLOBAL INVITATION | PPP - DBFOT

Mumbai Port Authority under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Govt. of India, invites online proposals from eligible Indian / international developers / joint ventures for

Development of World-Class Full-Service Viksit Bharat Mumbai Marina and Integrated Waterfront Assets, Mumbai on Design, Build, Finance, Operate and Transfer (DBFOT) basis.

Operation and maintenance of 424 wet berths developed by Port (Further development to 696 berths by Concessionaire)

39.86 ha Protected Water area + 7.30 ha Onshore

₹922 Cr Estimated Project cost

45 years concession period

Marina Facilities

• Marina terminal, Marina club, sailing school, dry stack and repair yard.
• Supporting infrastructure: 5-Star Hotel and Tourism Business Centre.
• Total Permissible Built-up Area - 1,06,000 sqm.

Location

Opposite the Domestic Cruise Terminal, with access via the Eastern Freeway and Atal Setu.

Bid documents available from	Pre-bid meeting	Last date for bid submission
12.10.2026	27.10.2026	25.11.2026

Bids to be submitted online only at www.eprocure.gov.in. Tender documents can be downloaded from www.mumbaiport.gov.in and www.eprocure.gov.in.

Chief Engineer, MbPA, Port House, Shoorji Vallabhdas Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai - 400 001 | Email: chiefengineer@mbpa.mumbaiport.gov.in | Tel: 022-6656 4031

Corrigenda / addenda, if any, will be published only on the above websites and not in newspapers.

BIHAR SCHOOL EXAMINATION BOARD
NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER
Tender Notice No. : PR 233/2026

Bihar School Examination Board invites e-tenders/proposals under the Two-Bid System from reputed, experienced Firms/ Companies/Agencies/Societies for "Scanning of Package 1 & 2 and Finalization of Data for Intermediate, Matric and other examination as per decision of BSEB". Detailed RFP document containing eligibility criteria, scope of work, and other terms and conditions are available on the website <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>.

Tender Schedule

Date and Time for Activity	Date/Time: Duration
Online Sale/ Download Date of Tender Documents	From: 07/10/2026 (16:00 Hrs.) to 28/10/2026 (16:00 Hrs.) (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Pre-Bid Meeting	13/10/2026 at 12:30 Hrs. (Bihar School Examination Board, Sinha Library Road, Patna-800017)
Last Date/ Time for Submission/ uploading of Online Bid	28/10/2026 up to 16:00 Hrs. (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Last Date and Time for submission of EMD in Hard Copy/ Original (Only in case of BG)	29/10/2026 up to 13:00 Hrs.
Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid and Live Demonstration & Presentation	29/10/2026 at 15:00 Hrs (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Date, Time and Venue for Opening of Financial Bids	Date to be announced later by Competent Authority.
Cost of the Tender Document	₹5,900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Tender Processing Fee	₹5,900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Earnest Money	₹10,00,000/- (Ten Lakh Rupees only) (Refundable)

• Contact Details: Nodal Officer, Mobile No.: +91 6299923095, E-Mail ID: eproc-bseb-bih@gov.in/ eproc.bseb@gmail.com

• Note: Bihar School Examination Board reserves the right to accept/ cancel/ reschedule tenders without assigning any reasons. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>. Corrigendum/ Amendments etc., if any, will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.

Secretary

epaper.indianexpress.com

Plaque in tribute to Express group founder unveiled at Nariman Point in Mumbai

Express News Service
Mumbai, October 5

A MARBLE plaque built in tribute to the founder of The Indian Express Group of newspapers, Ramnath Goenka, was inaugurated on Monday by Bombay High Court judge Somasekhar Sundaresan at Mumbai's Nariman Point, where the newspaper's office is located.

The plaque commemorates the memory of Ramnath Goenka who launched *The Indian Express* in 1932 and ensured it became a fearless, credible and fiercely independent newspaper. Anant Goenka, Executive Director, *The Indian Express* Group, was present at the event organised on the founder's 35th death anniversary.

Built in Makrana marble, the plaque is installed on Ramnath Goenka Marg, a street that links Maharashtra Vidhan Bhavan to the Vinay K Shah Road in Nariman Point. The road was named after *The Indian Express* founder after former Mumbai mayor and senior Congress leader from Mulund, Ramcharitra Rambhajan Singh, on September 13, 1993, cleared a request submitted by former corporator Vijaya Kanti Dhulla.

Two years after the BMC's decision, the road was officially named as Freedom Fighter Ramnath Goenka Marg on November 25, 1995. It was inaugurated by then Vice-President K R Narayanan, with then Chief Minister Manohar Joshi and municipal commissioner JD Jadhav.

The name of the lane has now been engraved upon the



Bombay HC judge Justice Somasekhar Sundaresan with Anant Goenka, Executive Director of The Indian Express Group, during the plaque inauguration at Nariman Point on Monday. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

new plaque along with Goenka's portrait and his words that define the newspaper's motto of "Journalism of Courage".

The plaque of 8.5 feet width and 12.5 feet height, was constructed over four months. "While the plaque was constructed in four months, the intricate engravings were executed over a period of 25 days. The plaque rests on a platform, which takes the total height of the structure to 14

feet," said urban planner Hardik Sankhe, who worked on its design. The project work was executed by the contractor, Aditya Interiors.

The final nod for constructing the commemorative plaque was granted by the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation's A ward office in July 2025, following which permissions from traffic police, BEST and the Mumbai Heritage Conservation Committee were obtained.

District authorities considering new SOPs to divert traffic to a bypass

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, October 5

FOR KILOMETRES, cars crawled through the Kumaon hills towards Kainchi Dham over the long weekend, bumper-to-bumper on the mountain road. Pilgrims got out and walked along the roadside and families waited for hours, while vehicles heading towards Mukteshwar were caught in the same gridlock as those arriving for *darshan*.

Videos circulating online showed long lines of cars, buses and two-wheelers around Bhimtal, Bhowali and Kainchi, with reports of journeys that ordinarily take a few hours stretching much longer.

The congestion has prompted the Nainital administration to consider opening an alternative route to ease pressure on Kainchi Dham.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Nainital District Magistrate Lalit Mohan said that the administration is considering a new standard operating procedure (SOP) under which a bypass connecting the Kainchi area towards Almora and Ranikhet could be opened to divert traffic.

The district administration will meet temple authorities, police and other stakeholders on Tuesday to finalise crowd-control measures, he said.

"We usually expect about 25,000 people visiting the

shrine every day, but this weekend, since October 2, we have seen a crowd of more than 35,000 every day. Both the pilgrims and the locals use the same road to Kainchi, which also goes up to Mukteshwar, causing a traffic jam for hours," Lalit Mohan said.

He said traffic had been cleared from the Mukteshwar side on Sunday.

Mohan attributed the surge to two factors: the end of the monsoon, when travellers who had avoided the hills because of rain and landslides return, and the release of *Hanuman Ansh*, the film based on the life and teachings of Neem Karoli Baba.

When *The Indian Express* reported on Kainchi Dham last month, Hanuman Ansh, made on a reported budget of Rs 2 crore, had grossed around Rs 300 crore worldwide. Its success has introduced Neem Karoli Baba, who died in 1973, to a younger audience.

It is learnt that 24.34 lakh people visited Kainchi Dham in the first half of 2026, against around eight lakh visitors last year. The surge has even prompted *Hanuman Ansh* director Vishal Chaturvedi to urge devotees to check the situation before travelling to Kainchi Dham. "There is a huge crowd at Kainchi Dham at the moment... we should all check the situation there before going," he said, adding that visi-

EXPRESS special

Kainchi Dham drowns in tourists after *Hanuman Ansh* film's release



Heavy traffic on the route towards Nainital, Bhimtal and Kainchi Dham on Saturday. ANI

tors should avoid a situation where "children and women in your family are suffocating in the crowd or are stuck in a traffic jam". He also suggested that devotees consider other sites associated with Neem Karoli Baba if Kainchi remains overcrowded.

The proposed diversion comes as Uttarakhand is already building an 18.15-km Kainchi Dham bypass from Sanatorium to Ratighat. Eight km were completed and hot-mixed earlier this year, and hill-cutting on another 10.15 km is done too.

A motor bridge is also being built to connect the bypass with the Bhowali-Almora highway. The state has separately built the Bhowali bypass and a 30-metre double-lane bridge over the Shipra River to ease congestion.

The state's Public Works Department has also identified the Talla Ramgarh-Ratighat road as an alternative route connecting Kainchi with Ram-

garh, Mukteshwar, Lohaghat and Champawat, saying its strengthening could significantly reduce traffic pressure.

A state planning document notes that Uttarakhand receives tourists equivalent to roughly 300 per cent of its resident population, compared with 185 per cent in Himachal Pradesh, and warns that hill destinations once known for walking and trekking are increasingly being "choked by vehicles".

The National Green Tribunal has on record a scientific carrying-capacity study covering major pilgrimages sites including Kedarnath, Hemkund Sahib, Gangotri and Yamunotri.

Kainchi has had its own carrying-capacity study. A Tourism Department study conducted in 2025 found that 64 per cent of devotees came only for *darshan* and returned the same day, while 82.4 per cent were from outside Uttarakhand. Nearly two-thirds were aged between 15 and 30. Park-

ing was the biggest infrastructure complaint, with 74 per cent of respondents dissatisfied with parking facilities.

At the temple, authorities said the situation remained manageable.

An employee with Kainchi Dham's accounts section said authorities have deployed additional police personnel inside and outside the temple.

"The crowd has swelled due to the long weekend... So far it has been managed all right," he said. By Monday, the immediate crisis had eased.

Dheeraj Tiwari, 27, who runs his family's business beside the temple entrance, said the worst congestion lasted a day or two. "The administration has now cleared everything out. Today everything looks normal. It was the long weekend that created a lot of flow of pilgrims," he said.

For residents, however, the problem is measured differently. Mani Bharadwaj, who formerly worked at Hotel Monal, about 500 metres from the shrine, and lives in Bhowali, said, "When thousands of vehicles are stuck on the same road, it affects everyone—people going to work, bringing supplies, travelling for medical needs or simply trying to get home. Locals have no separate road. The same infrastructure has to serve pilgrims and local residents. Every time there is a huge rush, locals bear the disruption. There needs to be a permanent solution rather than waiting for every long weekend and then putting more police on the roads."

Hours after rescue, lioness that attacked 5 persons in Gujarat dies; rabies suspected

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, October 5

A LIONESS has died of suspected rabies in Gujarat's Amreli district after it was rescued last week following separate attacks on five persons - four villagers and a forest department officer. Samples of its brain tissues have been sent to Anand Agriculture University for confirmation, a senior forest department officer said Monday.

Meanwhile, all the injured have been administered anti-rabies vaccine as per standard medical protocol, officers said.

The lioness — aged 2-3 years — was rescued on October 2 from Arjunsukh village in Amreli after it injured the five in separate incidents.

The lioness was later shifted to Krankach Animal Care Centre, where it showed "unusual behaviour", such as biting and unusual vocalisations.

Within around 20 hours of its rescue, the lioness died at the centre on October 3, forest officers said.

Deputy Conservator of Forests, Shetrunji Wildlife Division, Chirag Amin said that primary symptoms indicated that the cause of death may have been rabies, but added that this could be confirmed only after scientific tests.

Amin said there was "no cause for worry" so far, as the

lioness was solitary and there were no other instances of any other lion showing similar symptoms.

Another senior forest officer said a lion can get infected with rabies if it consumes or bites an animal infected by the virus. Similarly, if an infected animal drinks water from a waterbody and then the lion also drinks water from the same waterbody, it can cause transmission of the virus to the big cat.

10,107 women candidates cleared JEE Advanced 2026, highest in six years

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, October 5

FOR THE first time in six years, the number of women candidates qualifying the JEE Advanced crossed the 10,000 mark in 2026, shows the Joint Implementation Committee (JIC) report by IIT Roorkee, which conducted the JEE Advanced this year.

According to the JIC report, a total of 43,112 female candidates registered for JEE Advanced. Of these, 40,562 appeared in both papers and 10,107 qualified. The success rate among registered women candidates rose from 21.7% in

• RISE & SHINE

Year	Female candidates who registered for JEE Advanced	Those who qualified
2021	34,525	6,452
2022	35,124	6,516
2023	43,596	7,509
2024	42,947	7,964
2025	43,413	9,404
2026	43,112	10,107



2025 to 23.4% this year. One in four registered women candidates qualified this year, compared with roughly one in five last year.

The top female candidate scored 280 marks (mathematics: 101, physics: 86, chemistry: 93), securing All India Rank 77. Among the 3,814 female students who got admission, 37 secured seats through the gender-neutral pool, the report said.

The qualification rate for Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) candidates also saw a sharp jump of 9.8 and 8.1 percentage points, respectively, from last year. In 2026, a total of 15,856 SC candidates and 6,379 ST candidates qualified in JEE Advanced, whereas last year it was 12,499 and 5,008, respectively.

The number of Economically Weaker Section (EWS) candidates qualifying the entrance exam also went up from 6,291 to 6,377.

The report also shows a decline in the number of general category candidates qualifying for the entrance exam this year. Last year, a total of 16,154 students from the gen-

eral category qualified the exam. The number dropped to 15,883 this year, with the qualification rate declining from 43% to 39.8%.

For OBC (non-creamy layer) candidates, the qualification rate declined from 18.2% to 17.5%, while the number of qualifiers fell from 12,606 to 12,385.

The JEE (Advanced) 2026 was held on May 17 in two sessions. A total of 1,87,389 candidates registered for JEE (Advanced), and 1,79,694 appeared for both papers. Of those who appeared, 56,880 candidates qualified.

"It was decided that category-wise, the top 2,50,000 candidates would be short-listed from JEE (Main) 2026 to be eligible to appear in JEE (Advanced) 2026. Due to the bunching of percentiles, a total of 2,50,174 candidates (excluding 394 foreign and 2,058 OCI/PIO candidates) from JEE (Main) 2026 were declared eligible for JEE (Advanced) 2026," the report said.

"The qualifying criteria were relaxed to ensure at least twice the number of candidates qualify as compared to available seats in each category," the report said.

Further, the highest number of seats have been allotted in IIT Kharagpur - 1,952, followed by IIT BHU - 1,590, IIT Bombay - 1,366, IIT Roorkee - 1,357, IIT Delhi - 1,251, IIT Kanpur - 1,241, IIT Dhanbad - 1,215 and IIT Madras - 1,122.

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, राँची। सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना।



नाम—अनिशा उरॉव, उम्र—26 वर्ष, उँचाई—4 फीट 5 इंच, रंग—गोरा, पहनावा—पिक रंग का सलवार सूट पहनी हुई है।

उपरोक्त लापता महिला अनिशा उरॉव, उम्र—26 वर्ष, पति—रंजित उरॉव, सा0—कुल्लू, पो0—बेयासी, थाना—नरकोपी, जिला—राँची जो दिनांक—06.04.2026 को अपने घर से बगैर बताए कहीं चली गईं जो आज तक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई हैं। जिसके संबंध में नरकोपी थाना सनहा सं0—14/2026, दिनांक—18.09.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता महिला कहीं मिलती/दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।
Email ID: (mc-dcb@jhpolice.gov.in)
—9431728777
—9431706146
थाना प्रभारी, नरकोपी, राँची।
—8809209117

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, राँची।

PR 391124 Police(26-27)D

कार्यालय, माध्यमिक शिक्षा मण्डल मध्यप्रदेश, भोपाल
E-mail : mpbse@mp.nic.in, Website : www.mpbse.nic.in
कार्यालय : (0755) 2551166-71, फ़ैक्स : (0755) 2554398, 2552061
क्रमांक 1149/भवन/2026 भोपाल, दिनांक 05.10.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Bids are invited for "Supply of Furniture and other material for Model School Rewa"
Tender in two-bid system are invited from interested bidder for Supply of Furniture and other material
Tender in two-bid system are invited from GeM Portal <https://gem.gov.in/>. Aspiring Bidders/suppliers who have not enrolled/registered in e-procurement should enroll/register before participating through the website <https://gem.gov.in/>. The portal enrolment is free of cost.
Bidders can access tender documents on the website, fill them with all relevant information and submit the completed tender document through electronic tender on the website <https://gem.gov.in/> Tender and supporting documents should be uploaded through the portal. Hard copy of the tender documents will not be accepted.
For any query/clarification, you may contact the concerned officials,
Tender Publishing Date : 07.10.2026 Time 05:00 PM
Bid Submission Start Date & Time : 08.10.2026 Time 05:00 PM
Bid Submission Closing Date & Time : 28.10.2026 Time 06:00 PM
Technical Bid Opening Date : 29.10.2026 Time 03:00 PM
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NOTICE INVITING E- TENDER
CONCOR invites E-Tender in Single Packet System of tendering for the following work:

Tender No.	CON/Aree-1/EP/PLH-AHH/CC-PNV/E-103763/Y-2/2026-27
Name of Work	Supplying and laying of M50 CC BLOCK Pavement between Line No. 3 & 4 for cargo handling PLATFORM at MMLP Ahmedgarh (PLH)
Estimated Cost	Rs. 906.35 Lakhs (including GST)
Completion Period	09 (Nine Months)
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 10,12,700/- (through e-payment).
Cost of Tender Document	NIL
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	Rs. 3,540/- (inclusive all taxes & duties through e-payment)
Date of sale of Tender (online)	06.10.2026 (from 15:00 hrs.) to 27.10.2026 (up to 17:00 hrs.)
Date & Time of submission of Tender (online)	28.10.2026 up to 17:00 hrs.
Date & Time of Opening of Tender (online)	30.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

For financial eligibility criteria, experience with respect to similar nature of work, etc, please refer to detailed tender notice available on website www.concorindia.com, but the complete tender document can be downloaded from website www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL only. Further, Corrigendum / Addendum to this tender, if any, will be published on website www.concorindia.com, www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL and Central Procurement Portal (CPP) only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same. Group General Manager (Projects), Phone No. 011-41222590

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF POLICE RAJ JAIPUR
V-150/PS/SAMGR/MPF/Tender/2026-27/12946 DATED-27.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING BIDS
NIB NO. POL2627A0023

Bids for Many Items of estimated value INR 13,12,44,000/- are invited from interested bidders S.No. 1, 2 & 3 up to 21.10.2026 and S.No. 04, 05 & 06 dated 08.10.2026 at 11.00 am. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>) (<https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/>) of the state, and <https://www.police.rajasthan.gov.in> UBN.

Drone	POL2627GLOB00027
Computer	POL2627GLOB00028
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Portahutis (10-15 Person)	POL2627GLOB00030
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PUBLIC NOTICE
MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, FARIDABAD
Precautionary directions regarding safety of buildings and structures
In view of the risk of accidents/collapse arising from old, dilapidated, abandoned or unsafe buildings/structures and buildings/structures under construction, repair or demolition, all concerned owners, occupiers, builders, contractors and other persons shall be responsible to take immediate and necessary safety measures. For this purpose, teams of officers/officials of this Corporation have also been deputed to inspect and ensure the structural safety and stability of all buildings/structures falling in the area of this Corporation and take necessary action as contained in office order No. MCF/PS/2026/1262, dated 1-10-2026 which letter has been uploaded on MCF-ULB website.

Sd/-
Joint Commissioner
For Commissioner
Municipal Corporation,
Faridabad.
No. 49937/HRV

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA
NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)
E-mail ID: ccbuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in
ccbuildings@rediffmail.com Tel. -(0674)-2391523

File No- B-I-Rev.-01/2026 Lr. No. 36734 Bhubaneswar, dtd. 3rd Oct., 2026
1st Corrigendum

Bid Identification No. CE-Bldg-138/2026-27
Name of the Works: "Construction of Annex Building with Training, Administrative Support Facilities and 500 Seater Auditorium of ROTI, Gopabandha, Bhubaneswar on Turkey Basis".

The following changes have been made in Bid Identification No. CE-Bldg-138/2026-27
Bid documents can be seen / downloaded from the Govt. Website i.e. www.tendersorissa.gov.in, during the period dt.12.10.2026 to 17.30 hours of dt.02.11.2026 instead of dt.05.10.2026 to 17.30 hours of dt.26.10.2026 for ONLINE BIDDING respectively.

- A pre-bid meeting shall be held on dt.22.11.2026 at 11:30 AM at the Conference Hall of Office of the Chief Engineer (Buildings-I), Odisha, Nirman Soudha, Unit-V, Bhubaneswar instead of dt. 13.10.2026.
- Online bids shall be received upto 17.30 Hours of dt.02.11.2026 instead of dt.26.10.2026.
- Hardcopy shall be received on or before dt.06.11.2026 up to 17.30 Hours by this office instead of dt.30.10.2026.
- The technical bids will be opened at 11.30 A.M. of dt.07.11.2026 instead of dt.31.10.2026.

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Engineer-in-Chief (Civil)
(I/c) Chief Engineer, Buildings-I, Odisha, Bhubaneswar
OIIPR- 34001/34117/1/26-27/0081

NORTHERN RAILWAY E-AUCTION NOTICE
No: C-12/San/SWM/2026 Dated: 05.10.2026
Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<http://ireps.gov.in/>) for Solid Waste Management at following 27 Nominated Railway stations/locations:

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
SWM-DL/Div-28-1	Dated 21.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs	SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT AT RAILWAY STATIONS OVER DELHI DIVISION- CONTRACT FOR COLLECTION, TRANSPORTATION, RECYCLING AND SCIENTIFIC PROCESSING OF SEGREGATED WET, DRY RECYCLABLE, SANITARY, SPECIAL-CARE AND INERT WASTE AT 27 DESIGNATED BULK WASTE GENERATOR (BWG) RAILWAY STATIONS OVER DELHI DIVISION NAMELY NEW DELHI, DELHI, HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN, ANAND VIHAR, DELHI SARAI ROHILLA, GHAZIABAD, MEERUT CITY, MUZAFFARNAGAR, DELHI CANTT, PANIPAT, SONIPAT, ROHTAK, GURGAON, FARIDABAD, KARNAL, KURUKSHETRA, SAHIBABAD, BAHADURGARH, PALWAL, SHAKURBASTI, SUBZI MANDI, GANAU, NARELA, BALLABHGARH, DELHI SADAR BAZAR, BADLI & FARIDABAD NEW TOWN OVER DELHI DIVISION FOR A PERIOD OF 05 YEARS, IN ACCORDANCE WITH SOP FOR SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT RULES, 2026 ISSUED BY RAILWAY BOARD, Total 27 Railway Stations of Delhi Division

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen <https://ireps.gov.in/>

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfill following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module - Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module • Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions. • Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender / E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: sanitationcell@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084
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Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS Northern Railway, Delhi Division
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3448/26

Punjab: Student among four killed as bus overturns

Chandigarh: A bus overturned in Punjab's Shaheed Bhagat Singh Nagar district on Monday, leaving four people, including a student, dead and 17 others injured, police said.

The bus was on its way from Manali to Amritsar when the accident occurred after the driver apparently lost control over the vehicle, a police official said. The bus was carrying around 40 passengers who were mostly students, Pargat Singh, Station House Officer (SHO) of Sadar Banga police station said.

"Four people, including a student of a private university, were killed and 17 others sustained injuries. Two to three injured have been referred to a hospital in Ludhiana," SHO Singh said. PTI

7-year-old dies in Andhra after anti-malaria dose, SC asks HC to monitor probe

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, October 5

IN THE last week of August, a seven-year-old girl was handed out an anti-malaria tablet in Andhra Pradesh's Polavaram district during a drive against the illness in her village.

The girl, Madivi Jamuna, a Class 2 student, developed complications on August 31 and died on September 2. Taking suo motu cognizance of her death, CJI Surya Kant has asked the Andhra Pradesh HC to monitor the probe ordered by the state government. Meanwhile, an investigation team is awaiting detailed reports from different laboratories, including the Andhra Pradesh Forensic Science Laboratory in Amaravati, to check if the batch of anti-malarial tablets was contaminated.

On September 1 and 2, at least 70 people, including many children, were hospitalised at primary health centres in Polavaram after the drive. They were later moved to Bhadrachalam Area Hospital in neighbouring Telangana where all of them recovered and were discharged the next day. The girl, however, died at the hospital.

Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu had ordered a probe into the matter. As per the FIR, Jamuna fell ill and lost consciousness a day after taking the tablet. She was among the 15 children who fell ill.

MP techie held in Rs 15 crore nationwide cyber fraud

Mumbai: The Mumbai Crime Branch has arrested a software developer from Madhya Pradesh for allegedly operating an interstate cybercrime syndicate that defrauded senior citizens and other people across India of over Rs 15.75 crore using malicious APK files, police said on Monday.

An investigation revealed the 36-year-old accused had created and sold 2,805 malicious APK files to cyber-criminal gangs, which were subsequently used to cheat 9,673 people nationwide, an official said.

The fraud came to light after a Mumbai resident, 72, was duped of Rs 5.62 lakh on August 13. The caller, posing as a senior bank official, tricked the victim into installing a file named "Senior Citizen Card Verification.apk" via WhatsApp under pretext of issuing a card for elderly and coerced him into entering personal details and debit card information, the official added. Based on the victim's complaint, an FIR was initially registered. The case was transferred to the Property Cell and Cyber Cell of the Mumbai Crime Branch, leading to arrest of the software developer in MP following technical analysis. PTI

India, Switzerland to strengthen ties in defence, nuclear energy sectors

Shubhrajit Roy
New Delhi, October 5

INDIA AND SWITZERLAND signed pacts on mobility that will ease granting longer-duration visas and the exchange of young professionals and agreed to strengthen cooperation in defence and nuclear energy sectors, as Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Swiss President Guy Parmelin on Monday.

After the bilateral meeting with the visiting Swiss President, PM Modi said, "Today, we identified new possibilities for cooperation in military exchanges and defence production. We also reached a consensus on further deepening our collaboration in the field of nuclear energy."

On people-to-people ties, he said that the Migration and Mobility Partnership Agreement and the Young Professionals Agreement signed today will open up numerous new opportunities in Switzerland for Indian students, researchers, professionals, and the youth.

According to Ministry of External Affairs, the MoU aims to develop migration and mobility cooperation under equal treatment principles, and to prevent and combat irregular migration/human exploitation/trafficking in accordance with national laws. "It provides for multiple-entry visas for up to 5 years, including stays of up to 6 months on each visit, and renewable 1-year student per-



Switzerland President Guy Parmelin with Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the Hyderabad House in New Delhi on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

mits," it said. On the agreement for exchange of young professionals, MEA said that the pact incorporates an exchange of 300 persons annually per country, which may increase to 500, and a timeline of 30 to 90 days for verification of nationality/residency status, among other provisions.

Lauding Swiss President Parmelin, Modi said, "I appreciate his commitment to India-Switzerland relations. Last October, with his personal support, we operationalised a historic Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement between India and the European Free Trade Association (EFTA) countries. This is India's first FTA with any economic bloc in Europe."

"It is also an ambitious blueprint for investment, innova-

tion, jobs, and shared prosperity. Through this, we aim to realise the goals of attracting \$100 billion in investment and creating one million direct jobs in India over the next 15 years."

Swiss President Parmelin said, "Trade was a key aspect, as my visit marks the first anniversary of the entry into force of the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement between India and the European Free Trade Association. This partnership benefits both sides: India gains access to capital, technology transfers, and easier access to markets for high-value-added goods. Switzerland, for its part, benefits from trade with a massive partner experiencing sustained growth—at a time when global trade has become more vulnerable and unpredictable."

He said, "I am accompanied by a large delegation of high-ranking business leaders, underscoring our commitment to capitalising on the opportunities offered by this trade and economic partnership agreement."

"To further boost investment, Switzerland hopes to conclude an investment protection agreement soon. In this context, achieving results in discussions on intellectual property protection is equally important," the Swiss President said.

In October last year, the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) between India and the European Free Trade Association (EFTA) States of Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway and Switzerland, came into force. Modi said, "We have taken several important deci-

sions to expand market access for Indian exports to Switzerland and further facilitate investment between the two countries."

"This will increase India's exports of agriculture, pharmaceuticals, textiles, and engineering goods to Switzerland. At the same time, we will attract new Swiss investment in key sectors like biotech, life sciences, banking, insurance, food processing, and sustainability," he said.

Through these initiatives, we will jointly develop trusted supply chains and reliable solutions for the entire world, he added. Modi said, "The ropeway in Varanasi, the Jewar Airport in Noida, and railways and tunneling projects in hilly areas are shining examples of our infrastructure cooperation."

An agreement was also inked for collaboration on transport and infrastructure. "We invite Swiss infrastructure companies to invest in India on a large scale, and to participate in capacity building, design, and manufacturing," Modi said.

The PM said new joint research projects in priority areas such as health, clean energy, and space will be launched soon.

He said India-EFTA Prosperity Summit on Wednesday will be an important platform to translate the promise of our trade and investment partnership into concrete outcomes, he said. PM Modi also extended his best wishes to Switzerland for hosting the next edition of the AI Summit next year.

EXPRESS special

Married to Bihar man & want to be a teacher? New domicile rule may pose a hurdle

Applicants must produce documents with parents' address, not husband's

Santosh Singh
Patna, October 5

A YEAR after it passed its Domicile Policy 2025 to leave only 15% of seats for candidates outside the state, the Bihar government has introduced a new policy rider—women married into the state must produce documents with their parents' and not their husband's address. This effectively means that women from outside Bihar married into the state are not eligible for any reservation benefits.

In a notification it issued on September 22, the Bihar Public Service Commission (BPSC) said: "Married women, who wish to avail quota, will have to produce their caste, residence and non-creamy layer certificates, from [the] address of their parents', not of their husbands."

The notification was issued around the time when the BPSC opened applications for its 32,388 teacher posts through the Teachers Recruitment Examina-

tion (TRE)-4. The notification comes as the policy passed in August 2025 comes into effect this year.

For applicants, it adds another layer of filtering. Said a BPSC official: "Since Bihar had not introduced its domicile policy in our past three examinations, women candidates were free to use their husbands' address. We had to ensure fool-proof implementation of our domicile policy, and needed to clarify rules on married women, applicable for women married into Bihar."

In TRE-I, held in August 2023, around 1.20 lakh teachers were appointed against 1.70 lakh advertised vacancies. In TRE-II, held in December 2023, around 96,000 teachers were selected against 1.22 lakh advertised posts across primary, middle, secondary and higher secondary cadres. TRE-III, originally held in March 2024, was cancelled after a paper leak and re-conducted in July 2024 for 87,774 va-



The notification was issued around the time when BPSC opened applications for its 32,388 teacher posts through TRE-4. BIHAR.GOV.IN

cancies. The BPSC subsequently selected around 70,000 candidates across four school cadres.

According to officials, about 50,000 out-of-state teachers have been appointed across TRE-I to TRE-III since 2023—nearly one-fifth of BPSC's 2.68 lakh teacher appointments.

"Of the 5.68 lakh teachers hired since 2006, a good number of candidates came from other states. This upset Bihar candidates. When the Bihar Teacher Recruitment Rules were first notified in March 2023, a mandatory Bihar domicile policy im-

plementation clause was added. But the Bihar cabinet scrapped it in July 2023, which effectively means that the Bihar domicile policy was never enforced for any examinations," said an education department official.

Notified in August last year, the BPSC TRE Domicile Rules introduced a 40% quota for candidates who passed matriculation or intermediate from institutions in Bihar. Under the new policy, no direct quota exists for candidates from outside Bihar, and they must compete exclusively for 15% open seats.

Non-domicile candidates also don't receive state reservation benefits such as women's quota and other relaxations, and, like other general candidates, require 60% in central and state teacher eligibility tests to qualify—the highest qualifying mark among the categories.

Bihar reserves 85% of state teacher recruitment posts directly for permanent residents of Bihar through various reservation quotas. The BPSC, which has invited applications for the TRE-4 examination, has not yet announced its examination schedule. Of the total 32,388 vacancies, 3,847 positions are for Class 1 to Class 5, 8,563 posts for Class 6 to Class 8, 3,878 posts for Class 9 to Class 10, and 16,101 posts for Class 11 to Class 12 teachers. According to the UDISE+ 2024-25 report, Bihar has a total of approximately 94,339 schools, both government and private.

About 80.84% to 80.90% of these, roughly 76,000 to 76,300 government-managed schools, operate in the state. These government schools are served by a total of approximately 7.07 lakh (707,000) teachers.

Great Nicobar project: SC dismisses Centre's objection to PILs' maintainability in HC

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 5

THE SUPREME Court on Monday declined to entertain the Centre's objections regarding the maintainability of a PIL filed before the Calcutta High Court against the clearance for the ambitious Great Nicobar project.

A Chief Justice of India Surya Kant-led three-judge bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, asked the HC to make an endeavour to decide the matter on the dates (November 25-26) fixed.

The National Green Tribunal (NGT) had in February this year cleared way for government's Rs 81,000-crore Great Nicobar mega infrastructure project, noting its "strategic importance" and observing that there were "adequate safeguards" in the project's environmental clearance. This was challenged before the HC on the ground that it violates the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers Act, 2006.

Before the HC, the Centre raised objection to its maintainability, but they were rejected. Following this, the Centre approached the Supreme Court.

Appearing for the Centre, Attorney General R Venkataramani told the SC, "...this is such an important matter on which somebody comes and files a petition years later, and then

three different petitions try to challenge it in three different ways. Then they say the tribunal are affected, and they are not before the court. Now they have not impleaded. Therefore, this petition should not be there before the High Court at all. This question of maintainability goes to the root of the matter."

He urged the bench to allow him to make submissions on the point of maintainability. "Do not close the door on maintainability because something very important turns on that. I just want to keep the door open," he said.

Appearing for respondent (original petitioner before HC) Meena Gupta, Senior Advocate S Muralidhar said the Centre's counsel had himself urged the HC to list it for final hearing. He contended that the PIL was maintainable as it involved the issue of Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups.

Justice Bagchi said the "preservation of culture is a constitutionally protected fundamental right". He added that the Great Andamanese had by now become integrated with the mainstream population, adding, "Do they become integrated completely with the mainstream, or do we keep them with their unique identity and the identity of their culture?"

The court ultimately left it to the HC, noting that other similar matters were also pending there.

In Keralam, elephant dies of lightning strike, scores gather to pay final tribute

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 5

FOR DECADES, Pallatt Brahmadathan was a constant presence in temple festivals across Keralam. Only last year, the tusker had carried 'thidambu' or sarsad replica of presiding deity Paramekkavu Devi during the Thirsur Pooram last year.

On Monday, scores of people gathered at the premises of its owner, Pallattu Rajesh, at Erattupetta in Kottayam to pay their last tribute to the 'gentle giant' known for its calm demeanour. Brahmadathan, the 54-year-old male elephant, died after being struck by lightning on Sunday evening.

Rajesh, his family members, and mahout Sarath grieved inconsolably near the carcass when a crane lifted it for post-mortem examination.

Brahmadathan was brought to Keralam 28 years ago from Arunachal Pradesh. His first owner in Keralam was Pappalarambil Pothen Varghese of Puthuppally in Kottayam. At that time, it was known as Pu-

thupally Brahmadathan. Sixteen years ago, the Pallatts, another family of traditional elephant owners in the city, took over its guardianship. Ever since, Brahmadathan had been carrying their family name.

Brahmadathan's imposing presence at many annual festivals in Keralam had made him a social media star with a number of its reels being shared widely.

Recalling his relationship with the elephant, Rajesh said, "My three brothers and I were managing Brahmadathan. After the festival season, we used to tether him at our house compound. Each time, before he left for a festival procession, Brahmadathan used to greet my aged mother. He had become a member of our family over the years." Rajesh said Brahmadathan was loved by young and the old alike. "I can proudly say that Brahmadathan had never attacked any person in his 28 years of life in Keralam," he said.

As Brahmadathan passes into the lore of Keralam's domestic elephants, its bond with its mahouts was fondly recalled by elephant lovers.

FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Dozen Bengal Tribunal judges flag their EC portal

The Indian Express last month had revealed that two Election Commissioners had put on record 14 objections in 10 months to a string of decisions taken that pertain to who gets to vote and who doesn't. One of the key concerns they raised was that ECINET, the EC's principal digital system for citizens and officials, restricted access for the officers on the ground responsible for finalising the electoral rolls. Subsequently, the EC announced it would set up a committee with an "independent expert" to review ECINET and "double-check" its compliance with the law.

Similarly, the hurdles highlighted by the Tribunal judges, they said, were, in effect, getting in the way of ensuring due process for deleted voters.

On October 1, The Indian Express sent emails to the Election Commission of India and the Registrar General of the High Court of Calcutta for their response to the judges' concerns and whether these were ad-

ressed. There was no response.

The key challenges judges put on record

The August 11 minutes put on record the challenges the judges face. The excerpts from the minutes are telling:

● **'Can't serve notices':** "There is no mechanism... till date in spite of several requests and reminders to develop a common and proper mechanism on the portal to serve notice to the parties directly or through proper channel. Sometime in the month of May 2026 some of us even approved a format of notice to be issued to the parties but it has not seen the light of the day till date."

● **'Can't store documents':** "...when the Tribunal finds up-loaded documents are not in terms of enumeration form or whenever the Tribunal needs additional documents, there is no mechanism how the same are to be secured. In the absence of such a mechanism on the portal, each Tribunal is trying to

serve the notices through e-mails, that is, through DM/DEO concerned but the response is very poor."

● **'Can't hold virtual hearings':** "There is no mechanism to hold virtual hearings in case the Tribunal intends to hear the parties... Once the appeal is disposed of either by way of deletion or inclusion of the voter, it cannot be restored on the portal if the restoration is needed on account of direction of the judicial order or otherwise."

● **'Can't give an order copy to appellant':** "There is no procedure for the parties to get certified copy or download copy of the order of the Tribunal from the designated portal to know the reasons why their name is deleted or included." This is significant because the Supreme Court, in its order on April 1, had asked the tribunals to communicate the reasons and to revisit the records before they decide on the appeals.

● **'Can't digitise physical records':** The judges flagged the

uncertainty over the appeals filed physically with the District Magistrate/District Election Officers. "...there is no proper mechanism for maintenance of record of these appeals since they are not digitized. If their appeals are not brought to the proper channel, injustice will be done to such citizens," they said.

Incidentally, as early as April 6, the Supreme Court had acknowledged this same issue which had then been raised during the hearing in the petition of Mostari Banu, a West Bengal voter. "The ECI has already notified on 20.03.2026 that appeals can be filed either online through the ECI NET platform or physically at the office of the DM/SDM/SDO, who shall ensure digitisation and uploading of the appeal on the ECI NET platform at the earliest," the SC had said in its April 6 order.

Another judge complained in May

There was an earlier alert, too. On May 22, one of the tribu-

nal judges, wrote to the Calcutta High Court Chief Justice highlighting how the issue of setting up a mechanism to send a notice was raised but went unheeded. "Absence of such a mechanism to notify the parties to the appeal is adversely affecting the pace of disposal of appeals," said the judge in the letter to the CJ. The judge also underlined the lack of accurate data on the number of appeals disposed of being shared by the EC.

"Unfortunately through 'EC source' incorrect data is being catered to the press regarding number of disposal, suppressing the fact ECI has not been able to set up proper mechanism for issuance of notice to the parties for hearing of the appeal," the judge said in the letter.

Shadow over appeal process

All these concerns raised by Tribunal judges cast a shadow on the Supreme Court-ordered unique appellate process meant to give the 27 lakh deleted voters a chance to appeal their exclusion from the rolls.

The Tribunals are a unique aspect of the contested West

Bengal SIR process. As many as 27 lakh voters deleted had been identified by the Election Commission using algorithms for "logical discrepancies" and "unmapped" as per the documents they submitted during the SIR.

After invoking its extraordinary powers under Article 142 of the Constitution while hearing a challenge to the SIR in West Bengal, the Supreme Court had on February 20 ordered appointment of judicial officers to decide on the eligibility of electors in the state. The Commission, using its centralised software, had drawn up a list of 60.06 lakh such electors, based on "logical discrepancies" flagged in their documents.

Hundreds of judicial officers from Bengal, Odisha and Jharkhand, appointed by the Chief Justice of the Calcutta High Court, following the Supreme Court directions, went through these cases, finally deleting 27.16 lakh electors just weeks ahead of polling in the Assembly elections in the state in April.

To give those affected a chance to appeal, the Supreme Court had on March 10 ordered

appellate Tribunals of retired High Court judges to be established, which the EC did on March 20 by notifying 19 single-member tribunals. Since then, two judges have resigned citing personal reasons. They have been replaced with other former judges, it is learnt.

TMC, BJP evenly shared gains in seats with heavy deletions

The two-phase elections in West Bengal last April led to a landslide win for the BJP. The incumbent Trinamool Congress claimed voter deletions played a role in its defeat but that's an allegation more political than empirical. SIR deletions exceeded the victory margin in 49 seats of the 293 that went to polls. In these, the spoils were almost evenly shared — 26 were won by the BJP and 21 by the TMC.

The EC had not released any data of the appellate process until a submission in the Supreme Court in another related matter on September 18, when it said 38.31 lakh appeals had been filed, of which only

1.26 lakh had been disposed of till September 10. Of the total appeals, it said, 22.21 lakh were filed by voters who had been deleted and 16.10 lakh were filed against inclusions (i.e., seeking deletion).

Before the elections, problems with another portal used by judicial officers to adjudicate 60 lakh names were also raised during Supreme Court hearings. In fact, the court noted this in its order on March 10.

"The judicial officers, through the Hon'ble Chief Justice, have expressed an urgent concern, which seems to have been created due to some mistake at the level of the Election Commission of India... Learned senior counsel for the Election Commission of India assures that the same shall be rectified immediately without any delay. We strongly recommend that the Election Commission of India provide full logistic support to the High Court at Calcutta and all the judicial officers in the completion of the responsibilities which we have assigned to them through our order dated 24.02.2026," the March 10 order said.





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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

The knock on the Supreme Court's door

THIS NEWSPAPER'S investigation that shone a light on the functioning of the Election Commission of India in the context of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls has raised serious questions. They have to do with a multi-member body, a constitutional authority, shrinking, many a time, into a one-man show, undermining the checks and balances within. More fundamentally, these questions touch the citizen's sacrosanct right to shape her own and the nation's future through the right to vote. On Sunday, Justice Ujjal Bhuyan framed the issues in all their breadth and gravity. Large-scale disenfranchisement caused by the SIR, he said, is a violation of the Constitution, and detaching the citizen from the right to vote is like "taking out the soul from the body". He referred to debates in the Constituent Assembly to underline the transformational vision and the constitutional guarantee. "... years of freedom struggle and the revolt against foreign rule made the adoption of universal adult franchise a natural choice and an essential ingredient of democracy..." Equal vote with equal value, regardless of identity and social location, was the first step in a new nation to achieve equality. As the Supreme Court takes up cases related to the modalities of the SIR, and the EC's appointment process and functioning, it would do well to listen in to Justice Bhuyan's outlining of what is at stake. Former SC judge Rohinton Fali Nariman underlined it: Also on Sunday, he said that the SIR's removal of voters put the right to vote, which is at the "heart of our democracy", in "great peril".

These are not just the concerns of two individual judges, they reflect the disquiet the Supreme Court needs to address to repair the damage done by its troubling silence. The citizen's fundamental right to participate in the electoral process has to be protected at all costs. But even as the EC went back on its own record of inclusiveness, even as it shifted the burden of proof onto the vulnerable voter and set up a hurdle race at every stage of the SIR, the Court kept giving it the benefit of every doubt. Going ahead, therefore, not just the EC, the Court is also on test.

It is welcome, then, that the SC has made it clear that it did not approve of the changes made to Form 6, which made the process of registration of new voters more daunting. It is reassuring, too, that it wants answers from the EC on aspects of the decision-making within. With due respect, the Court must keep asking questions, again and again. It has a formidable record of affirming the sanctity of Article 324 that secures the Election Commission, it should ensure that remains without stain. For, as one its own members said, this is about the soul of the nation.

From calling for peace, Delhi is now working for it

BY ALL accounts, India has stepped into a more proactive role vis-à-vis the Russia-Ukraine war. Since the conflict began in February 2022, New Delhi has consistently urged restraint, with PM Narendra Modi saying to Russian President Vladimir Putin in September that year that "this is not an era of war". Now, Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha has said that, among the proposals Kyiv has received, India's is the "most comprehensive"; President Putin has said PM Modi "constantly raises the question about putting an end to the conflict" and has "very good ideas"; and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has acknowledged that India has gone "beyond advocacy" and is talking to both sides. The shift from calling for peace to working for it is welcome. Delhi must build on it.

On this front, India's interests align with those of the world. Strikes on ports and vessels by both Russia and Ukraine, two major grain exporters, have left farmers in both countries vulnerable and increased the risk of a global food shock. Minister Jaishankar referred to this a few days ago when he warned of a "major food crisis" in the coming months, in addition to the already significant fertiliser shortages caused by conflicts in Eastern Europe and West Asia. The Ukraine war has also disrupted European energy markets, while India's purchases of Russian oil have strained ties with the US. An end to the war, or even a de-escalation, would ease such pressures.

Going forward, Delhi would do well to focus on specific issues such as grain and energy, rather than sweeping questions involving territory or security guarantees. Both sides have immediate and shared interests in these areas, which means something can be agreed upon without first resolving the harder questions. Even if it does not exert as much leverage over Ukraine or Russia as the US and China, respectively, India can demonstrate that it is actively working towards getting the warring parties to talk. A record of even-handed diplomacy would also answer critics who see India as too close to Russia, a relationship that has drawn scrutiny, not least over oil purchases, for nearly five years.

A single cell, a flash of light, a breakthrough

IN THE beginning was a single cell, instinctively moving towards light so that the business of living may continue. For German photobiologist Peter Hegemann, studying the microscopic alga known as *Chlamydomonas* in the 1990s, the question was straightforward: How did this simple organism respond to light in one-twentieth of the time that it took the human eye to see? The simplicity of the alga's biology, it turned out, was the key needed to unlock the complexities of the human brain, from how different organs are controlled to where feelings, memory, even consciousness itself, reside.

In awarding the 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine to Hegemann, American neuroscientist Karl Deisseroth and German biophysicist Georg Nagel, the Nobel Assembly has recognised what is effectively a new era in neuroscience. Hegemann, along with Nagel, discovered channelrhodopsin, a protein that enables *Chlamydomonas* to react to light in half a millisecond — compared to the 10 milliseconds that it takes the human eye to process information. Deisseroth then used it to develop a "light switch" that can control nerve cells, thus inaugurating the field of optogenetics.

The pinprick of illumination that was made by Hegemann's curiosity has since expanded to shed light on neural pathways that could once only be guessed at. Researchers have been able to identify the precise circuits that control functions and behaviours, from why some people develop a greater preference for sugar to how the rhythms of the heart can affect emotions and how the brain stores information about fear, anxiety and depression. It offers hope for a greater understanding of psychiatric and neurological disorders — areas of darkness that could soon become less intimidating.



PARAMESWARAN IYER, NITIN BASSI AND DANIEL W SMITH

NEW DELHI recently hosted the ninth edition of the India International Water Week under the theme of climate-resilient water management. The talk focused as much on what India has achieved in the last decade as on what comes next — keeping water supply sustainable, using water more efficiently, and treating used water as both an environmental and economic resource.

India's influence in the global water sector has grown substantially. From a country exposed to frequent climate shocks and access challenges to one now preparing for climate extremes such as floods and droughts, it offers lessons for other countries in the Global South. Over the past decade or so, India has designed and implemented some of the world's largest programmes to improve water governance, rejuvenate rivers, increase access to water and sanitation, and enable community-driven water conservation, protection, and augmentation. And if we pause and take a step back in time, it is important to acknowledge the leadership of then Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi's initiatives between 2001 and 2014, a period that served as a laboratory for the water governance reforms that rolled out across India after 2014. These included the design and implementation of the Swachh Bharat

Mission, Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), Jal Shakti Abhiyan, Namami Gange, Atal Bhujal Yojana (ABY), Per Drop More Crop (PDMC), etc.

This 25-year journey is documented in our new case study, 'From Gujarat to India: Water Lessons for the World', which traces water governance reforms in Gujarat and India from 2001 to 2026. Drawing on official data, policy and programme records, the literature and consultations with practitioners, the study examines how political leadership and prioritisation, public financing, institutional reform, administrative implementation and community engagement came together to strengthen water security at scale. Its central finding is that water security is as much a challenge of governance and institutions as it is of engineering — and that the Gujarat experience offers a useful lens for understanding the subsequent national journey and its relevance to the Global South.

The case study distils four key lessons which, if studied and contextualised appropriately, can prove effective in the coming years and inform water governance in other countries in the Global South: Lead with governance, manage the resource and the service together, root action in communities, and build for scale from the start.

Lead with governance, not only hardware: Political will and institutional strengthening, rather than infrastructure alone, are core to water security. India has developed a framework for putting them into action at scale, called the "4 Ps", which were articulated by PM Modi and UN Secretary-General António Guterres through the Delhi Declaration in October 2018. The first is political leadership that prioritises water, reflected in initiatives such as universal tap water access, a cleaner Ganga, community-driven groundwater manage-

ment, and communication campaigns that keep water top of the mind, such as Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain. Second, enabling public (and private) financing for the capital and recurring costs of water governance. Third, developing partnerships between national, state, and local governments; community-based organisations, and national and international knowledge organisations, including multilateral development banks like the World Bank. Fourth, ensuring people's participation in local water decision-making and management, such as communities resolving to make their villages open-defecation free or preparing village-level water security plans. The "4 Ps" are worth emulating in any other context or geography.

Manage the water resource and the service together: Taps and canals will fail if water does not flow. Addressing both water resources development and service sustainability simultaneously and at scale is paramount. Many cities in Africa are growing at a rapid rate, and industrial and irrigation demand will follow, so planning resources and services together now is cheaper than retrofitting later. As India's experience in recent decades shows, getting ahead of the coming surge in water demand with linked water resources and services plans would help countries gain from these economic shifts with lower risk for water insecurity. A key part of getting ahead of this surge is being forward-thinking on water reuse, especially for non-potable uses, including planned data centres and semiconductor fabrication units. In India alone, the annual market revenue from the sale of treated used water is projected to reach around Rs 73,000 crore by 2047, at current prices.

Root water action in community ownership: Water access gains mo-

mentum in communities equipped with effective local water governance institutions such as India's Pani Samitis, infrastructure that consistently delivers a high-quality service, and a balance of internal resources and external support. This has been demonstrated through numerous water conservation, harvesting, and recharge programmes. There is a governance linkage across scales to achieve this. As demonstrated in Gujarat during 2001-2014, the Chintan Shivirs helped prioritise water governance among key stakeholders and formulate actionable solutions to design water-related policies aligned with community expectations. A similar approach was replicated at the national level. The recent Departmental Summit on Water organised by the Ministry of Jal Shakti and addressed by the PM in September 2026 is an example.

Going big and scaling up: The world is off track on SDG 6 to ensure safe drinking water and sanitation for all, and to sustainably manage water resources, used water, and ecosystems by 2030. Estimates suggest an additional \$500 billion in annual investment is required. To meet the scale of water governance reforms, infrastructure installation, data collection, and maintenance required for SDG 6, governments and their leaders cannot afford to slow down. Implementation of JJM across the country demonstrates that India can both think big and implement big. The global community can learn from political leadership at the highest level in India about the will, the financing and the institutions to do it at scale.

Iyer is a former secretary to the Government of India at the Ministry of Jal Shakti; Bassi is a fellow with the Council on Energy, Environment and Water; Smith is an assistant professor at George Mason University. Views are personal

The limits of US's West Asia strategy are showing



ANJU GUPTA

AS THE US-Israel war against Iran enters its eighth month, there is little indication that a "durable" agreement is likely to be reached soon and revive negotiations over Tehran's nuclear programme. The war has reignited the Saudi-Houthi conflict, incurring additional risks to the East-West pipeline as well as to the maritime traffic through the Red Sea and across the strait of Babel-Mandeb.

Israel continues to be militarily engaged in four theatres — Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon and Syria — while perceived threats from Iran and its allies based in Iraq and Yemen have not diminished. An attempt allegedly by an Omani co-pilot to crash a Flydubai flight en route from Dubai to Tel Aviv has raised the risk to aviation security in the region. A few days earlier, the UK police arrested five British nationals on suspicion of planning attacks on RAF Fairford, a base being used by US bombers deployed against Iran.

Both incidents are still under investigation. However, Iran hawks believe the incidents must be linked to Iran.

Against this backdrop, the last US troops withdrew from Iraq on September 30, in line with a bilateral agreement with the Iraqi government, though the condition of bringing all Iran-aligned armed groups under Iraqi government control has not been met. This has raised serious concerns about the further deepening of Iranian influence in Iraq. Recall that the US handed over its last base in Syria to the interim government in April, even though Syria continues to be highly unstable.

While the US does not seem inclined to militarily disengage with Iran, what do withdrawals from Iraq and Syria suggest about US policy?

The war seems to have pushed the US to reassess its footprint in the region for three reasons: Damage to bases, depletion of its munitions, and high casualties among US forces. Over 16 US bases in the region are reported to have suffered serious damage. US think-tanks have documented an alarming depletion of munitions and long waiting times before these can be replenished to pre-war levels. This makes it harder for the US to protect its bases and forces.

Further, the "successful" hacking of personal information of US forces based in the Gulf has been repeatedly flagged. Thus, force protection at the bases has become a crucial issue for the US, which explains the withdrawal from bases in Iraq and Syria. The US is unlikely to use existing bases in support of allies in other active conflicts (Saudi-Houthi, Israel-Lebanon and Israel-Syria).

US CENTCOM has stated that "Combined Joint Task Force-Operation Inherent Resolve remains operational and is now headquartered in Jordan as US forces continue the counter-ISIS mission in Syria alongside Coalition partners and the Syrian government". This is in line with the US's current counter-terrorism strategy of working with partners rather than occupying bases in areas where force protection is a serious challenge. The US is in the process of deploying a third aircraft carrier strike group to the region.

The strengthening of seaborne resources seems to suggest that the US has perhaps reprioritised securing the Sea Lines of Communication (SLOCs) in the theatre over providing physical protection to allies.

Competing partnerships, including Israel-UAE, the Mecca alliance, and the Saudi-Pakistan Defence Pact are coming up in search of durable security architecture for the region. Many Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) countries are exploring ways to bring Iran into a broader architecture as well to ensure stability, security, and prosperity of the region. Given Washington's focus on Iran's nuclear programme and SLOCs, as well as Israel-Iran hostilities, such efforts may face serious obstacles.

The two upcoming events — the Israeli elections and the US midterm elections — could produce political outcomes unfavourable for the region. However, it is beyond doubt that the US-Israel war on Iran has resulted in multiple unintended consequences that the region and the global community will have to cope with for years.

Gupta, a security analyst and former director general of police, is the author of Glocal Terror in South Asia: Tracing the Roots in Geopolitics and the Tragedy of Afghanistan

In Germany, Indian migrant is caught between politics, policy



SHAIREE MALHOTRA

ELECTIONS IN the East German states of Saxony-Anhalt and Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania gave the far-right Alternative für Deutschland (AfD) two striking victories, marking the German far right's first landslide since 1945. Its vote share increased in Berlin. Chancellor Friedrich Merz's Christian Democrats suffered a historic defeat in all three elections. From failing to enter the Bundestag in 2013, the anti-immigrant AfD rose to second place in the 2025 federal elections, becoming the largest opposition party. It has exploited grievances over economic stagnation, pairing the discontent with demands for severe restrictions on immigration. This has consequences for Germany, the EU, and India.

In 2022, India and Germany signed a Migration and Mobility Partnership Agreement (MMPA). As Germany grapples with an ageing population, mass retirements and declining birth rates, the MMPA provides up to 3,000 annual job seeker visas for qualified Indian professionals. But while Germany invests in creating pathways to address labour shortages, its electoral politics portrays migration as a threat. With Indian nationals tripling from 86,000 in 2015 to 2,80,000 in 2025, the German Institute for International and Security Affairs describes India as "the most important country of origin for labour and education migration". Around 1,38,000 Indians work in skilled occupations including STEM fields, IT, healthcare — sectors central to the economy, but struggling with the largest worker deficits. A Bertelsmann Foundation study estimates that Germany would need 4,00,000 fresh immigrants annually to address worker shortages, likely to number 1.3 million by 2030. The AfD's proposed incentives to bring back Germans living abroad and "baby bonuses" can hardly bridge such gaps. But with the far-right boom, skilled Indians considering a future overseas may also rethink Germany's allure.

As migration rules are determined at the federal level, the far-right's rise may not lead to a direct abrogation of migration laws or agreements. Yet there is already evidence of a hardening political atmosphere. In 2025, Merz's CDU sought to restrict migration through a proposed law supported by the AfD. Thus, even as they try to keep the AfD out with the "firewall", its influence is changing how mainstream parties approach migration. States control aspects of public services, policing, and education, where far-right ideology may create an uneasy climate. Hate crimes doubled from 2019 to 2023. The AfD's rhetoric differentiates between irregular migration that burdens welfare systems and skilled legal migration that contributes to society. Yet rather than migration status, traits such as skin colour shape day-to-day encounters and prejudices. While the election results may not erode Germany's broader appeal, and a migration architecture that remains comparatively open as anglophone destinations tighten policies, perceptions are a two-way street. Hard-right rhetoric may convince skilled Indians to see Germany as a corridor to onward migration.

As Indo-German relations expand, the mobility of skilled professionals acts as a bridge, also linking both countries' research and innovation ecosystems, particularly in domains like AI. How policymakers reconcile political and economic realities will determine Germany's fate as Europe's industrial powerhouse and its attractiveness as a migratory destination.

The writer is a deputy director with ORF

40 YEARS AGO

October 06, 1986



PM on security measures

DESPITE BEING given funds and ideas to improve the police, the Union territories have not been able to use them well, PM Rajiv Gandhi has said. Talking to *Indian Express* two days after the attempt on his life at Raighat, he said, "I have been trying to chase it for some time... the expansions I have asked for have not taken place at the speed I wanted."

Asiad closing ceremony

THE PYROTECHNICS the South Korean ath-

letes displayed in the ultra-modern venues of the 10th Asian Games were reflected in the sky at a spectacular closing ceremony that may have brought a tear to the eye of the most hard-boiled media critic in the 100,000 capacity Olympic stadium in Seoul.

Panel on civil services

PRIME MINISTER Rajiv Gandhi is appointing an eight-member panel to "examine certain aspects relating to the civil services, including their structure, management, role etc." During a recent review of the performance

of the Department of Personnel, it was thought that a panel should go into the various aspects of the functioning of the civil services to make them more efficient and result-oriented.

Reagan writes to Rajiv Gandhi

US PRESIDENT Ronald Reagan is understood to have written to PM Rajiv Gandhi on the hijacking of the Pan Am plane last month. Well-informed sources in New York said the letter was sent recently but would not give any details of the contents.



The problem is not just what history textbooks teach, but also what they don't



MANU V DEVADEVAN

IN RECENT decades, the periodic revisions of Indian school History textbooks have become increasingly tenuous and worrying. From the invention of fictitious narratives to the erasure or inappropriate abridgement of important periods in history, revisions have assumed several questionable forms. The new textbooks tend to present pieces of information that are sometimes contrary to facts, besides contradicting their own statements in some instances. The larger purpose of these textbook revisions is to present a communally informed account of India's past that conceives of history as a story of antagonistic groups forced to share a geopolitical territory.

History is the discipline that tells us how we reached the present and what it meant to live in times when human lives were organised differently. Human lives were transformed by deep-seated processes involving the introduction and increased use of metals, tools and weapons, fire, agriculture, livestock farming, the wheel, alphabets and numbers, money, monumental architecture and more. Ideas, ranging from god, value, valour and hierarchy to justice, equality, democracy and peace have shaped human lives in profound ways. A lesson in History involves a nuanced understanding of this journey.

Do the new History textbooks in our schools live up to this mandate? No, they do not. NCERT's new Social Science textbook for Grade IX, Understanding Society: India and Beyond — Part 2, is the latest in a series of contestable textbook revisions. Released last Tuesday, the book putatively "aims to equip students with the skills that are needed to grow... and to enhance their analytical, descriptive, and narrative capabilities". As it turns out, there is much to be de-



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

sired in the book on these counts.

Consider the chapter, "India's Long Road to Independence", which is meant to be an account of a decisive phase in Indian history. The chapter turns out to be an assorted set of events presented chronologically. Little is said in it of historical processes that might encourage critical thinking. Colonialism and nationalism are not defined or discussed in conceptual terms, and processes such as the growth of literature, the development of capitalism and the course of constitutional reforms are nowhere seen. There isn't a word on Ripon's local self-governance initiative or the Morley-Minto or the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms.

The chapter begins with a "big question": "How did a land of diverse geographies, languages and religions come together to challenge and finally end nearly two centuries of British rule?" This is precisely the kind of question that encourages critical thinking, but the chapter ends without touching upon any of the issues that the "big question" flags.

Another chapter, "Cultural Currents: 13th to 17th Centuries", puts off a conscientious reader with its

embarrassing "big question": "How did Indian culture endure and continue to grow richer during this period despite invasions and an unstable political context?" The chapter states that religious differences between the Islamic invaders and the local population were so striking that there wasn't really a meeting ground in sight for a time. The power of the Bhakti tradition, along with Sufism, allegedly helped India overcome this crisis. The chapter posits that monotheistic Islam and a religion with several schools of thought were marked by a stark difference. A few pages later, it argues that Islam's idea of the oneness of god was already present in the Upanishads. One is left wondering what the stark difference was all about!

This chapter holds that Islamic invasions led to the imprisonment of women and their sale as slaves. As a natural consequence, women began to make their public appearances less frequent. The use of purdah, *ghunghat* and other forms of veiling are presented in the chapter as an attempt to protect women from the invaders. The 10th-century traveller Abu Zayd's words are cited as evidence to the effect that Indian

women wore no veil before the advent of Islam. It is, then, mighty uncertain what Rama was referring to in the *Pratima*, a play attributed to Bhasa, when he told Sita, "*apaniyataam avagunthanam*", "remove your veil". And what was Sudraka speaking of in the *Mricchakatika* when he said that Sarvilaka covered Vasantasena with a veil (*vasantasenaam avagunthya*) after she relinquished her life as a courtesan?

These aren't the only factual inaccuracies in the book. There are several more. But the challenge that such textbooks pose is not with deliberate misrepresentation of facts or contradictory information. A learned class teacher can address these inadequacies in the classroom effortlessly. The real issue lies in shifting the emphasis increasingly to lionised accounts of certain periods in history and presenting the past as a set of acts by a variety of actors engaged in religious antagonism. The interrogative character of historical studies is less frequently seen in these textbooks.

Students are told of thousands of soldiers marching, but not how the soldiers were fed or from where they sourced their weapons. Students are told of high-quality steel produced in ancient India but not how the furnaces worked. Students are told of fire sacrifices by the Vedic people, but not told what it took to produce and maintain fire in an age when lighters and matchsticks did not exist. Students are given a checklist of great advances in astronomy but not told what an armillary sphere is and how it worked. Students are told that Bankim Chandra wrote *Anandamath* but not told how the schools of the day equipped children to be literate enough to read Bankim.

The schools that made Indians literate in the past 200 years have contributed in no small measure to the making of India as we have known it in our lifetime. This important lesson from the past should inform every line that a textbook committee decides to include in a book meant for our schoolchildren.

The writer is associate professor of History at IIT Mandi, Himachal Pradesh

ECI must not force voters to lie. Solution may lie in a Form 6X



S Y QURAISHI

THE ELECTION Commission's latest instructions mark a U-turn in its approach to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR). After an exercise in which about 13 crore names disappeared from draft electoral rolls, the ECI has directed its machinery to identify and re-enrol arbitrarily deleted eligible voters. The change is welcome — even after causing countrywide chaos. But its significance should not be concealed behind administrative language.

In instructions issued on September 29 and reinforced at its October 1 meeting with Chief Electoral Officers, the ECI has ordered a special enrolment drive in 20 states and Union territories where SIR has been completed. Officials must compare pre-SIR and post-SIR rolls, identify missing voters, visit their homes and facilitate their enrolment. Political parties may assist. These instructions address two distinct problems. Both deserve attention.

First, young voters. For years, the ECI took pride in encouraging every Indian youngster who turned 18 on every January 1 to register immediately. The Union cabinet's 2011 decision to make January 25 National Voters' Day reflects this approach. In 2022, another important reform was introduced. Instead of a single qualifying date of January 1, it provided four: January 1, April 1, July 1 and October 1. Seventeen-year-olds could even apply in advance. The message was unmistakable: Nobody should unnecessarily wait to exercise the franchise after becoming eligible.

What happened to that commitment in 2024? The ECI must explain how many young people becoming eligible from 2024 onwards remained unenrolled and why. It cannot now quietly announce a special drive for young voters and expect everyone to forget these questions. Generation Z is entitled to an explanation. The Commission should publish quarterly figures for applications, enrolments, rejections and pendency, identify those affected by its additional requirements, and account for any eligible young citizens who consequently missed elections. Those responsible for unlawful or unjustified administrative obstructions must be held accountable. Announcing a corrective drive is no substitute for explaining why it became necessary.

Two, the restoration of deleted voters. Here, the contradiction is even more extraordinary. The Commission has instructed officials to identify people who appeared on the pre-SIR rolls but disappeared from the revised rolls and bring them back on the rolls straightaway. A dramatic surrender indeed. Yet it proposes to bring them back through Form 6. The heading of Form 6 explicitly states: "Application Form for New Voters". Its declaration requires the applicant to state: "I am applying for inclusion in Electoral Roll for the first time." How can somebody who has been voting for 20 or 30 years honestly sign such a declaration? There is an additional irony. The same form warns that making a false declaration is punishable under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, with imprisonment extending to one year, a fine, or both. An elector whose name has disappeared is effectively being told to declare that he is applying for registration for the first time.

We need to examine the experience of those previously registered voters who reportedly protested against this procedure but were nevertheless forced to submit Form 6. How many complied because they were told that they had no other way of recovering their vote? Why should citizens be placed in a position where recovering their electoral registration requires them to sign a false — and hence illegal — declaration? There is a potentially serious criminal dimension for election officials, too. Under Sections 45 and 49 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, intentional instigation or assistance in committing an offence can constitute abetment. An abettor can face the same punishment as prescribed for the offence.

But the larger question is institutional. The Commission is now instructing officials to identify previously registered voters and bring them back through a statutory form designed for first-time applicants. How can it reconcile these two instructions?

The solution is straightforward. Introduce an appropriate restoration procedure. Ask for the previous EPIC number and electoral-roll particulars. Verify whether the citizen remains eligible, has shifted residence, is registered elsewhere or has become disqualified. Where necessary, amend the statutory forms through the prescribed legal procedure. I would suggest introducing a new form, say 6X.

We must save citizens from expensive and cumbersome litigation when the electoral administration possesses the records needed to examine their claims. A first-time voter needs registration, using Form 6. A wrongly deleted voter needs restoration, using Form 6X, which can be created in a few hours by the Law Ministry amending the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

The Commission has finally recognised the practical necessity of identifying both categories. It must now provide legally appropriate procedures for dealing with them, publish the results and explain the administrative failures that made this corrective exercise necessary.

Quraishi is former chief election commissioner of India and the author of An Undocumented Wonder: The Making of the Great Indian Election

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Asiad report card

CELEBRATING ASIAD podiums while dreading Olympic deficits overlooks a key systemic flaw ('A late surge at Nagoya and a long way to Los Angeles', *IE*, October 5). Unlike sporting powerhouses that field development squads at continental meets, India persistently deploys its frontline Tier-1 athletes to secure medals at the Asian and Commonwealth Games. This over-reliance inflates regional tallies while masking our acute lack of bench strength. Continental success will never translate into Olympic gold until we build genuine depth beyond this handful.

Harsh Pawaria, Rohtak

Seeking capital

RISING GLOBAL borrowing costs deserve closer attention as India seeks capital for development ('Global capital is no longer cheap, that's the challenge', *IE*, October 5). Dependence on foreign funds becomes risky when investors demand higher returns and global conditions turn uncertain. The priority should be to strengthen domestic savings, deepen the bond market and maintain fiscal discipline. Public expenditure must increasingly favour productive infrastructure rather than recurring commitments. A predictable tax regime and stable policies also improve investor confidence.

A Myilsami, Coimbatore

Aviation safety

THE INCIDENT is a reminder that aviation safety must account for both technology and human limitations ('A pilot's heroism points to need to rethink cockpit safety', *IE*, October 5). Pilots require regular simulator training for rare but critical emergencies, while airlines should strengthen procedures for situations involving incapacitation or impaired communication. Independent safety reviews can identify weaknesses before another incident occurs. Technology should assist pilots without creating excessive dependence on automation. Regulators must also ensure that safety recommendations are implemented and periodically audited.

SM Jeeva, Chennai



JYOTSNA GOVIL

A LONG-STANDING demand to make cancer a notifiable disease across the country may finally be within reach. If implemented well, this could mark a turning point and change how India counts, plans for and responds to cancer. In its recent order, the Supreme Court asked the 19 states and Union territories where cancer has not yet been declared a notifiable disease to consider doing so. It also asked whether mandatory guidelines from the Centre are needed to bring uniformity.

The states should respect the Court's order in its full sense and begin the process without further delay. Experience from states where notification is already in place can provide useful lessons. But differences in reporting and use of information make it difficult to build a comparable national picture. India needs common national guidelines for cancer notification. The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare should establish a standard minimum dataset, common definitions and timelines, uniform safeguards and compliance rules. Healthcare providers and laboratories will need training, technical assistance and a practical transition period.

The Indian Cancer Society, which completes 75 years in 2026, has long advocated stronger cancer surveillance because better data is the foundation of better cancer care. Notification can provide timely information on diagnosed cases, while registries can validate, enrich and analyse it to understand incidence, patterns and trends. Data is not merely about knowing how many people have cancer. It is about knowing where the disease is, who is af-

The real issue lies in shifting the emphasis increasingly to lionised accounts of certain periods and presenting the past as a set of acts by a variety of actors engaged in religious antagonism

To fight cancer better, make every diagnosis count

ected and where the health system needs to respond. Linked with registry and health-system data, notification can reveal geographic patterns, high-risk populations, delays and dropouts, and show where additional staff, diagnostic capacity or financial support are needed.

The implications for health planning are considerable. How does a government decide how many hospitals a district needs, whether facilities are adequate, how many professionals are required or where specialised cancer services should be developed? Such decisions should be based on disease burden and population need. Cancer information must flow from facilities at every level, including smaller hospitals and diagnostic centres, into a system that can bring the data together. States have different levels of technical capacity and some will need the Centre's support through training, standardised protocols and digital infrastructure. Reporting must be simple, practical and interoperable with hospital, laboratory and cancer registry systems, including where connectivity is limited. A common digital backbone could provide shared standards while integrating existing systems. CoWIN demonstrated India's ability to operate digital public-health infrastructure at national scale. Cancer notification requires a different architecture, especially for longitudinal information, interoperability and privacy, but deserves the same ambition.

Reliable data can also improve planning for medicines, diagnostics, radiotherapy and emerging therapies by helping governments, healthcare providers and

the pharmaceutical industry anticipate demand and improve availability. Data protection, however, must be non-negotiable. Cancer information is deeply personal. Any national system must safeguard access, privacy, cybersecurity and permitted uses of information, with clear rules on identifiable data and anonymisation. Better notification may initially make India's cancer numbers appear higher. This should not be interpreted as a sudden increase in prevalence. More comprehensive reporting will identify cases previously outside formal records; an initial rise may simply mean we are seeing the problem more clearly. Over time, consistent data can identify trends and gaps in care, strengthen research, guide resources and help policymakers assess whether interventions are improving outcomes. Most importantly, it can move cancer planning from estimates towards evidence.

The SC has opened the door. States should move promptly, while the Centre provides the standards, technical support, digital infrastructure and safeguards needed to make notification work consistently. Ultimately, this is about making every cancer diagnosis count. A diagnosis should not remain confined to an individual hospital record when, with appropriate privacy protection, it can help show where cancer occurs, where care is falling short and where resources are most urgently needed. We should use this moment not merely to count cancer cases, but to build the knowledge India needs to fight cancer more intelligently, more equitably and more effectively.

The writer is chairperson, Indian Cancer Society, Delhi Branch

Notification can provide timely information on diagnosed cases, while registries can validate, enrich and analyse it to understand incidence, patterns and trends



VINEET NAYYAR

IF A machine can answer almost any question our children ask, what should we be teaching them? I have been thinking about this as AI moves from our phones into our classrooms and workplaces. Knowing the right answer will still matter. But it cannot be the only thing we reward. We will need people who can ask better questions, challenge what they are told, experiment, and imagine something that does not yet exist. I have seen young graduates grow into CEOs. What stood out was their belief that they could figure things out. They were willing to say, "I don't know. Let me try."

For nearly two decades, I have worked

with children and teachers in government schools. I have watched what happens when a child understands the lesson, and what happens when the language itself becomes a barrier. Imagine a six-year-old girl. At home, she talks endlessly, argues with her parents, and asks questions about everything. At school, the teacher begins explaining a lesson in a language she barely understands. Other children raise their hands. She stays quiet. Tomorrow, it happens again. Soon, "I don't understand the language" becomes "I don't understand the lesson." And then, perhaps, "I am not as smart as the others."

This is why the language in which a child first learns matters so much now. A familiar language lets the child concentrate on the idea rather than struggle with the words used to explain it. More importantly,

it gives her the confidence to participate. She can ask why, disagree, make mistakes, and try again. I worry that we underestimate this. We speak about learning outcomes, but what about the child's belief in her own ability to learn? We can help her catch up on a missed chapter. Rebuilding the confidence to speak after years of silence is much harder.

For millions of children, the mother tongue is the language in which they first learned to think aloud, tell stories, make friends and ask why the world works as it

We speak about learning outcomes, but what about the child's belief in her own ability to learn?

does. It deserves a place at the beginning of their education, not just in a cultural celebration. This is not an argument against English. I know how many doors English can open, and I want those doors open to every child. But learning English and being required to learn everything through English are not the same thing. We should not make a child feel less intelligent simply because she has yet to master a second language.

For generations, we have often treated the child with the correct answer as the smartest child in the room. Today, a machine can produce answers in seconds. What will distinguish the person using it? The ability to ask why the answer might be wrong. To notice the problem nobody has framed. To wonder whether there is a better way. To test an idea even when the outcome is uncertain.

I call this the fourth language: The language of questions. It is not taught by asking children to memorise a list of questions. It grows when a teacher welcomes an unexpected "why", when a child is allowed to be wrong without being embarrassed, and when curiosity is treated as a strength rather than an interruption. And it begins long before a young person joins a company or learns to use AI. It begins in that first classroom, with a child who feels she has something worth saying. So as we discuss how many languages our children should learn, let us pay attention to the one in which they begin. The first language gives a child the confidence to speak. Only then can she learn the fourth, the courage to question.

The writer is founder-chairman, Sampark Foundation, and former CEO, HCLT



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• GLOBAL

Behind France’s snowballing student protests

Yashee
New Delhi, October 5

AROUND 500 schools stayed shut across France on Monday amid raging protests by high school students. The protesters have blockaded schools, set fire to waste bins, and in some cases smashed furniture. According to French officials, damage across 40-odd schools is worth around €3 million (Rs 32.5 crore). The protests began on September 17 at the Saint-Exupéry high school in Créteil, a Paris suburb, and quickly spread. Education Minister Édouard Geffray has announced a feedback programme for students, along with an action plan to quickly hire more teachers beginning Monday.

What do the protesting students want?
The major grievances are overcrowded classrooms, fewer teachers, no nurses or social workers in some schools, and crumbling infrastructure. Inequality is also a factor, with students from poorer suburbs saying their address is impacting their education.
A French government report from April says, “During the 2024-2025 school year, 9.8% of teaching hours were not provided in public secondary schools, of which 7.5% was due to the non-replacement of absent teachers and 2.3% was due to the total closure of the establishment.” The report adds that the “proportion of teaching time not provided increased by 0.7 points compared to the previous year due to a greater number of days of school closures.”
Some of the students have said there are 40 of them packed in a classroom, when the average for French high schools is around 30 in a class. The length of the school day — from 8 am to 5 pm — is another concern. The extreme heat wave this year has added another dimension.

What is the political angle?
While in many schools, teachers have protested side by side with students, in other cases, school staff have said the protesters are not from among their pupils.
This, the scale of the violence, and flags of Palestine and Algeria at some of the protests have led those on the right and even the centre to claim that the hard left party France Unbowed (LFI) is playing its part in the protests.
France will go to polls next year. The government of Emmanuel Macron is under stress over migration and identity politics on one hand and rising inequality and spending cuts by the government on the other.
While support for the hard right party National Rally led by Marine Le Pen has surged, the LFI’s presidential candidate, Jean-Luc Mélenchon, is popular among the youth. However, the French youth often do not turn up to vote in large numbers. Some analysts believe that the LFI is fuelling the students’ protests to rally the youth and make them vote for it next year.



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• CULTURE

Cornell 7 & the frat house problem: ‘Greek life’ on US campuses under scrutiny

Arav Shah
New Delhi, October 5

A FORMER student of Cornell University in the US filed a civil lawsuit in the New York State Supreme Court last month, alleging that she was raped by seven members of a university “fraternity” house in 2024. The lawsuit names, among others, seven students of Cornell who belonged to one of the chapters of the national “Chi Phi” fraternity. They are now being referred to as the “Cornell 7”.
The incident has shone a harsh light on a ubiquitous aspect of college life in the US — fraternities, which are male student organisations built around shared social, academic or professional interests. Many have voiced anger over the freedoms enjoyed by fraternities (also called frats) across the country, relative to their status as a student-led group.
The mayor of Ithaca, where Cornell is situated, has called for a moratorium on fraternity life (also called Greek life because frats are named after Greek letters), with the Chi Phi fraternity’s Cornell chapter shut down pending investigation.
Around a million students are estimated to currently be part of such organ-

isations across the US, according to Fraternity Advisor, a website that documents US college fraternities.
How college fraternities evolved
Until the late 1700s, student-led groups in the US were dominated by literary societies.
Nicholas L Syrett, author of the book *A History of White College Fraternities*, told *The Indian Express*: “Almost everyone who wanted to be in one (literary society) was able to join.” Indeed, at some schools “students were basically required to join one of two societies. In that sense, they weren’t exclusive at all”.
In 1776, however, a fraternity called Phi Beta Kappa at the College of William and Mary in Virginia came up as an alternative.
Fraternities, unlike literary societies, were “by definition exclusive”, said Syrett, who is Gender Studies Chair at the University of Wisconsin-Madison. “One of the reasons was also to separate out the wealthier or secular students from the poorer students studying for the ministry [religious offices].”
The Greek lettering was derived from the position the study of the Classics represented in Western education.



People arrive for a hearing on sexual assault at Cornell University in Ithaca, N.Y., on Oct. 1. AP

Community and ‘fraternity’
For much of their existence, Greek letter organisations had membership restrictions that could encompass elements from race and class to gender and political ideology.

The fraternal mindset of brotherhood was contingent on who qualified as community. Fraternities were also gender-segregated and ‘sororities’, as they were known for women, developed later during the ex-

pansion of women’s higher education. The underlying structure remained the same.
Today, “it is illegal for race, religion or ethnicity to be a part of the pledging process,” said Syrett.
Activities and operation
Over time, fraternities have become institutions functioning like corporate entities. A national organisation oversees local campus chapters that consist of undergraduate members. The national board and chapter houses also benefit from their respective alumni networks built over time.
Alumni protests over fraternity crackdowns are not “unprecedented” and the national organisations also have “lobbyists in Congress who work to limit how much they can be regulated”, Syrett said.
The Cornell case
The Cornell 7 case reflects a wider pattern of fraternity behaviour and misconduct.
In 2007, researcher John Foubert concluded that fraternity men were three times more likely to commit sexual assault than non-participants. Excessive alcohol ingestion is another component which fraternity life is closely linked with.

These fraternities are also infamous for their hazing practices, which are essentially humiliating initiation rituals for new students hoping to “pledge” themselves to the frat.
According to a database maintained by journalist and hazing researcher Hank Nuwer, there has been at least one university hazing death in the US every single year between 1959 and 2021.
Disproportionate freedoms
The true source of a fraternity’s power on campus is real estate. “Most fraternity houses are owned by alumni corporations that then rent out space to individual members to live in them,” Syrett explained. “This means the universities do not officially control the property.”
While a university can govern the process of Greek life — such as setting university-wide rules on joining and eligibility — they have very little authority over the physical spaces themselves.
The houses are legally classified as private property and “for day-to-day matters, they are in charge of what happens in the houses,” Syrett said.

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• NOBEL MEDICINE PRIZE 2026

How scientists used light to control brain cells



ANONNA DUTT

THE NOBEL Prize in Physiology and Medicine for 2026 was jointly awarded to Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann and Georg Nagel for their discovery of an alga protein that reacts to light and its use as a switch to study the functions of nerve cells.
Their explorations led to the creation of a new field of study called optogenetics, which may finally help scientists understand how the brain forms memories, feelings and behaviours.
“We were able to precisely pace the heart and look at the effects that different heart rates have on brain states... Communication across the body, from the body to the brain, but with the precision of a gain of function in a peripheral organ allowing us to see the effects on brain and behavioural state... this ability to execute a precision intervention in one organ and read out the effects in complex behaviours — this is something that people have wanted for a long time to be able to do,” said Deisseroth.
In simple terms, they found a way to control cells with light. Imagine that the brain is a vast electrical network containing billions of tiny cells called neurons. These neurons communicate by sending electrical signals, allowing us to move, see, remember, feel pain and experience emotions. Deisseroth, Hegemann and Nagel helped scientists develop a remarkable way of controlling these electrical signals: using light.
Their research led to the discovery and development of light-sensitive proteins, called opsins, that can be placed in specific cells. When light is directed at those cells, the proteins act like tiny switches, turning the cells’ activity on or off. This is known as optogenetics — essentially, using light to control genetically modified cells.



• **‘For their discoveries concerning light-gated ion channels and optogenetics’**

“Optogenetics... fundamentally altered our understanding of the brain,” the press release said. It credited the three for ushering in a new era in neuroscience.



KARL DEISSEROTH, 54
The Howard Hughes Medical Institute and Stanford University



PETER HEGEMANN, 71
Humboldt University of Berlin, Germany



GEORG NAGEL, 73
University of Würzburg, Germany

ON TUESDAY: NOBEL PRIZE IN PHYSICS

What is optogenetics?

It is a field of research that uses light to manipulate the activity of neurons or other types of cells and study the resulting effects. This is done by expressing the light-sensitive protein in the targeted cells. Within the brain, it has contributed towards identifying neural circuits responsible for sensing pain, social behaviours, thirst, food consumption, reward and attention or the understanding of how memories are created.
Interestingly, the field rests on a theory proposed by Francis Crick, the molecular biologist who was behind the discovery of the double helix structure of DNA, and was awarded the Nobel prize for it.
He envisioned activating individual nerve cells in the brain to investigate the mechanisms that underlie human consciousness. With nerve signals being extremely rapid, he realised it would only be possible if scientists were somehow able to manipulate the nerve cells with light. He himself admitted that the idea sounded far-fetched.
But it was made possible by the work of Hegemann and Nagel on the alga Chlamydomonas. These are famous for their ability to quickly swim towards a light source. Hegemann found that these reacted extremely quickly, within half a millisecond after the light reached a tiny orange dot (called the eyespot) that the alga used to de-

Why the field matters

‘Optogenetics has given us an extremely powerful way to switch on and off the neurons and see what happens.’

It has allowed us to manipulate nerve cells and study its effects with an unprecedented level of precision,’ said Vidita Vaidya, senior professor, Tata Institute of Fundamental Research.

tect light. For reference, it takes 10 milliseconds for the human eye to react to light. Hegemann wondered, how could the response to light be more than 20 times faster in Chlamydomonas?
He hypothesised that a single protein complex both captured light and acted on it in the alga as opposed to the multi-step process in the human eye. Yet, finding this protein was a challenge because when the proteins in the algal eyespot were removed from their natural setting, they became unstable and easily damaged. This is when he discovered that Japanese researchers had mapped the DNA of Chlamydomonas, among which were the codes for two genes that shared similarities with light-capturing proteins.
Enter Nagel. He used egg cells of frogs to express the two proteins and confirm Hegemann’s hypothesis. The alga detected and reacted to light using the protein channelrhodopsin-2 (ChR-2). They then introduced the cells in different types of cells and found that they all became light sensitive.
Deisseroth found that ChR-2 could control the activity of specific nerve cells in the manner proposed by Francis Crick. He used it to control rat nerve cells in a petri dish and later in the rats. With Deisseroth’s lab at the forefront, researchers soon found more proteins that can turn nerve cells on and off, and which are activated by different wavelengths of light.

How does it help to study the brain?
“Imagine the brain to be a building with lots and lots of rooms — now there was no way for us to know what happens if the light is switched on in just one room. Optogenetics has given us an extremely powerful way to switch on and off the neurons and see what happens. It has allowed us to manipulate nerve cells and study its effects with an unprecedented level of precision. It has completely changed the scale at which discoveries are happening in neurosciences,” said Vidita Vaidya, senior professor at the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research.
Optogenetics is still largely used in laboratories to see which set of neurons regulates what type of behaviour in animals, helping scientists look into the black box, Vaidya says. Dr Sanjeev Kumar Mahto, professor at IIT BHU, said it has allowed scientists to see the functions of the brain and enhance the understanding of what causes certain conditions.
Deisseroth’s research group introduced the gene for ChR-2 in 2006 and successfully used light to activate neurons and control the movements of mouse whiskers. The same year, he used the technique to wake sleeping mice by manipulating a recently discovered type of nerve cell that was suspected to control wakefulness. His team also studied the brains of mice as they experienced fear, and noted which nerve cells appeared to form memory. When they later reactivated these nerve cells, the mice showed signs of fear, despite not being in danger at the time.
What kind of therapies are being developed based on this field?
There are ongoing clinical trials on restoring vision in people who have become blind due to *retinitis pigmentosa*, a disease that destroys the eye’s rods and cones. Using special glasses emitting light, the person was able to discern and grasp objects on a table. There are also hopes that optogenetics could improve cochlear implants. Currently, these implants stimulate the auditory nerve using electricity.

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Letter No.: 1637/V-14/185
Dated: 25.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of "Survey design, supply, laying, testing, commissioning and shifting of 1100 mm dia M.S. Rising main (12mm thick) at Bichpuri, Nagar Nigam, Agra area, District, Agra including all associated and appurtenant works on turnkey basis. The scope of work shall include survey, design, supply, laying/shifting, testing commissioning and 03 months trial run period and successfully handing over of the completed works to the concerned authority/ULB/O&M Agency including fulfillment of all contractual obligation during the defect liability period." are invited in two bid system on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <https://etender.up.nic.in> and U.P. J.N. (Urban) website www.jn.upscd.gov.in for download from dated 05.10.2026 from 05:00 PM. Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated 15.10.2026 at 12:30 PM in undersigned office. E-bids can be submitted till 04.11.2026 up to 05:00 PM and technical bid shall be opened on 05.11.2026 at 12:30 PM in the office of undersigned in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender cost is Rs. 10,000.00 + GST @ 18% for tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> and U.P.J.N.(Urban) website www.jn.upscd.gov.in.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,MD SHARIQ RAZA, S/o- Mohammad Shamim Address- 1231,first floor gali mehal sarai punjabi phatak ballimaran north Delhi Delhi,110006, have changed my name to Mustafa Raza. 0040881837-9

I,DEVDUIT,S/O-POORAN LAL, R/O-A-19/2,GATE NO 2, ASHUTOSH CITY,PILIBHIT BYPASS ROAD,BAREILLY UTTAR PRADESH 243122 , HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO DEVDUIT GANGWAR FOR ALL PURPOSES 0040881831-10

I,AKASH GUPTA S/O MANOJ GUPTA R/O 530/20 JHAJJAR-ROAD BAHADURGARH JHAJJAR HARYANA-124507. HAVE CHANGED MY CHILD NAME PALAK BANSAL TO PALAK. 0040881833-7

I, Ashok S/O Bhagat Ram,R/O House no-F-542,Dakhshin Puri Dr.Ambedkar Nagar,New Delhi-110062,Have changed my name to ASHOK KUMAR Permanently 0040881843-4

I,Meera Kumar,W/o-Sh.Harendra Singh,R/O-FF.1, Yadu Tower,Chiranjiu Vihar, Ghaziabad UP,That I have changed my minor son name Pragyan Bhatti to Krishunk Bhatti,for all purposes. Both name belongs to one and same person. 0040881837-2

I,KABIRAN,W/O-MUJAHIR KHAN,R/O-35,BAGICHI BHARGAV LANE,BOLWWARD ROAD,TIS HAZAR,CIVIL LINES,DELHI-110054,have changed my name to KABERAN BEGUM,W/O MUJAHIR KHAN,for all future purposes 0040881831-3

I,SANA W/O GANGA PRASAD R/O - D-391, MADIPUR COLONY, PASCHIM VIHAR, DELHI - 110063,have changed my name to SHALINI 0040881713-1

I,Prem Kishore, S/o-Ram Dhan,R/O-House no 10,Block-B,Vikas Vihar,Vikas Nagar, Uttam Nagar,Delhi-110059, have changed my name Prem Kishor for all Purposes. 0040881834-5

I, Parminder Kaur chandhok w/o Avtar Singh, R/O B - 144 Jangpura B New Delhi-110014, have changed my name to Parminder kaur 0071063974-1

I Jarnail Singh Sahota s/o Sardool Singh r/o YB-369, NTPC Anandam SAS Ltd., Pocket-P6, NOIDA-201315 have changed my name to Jarnail Singh. 0040881776-1

I, Shahadat S/o Mohd Wasim R/o 188, Village Hirdaypur, Hapur, Uttar Pradesh-245101, have changed my name to Shahadat Khan. 0040881832-2

I,DIVYA GARG,W/O ROHIT GARG R/O H.NO-7 RAJ NAGAR PITAMPURA DELHI -110034, HAVE CHANGE MY CHILD NEMA SHINAYA GARG TO SHANAYA GARG 0040881833-9

I,Nirmolak Singh Saini S/o Ram Prakash Singh R/o EH-07, Flat No -504, TDI Espani, Opposite Juraski Park, GT Road, Sonipat, Haryana -131001, have changed my name to Nirmolak Singh permanently. 0040881725-1

I,Mohammad ADIB,S/o,Mohammad Abid Ansari,R/O.2468,Haveli Mahabat khan Bazar Chitli Qabar, Jama Masjid, Delhi-110006, have changed my to MOHAMMAD ADEEB ANSARI permanently 0040881843-6

I Sanoj Kumar Choudhari S/o Shiv Kumar Chaudhari R/o RZ - 6 Gali no 11 Left side Tughlakabad Extn Delhi 110019 Have Changed my name to Sanoj Kumar Choudhary 0040881837-4

I, SANTOSH KUMAR, S/o- DAULAT RAM KALRA, R/O- D-4, F/F, KHANPUR EXTN., NEW DELHI-110062, have changed my name to SANTOSH KUMAR KALRA, for all purposes. Both name are the same and one person i.e. me. 0040881847-8

I,MOHD SALMAN,S/O- AYYUB,R/o-House No-D-10,Block-D, Sector-55,Noida,District Gautam Buddha Nagar,UTTAR PRADESH -201307,have changed the name of my minor Son MOHAMMAD AAMAD aged 5years and He shall hereafter be known as AAMAD KHAN. 0040881831-5

I, Mohd Shehbaz R/o B-72/14, Mandir Wali Gali, North Ghonda, Delhi 110053 in my school documents my father's name is wrongly mentioned as SHEIKH NASIR, however correct name is MD NASIR. 0040881705-3

I,hitherto known as Komal,W/O Varun Gupta,R/O C-132,Third Floor,Vikas puri Delhi-110018,I Have Changed My Name From Komal To Komal Mittal All Future purposes 0040881834-7

I, Jagat Pal S/o of Chanderpall, resident of Sec 72 Near Kuda Neemka, Faridabad, Haryanaa 121004 do hereby that I have changed my son's name from Nishant to Nishant Nagar and hereforth he shall be known as Nishant Nagar in all purpose. 0050299038-1

I Ashwini Kumar S/O Ved Prakash R/o 519, Arun Vihar, Sec-28,Noida, G.B.Nagar, U.P.-201301 have changed my name to Ashwini Sharma for all future purpose. 0040881843-2

I,REVANSHI,D/O SHRI NAVEEN KUMAR,R/O.352/E J N U MUNIRKA VILLAGE,NEW DELHI-110067,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND,SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS REVANSHI MUDGAL 0040881843-8

I, MEHMUDA W/O ABDUL HAKIM, R/O HOUSE NO-421, A-4 BLOCK, SULTAN PURI, DELHI-110086 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM MEHMUDA TO MAHMOODA 0071063991-1

I,Dinesh Kumar,S/o-Kundan Lal,R/O 58-B,Munirka Village,South West Delhi,Delhi-110067,have changed my name and,shall hereafter be known as Dinesh Kumar Tokas. 0040881847-2

I,Pushpander Kumar S/o Rameshwar Chandra R/o Houae No.74,Pocket-B-3, Sector-11,Rohini Delhi-110085,have changed my name to PUSHPENDER KUMAR RASTOGI 0040881832-4

I,NEERAJ,W/O-PANKAJ SINGH,R/O-HOUSE NO-79, BLOCK -C2,YAMUNA VIHAR, NORTH EAST DELHI 110053 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO NEERAJ KUMARI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040881833-11

I, Muntajib S/O Abdul Aziz R/-667, GALI NAL BANDAN, HAMILTON ROAD,KASHMERE GATE, North Delhi, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to Mohd. Muntajib for all future Purposes. 0071063979-1

I SANJAY PAHOJA S/O NARAIN DAS POHOJA R/O-H.NO-80 3RD.FLOOR, SHANTI VIHAR KARKARDOOMA DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SANJAY POHOJA 0040881837-6

I,Rahim Ahmad S/o Basir Ahmed R/o H.No-937 Sector-15 Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, U.P-201012,have changed my name to Raheem Ahmed and my correct date of birth is 10.04.1983. 0040881831-7

I,AKASH/AKASH BANSAL S/O MANOJ GUPTA R/O 530/20 JHAJJAR ROAD BAHADURGARH JHAJJAR HARYANA-124507,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AKASH GUPTA. 0040881833-4

I, Neetu Rajput D/o late Ramesh Chander Rajput RZB17, Mahavir Vihar, Sector1 Dwarka, New Delhi 110045 have changed my name from KUMARI NITU to NEETU RAJPUT vide Affidavit dated 18/09/2026 at new delhi 0071063943-1

I Ashish Sharma W/O Ashwini Sharma R/O 519,Arun Vihar,Sec- 28,Noida,G.B.Nagar,U.P.-201301 have changed my name to Ashish Vasishtt for all future purposes. 0040881843-1

I,Mohd. Hashim,S/o-Zaheer Hassan R/o,R-121 Gali No.7,Joga Bai Extension Jamia Nagar,okhla, New Delhi-110025,have change my minor Daughter's name Ayesha Hashim to Ayesha,for all future purposes 0040881843-10

I, P. Thara Solanky, W/o Pradeep Kumar Solanky, R/o 42793, Ansari Road, Darya Ganj, New Delhi, do hereby solemnly declare that P. Thara (as per Voter Card) and P. Thara Solanky are one and the same Woman and My Father name is N.P. Pallai (as per Voter Card) and Purushothaman Pillai are one and the same man. Henceforth, I have changed our names from P. Thara to P. Thara Solanky and my father name N.P. Pallai to Purushothaman Pillai for all future purposes. 0040881803-1

I,Pankaj Kumar Chawla,S/o-Subhash Chandra Chawla resident of,64/ 54-55,first floor sector 11,Rohini Delhi 85,have changed my name to Pankaj Chawla 0040881847-4

I,VIMLA DEVI,W/O Dulare R/O House No.WZ -1,Bindapur, Delhi-110059, Have changed my name to INDERKALI , in future for all purposes. 0040881832-6

I,Swati Bhatia,W/o-Shri Ram Ranawat,R/O-H.No-506,2nd Floor,Saraswati Vihar,Housing Board,Chakkarpur, Gurugram, Haryana-122002, have changed my name to Swati Ranawat for all Purposes. 0040881834-2

I, Prakriti Jaiswal D/o Rakesh Jaiswal, R/O D-18, Sudershan Park, Delhi-110015, Inform that Prakriti Jaiswal & Suhani Jaiswal both are one & the same person. 0040881724-1

I,HRIDAY NARAYAN SAH, S/O RAM BRIKSH SAH R/O KH.No 6/9 Swaroop Nagar, Delhi, changed my name from HRIDAY NARAYAN to HRIDAY NARAYAN SAH 0040881755-1

I, Jai Singh Bansali S/o J.L. Bhsansli R/o-C-70, Vivek Vihar, Phase-1 ,East Delhi-110095 have changed my name to Jai Singh Bhsansli. 0040881837-8

I,Puja Kumari,W/O-Sh.Jitendra Sharma,R/O-presently residing at RZ1-54,West SagarPur,South West Delhi-110046.I POOJA SHARMA mother of ARCHNA SHARMA KUMARI,which is wrongly mentioned in all documents and the correct name is ARCHNA KUMARI & PUJA Kumari,for all the future purpose. 0040881831-9

It is for general information that I,PUNEET MALIK,S/o-Ram Lal Malik R/o 51,3rd FLOOR,TAGORE PARK,Delhi-110009, declare that name of my minor son has been wrongly written as AARUSH P.MALIK in my minor son name as AARUSH PUNEET MALIK,aged 15 years in his school records.The actual name of my minor son is AARUSH PUNEET MALIK,which may be amended accordingly. 0040881847-5

I,ANNU THAKRAN W/O SUMIT THAKRAN R/O 189-190 3RD-FLOOR PCKET-2 SECTOR-25 ROHINI DELHI-110085,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANNU. 0040881833-6

I Neha W/O Dheeraj R/O House No-172/9 Mugalpur Gohana. District Sonipat Haryana-131301 Have Changed My Name To Neha Rani Permanently 0040881843-3

I,Anil Chawla,s/o-Hans Raj chawla,R/o-5/5,Ground floor,Indira Vikas colony,vtc Dr.Mukherjee Nagar,So District north West Delhi, Delhi - 110009,have changed my name from ,Anil chawla to Anil Kumar chawla. 0040881837-1

I,MITHLESH W/o Parvinder Kumar R/o 16/731-H, Street-11, Military Rd,Bapa Nagar,Karol Bagh,New Delhi-110005, changed my name to MAMTA. 0040881831-2

I,Bhupinder Bais S/o Harphool Singh R/o-C-II,105 Pushpanjali Enclave Delhi-110092,have changed my name to Bhupinder Pal Singh Permanently. 0040881832-8

I,Raju,S/O-Puran Lal R/o D - 96,Ground Floor,South City - 2,Sector -49,Gurgaon (Haryana)-122018,have changed my name to Raju Kumar for all Purposes. 0071063941-1

I,Mrs Surya Yadav W/o IC 38293A Col OS Yadav, resident of Street F-7.1, Plot No-01 (GF), Sec-82, Vatika INXT, Gurugram, Haryana-122012, have changed my name from Surya Yadav to Surya Gonsalves Yadav. 0071063972-1

I,AKANKSHA SETYA KUMAR,R/O-O-GAURAV KUMAR,R/O-B-3/73,Third Floor Block-B3,Paschim Vihar,Delhi-110063,have changed my name to AKANKSHA SETYA. 0040881837-10

I,RAJ SINGH MANN S/O HAZARI LAL MANN R/O HOUSE NO-454,PEHLAD PUR BANGAR, DELHI-110042,have changed my name to RAJ SINGH 0040881833-2

I, Nitya D/o Sovit Vij R/o C-94, S-4, Ramprastha, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201011, have changed my name to Nitya Vij. 0040881832-1

I,AKASH GUPTA S/O MANOJ GUPTA R/O 530/20 JHAJJAR ROAD BAHADURGARH JHAJJAR HARYANA-124507. HAVE CHANGED MY CHILD NAME HAZEL BANSAL TO HAZEL. 0040881833-8

I Ranveer Singh Khacharia R/O P/O-Dhingpur, Dist-Sikar, Rajasthan-332601 have changed my daughter's name from AKSHITA to AKSHITA CHOUDHARY vide Affidavit Dated 05/10/2026 before NCT DELHI. 0040881715-1

I,Mohammad Abid,S/o,Mohammad Hanif Ansari,R/O.2468,Haveli Mahabat khan Bazar Chitli Qabar,Jama Masjid,Delhi-110006,have changed my to MOHAMMAD ABID ANSARI permanently 0040881843-5

I,Harish Kumar Arora,S/o Sh.Lila Krishan,R/O H.No.75-LA,New Colony,Gurugram, Haryana-122001,That my name is Harish Kumar Arora and Harish are one and the same person. 0040881837-3

I,MUZAHIR KHAN,S/O-FATEH MOHAMMAD,R/o 35,BAGICHI BHARGAV LANE,BOLWWARD ROAD,TIS HAZAR,CIVIL LINES, DELHI-110054,have changed my name to MUJAHIR KHAN S/O,FATEH MOHAMMAD, for all future Purposes. 0040881831-4

I,Ankush Malhotra,S/o Vinod Kumar Malhotra R/o 107 B Deep Enclave Phase-3 Ashok Vihar Delhi-110052,have changed my,name to Ankush Kausalh. 0040881833-1

I Sidharth Vaid S/O Prithvi Raj R/O 158, New Four Storey, Vishal Enclave, Tagore Garden, New Delhi - 110027 Changed My Name To Siddharth Vaid. 0040881705-1

I,Anil Kapoor, S/o Shri Hari Ram,R/o C-274/4,Flat No-12,Arjun Nagar,Sardfajjung Enclave, New Delhi-110029 have changed my name to Anil Kumar Kapoor. 0040881834-6

Ihitherto known as Rakesh Kumar S/o Ayodhya Bind residing at Rupaiitha, Kargahar, Rohtas, Bihar- 821107 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Javahir Bind. 0071063978-1

I, Kapil Kumar R/o 30/7 Jagdamba Enclave Haibatpur Greater Noida Uttar Pradesh 201009 have changed my minor son's name from Ayan Singh to Ayansh Singh. 0040881797-1

I, SUDHA KHURANA D/o Sh. MANOHAR LAL KHURANA, R/o C2/309, Janak Puri, New Delhi-110058,have changed my name to SUDHA MIGLANI. 0040881832-3

I,ADITYA,S/O-DESH RAJ,R/O-9,NARAIN PUR (138) PO: SAHARANWAS DIST REWARI HARYANA 123401 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO ADITYA BHATIA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040881833-10

I,Raayna Arora,D/O-Vanddna Bhargave,R/O H.No-303,3rd Floor Pragati Hills,Plot no-14 Sec -47 Gurgaon-122001, have changed my name to Rayna Arora,for all future purposes. 0040881847-1

I,MANSI SAGAR w/o Chand Singh, H.No-C-48, BAPU PARK Kotla Mubarakpur Lodhi Road South DELHI-110003, have changed my name to MANSI SINGH 0040881831-1

I, Rajender Aggarwal, S/o Ram Prasad, R/o-126, Gagan Vihar, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051, have changed my name to Rajinder Prasad, for all purposes. Rajinder Prasad and Rajender Aggarwal is one and same person i.e. me. 0040881749-1

I,Manjusrree Roy Burman,W/O Shri Roop Darshan Pandey,R/o 15/10 IInd floor, B-Block Kalkaji, New Delhi - 110019 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Manjusrree Pandey. 0040881843-7

I SARITA PAHUJA W/O SANJAY POHOJA R/O-H.NO-80 3RD. FLOOR, SHANTI VIHAR KARKARDOOMA DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SARITA POHOJA 0040881837-5

I,Neha Bansal W/O Rakesh Kansal R/O E-5/8, First Floor, Sector-16,Rohini, Delhi-110089,have Changed my name to Neha Kansal. 0040881833-3

I, ASHISH SINGH S/O ANIL KUMAR SINGH R/O H.NO-D/251, STREET NO-5, WEST VINOD NAGAR, DELHI, SHAKARPUR, EAST DELHI, DELHI- 110092 have changed the name of my minor Son from THAKUR SAMRATH SINGH to SAMRAT SINGH. 0071063941-1

I,MOHD SALEEM,S/O-MOHD AYYUB KHAN,R/O- H NO-E-19, STREET NO-1,SHASTRI PARK, PO SEELAMPUR DIST,NORTH EAST DELHI-110053,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO MOHAMMAD SALEEM,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040881834-8

I, Kirti Sharma, W/o Vikas Kumar Rawat and D/o Sita Ram, R/o C-88A, Gali No. 3, C-Block, Mukund Vihar, Karawal Nagar, Delhi-110094, do hereby solemnly declare that Kirti Sharma and Kirti Rawat are one and the same Woman. Henceforth, I have changed my name from Kirti Sharma to Kirti Rawat for all future purposes. 0040881808-1

I,Karan Singh Arora,S/o-Randeep Singh Arora,R/O,F-808 8th Floor,Gurga Acropolis AG Road SUS,Pune City,PO:Armament, Pune Maharashtra-411021 have changed my name to Karan Singh 0040881847-3

I,KASHEV KUMAR,S/o Yash Pal Ahuja R/o B-8,House No.105 Sector-4,Westend Apartment Rohini Delhi-110085 have changed my name to KESHAV KUMAR AHUJA. 0040881832-5

I,MOHAMMAD ARIF HUSSAIN,S/O-MOHD IMTIYAZ HUSSAIN, R/O- H NO-12A/25-D, STREET NO-2, NEAR ZEENAT MAHAL SCHOOL, VIJAY MOHALLA , MAUJIPUR ,NORTH EAST DELHI 110053 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO MOHD ARIF HUSSAIN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE 0040881834-1

I, Jagdish Arora / Jagdish Sadana S/o Vir Bhan R/o 15/26, Subhash Nagar, Delhi-110027 have changed my name to JAGDISH KUMAR 0040881720-1

I Sourav S/o Pawan Kumar R/O C-73 Shri Chand Park, Matiyala, West Delhi, Delhi - 110059, have changed my name to Sourav Dhawan 0071063980-1

It is for general information that I,Harvinder Sharma,S/o Late Sat Pal Sharma, Residing at 383/18, Street No.17,East Azad Nagar,Krishna Nagar, East Delhi-110051, declare that name of mine and my wife has been wrongly written as Harvinder and Rakhi in my minor son name Ritwik Sharma Aged- 17years,in his Educational Documents. The actual name of mine and my wife are Harvinder Sharma and Rakhi Sharma,respectively, which may be amended accordingly. 0040881837-7

I Ruchi Chaudhary W/o Mahendra Pal Singh R/O F-4 First Floor 3/911, Sector-3 Vasundhara Ghaziabad U.P- 201012 have changed my name to,Ruchi. 0040881831-8

I,NEETU/NEETU BANSAL W/O AKASH GUPTA R/O 530/20 JHAJJAR ROAD BAHADURGARH JHAJJAR HARYANA-124507. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NEETU GUPTA. 0040881833-5

I, 15421009H(HAV/AA) WAGHMARE SACHIN MANOHER, Permanent R/O Village- Amrutnagar, PO- Gulewadri, Tehsil- Sangamner, District- Ahmednagar, Maharashtra- 422605, declare that name of my mother has been wrongly written as MALEN BAI in my service records. The correct name of my mother is MALAN MANOHAR WAGHMARE, mentioned in all other documents, amend accordingly vide affidavit IN- DL15765929823462Y, dated 05/10/2026, before Notary, Advocate: Ajay Massey, Regd.No.-54075, New Delhi. 0071063947-1

I,RUDRAKSH,S/O-SHRI NAVEEN KUMAR,R/O-352/E4,J N U.MUNIRKA VILLAGE NEW DELHI -110067 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known RUDRAKSH MUDGAL 0040881843-9

I Pushpa Jindal/Pushpa Garg D/o-Dayanand Jindal R/o-RZ-A-40, Pratap Garden,Uttam Nagar,Delhi-110059 have-changed my name after-marriage to Poonam Devi W/o-Sandeep Kumar permanently. 0040881831-6

I,Abhishek Kumar Dangra,S/o Sanjay Dangra,R/o-KR-303, Agrasen Apartments, 66 I-P Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-110092 have changed my name to Abhishek Dangra. 0040881832-7

I,Rajesh Chand Gothia,S/o-Om Prakash Chand,R/o,G-29/14-15, Sector-3,Rohini, Delhi-110085,have changed my name Rajesh Kumar Chandgotthia for all Purposes. 0040881834-3

I, Sumit Vinayak alias Sumit Kumar Vinayak S/o. Suresh Kumar Vinayak R/o. Flat No. 1903, Tower-21, Sector-37D, Gurgaon, Haryana have changed my name to Sumit K Vinayak 0040881717-1

I,Romita Bansali D/O, Jaisingh Bhsansli, W/O, Himanshu Gandhi, R/O C- 70,Vivek Vihar Phase-1, Delhi-110095 Have Changed My Name To Romita Bhsansli. 0040881681-8

LOST & FOUND

LOST Original SALE DEED of my Property No.EA-127, FIRST FLOOR INDERPURI, NEW DELHI Vide Doc.No-9482,Book.no.1 Vol no.1587,Pg-95-101,Dt.29-09-2008, REGISTRAR-IX, New Delhi, I,have not mortgaged said deed with any Bank/ Financial Institution. Finder kindly contact Ranjit Kaur at above address. 0040881832-10

I,Neerja Verma,W/O-Anil kr. Vema,R/O-E-90,WGF,Amar Colony,ND-24,my original Property Paper's part of chain of,300 yards,plot,which is situated in Dankaur have fallen somewhere.Wholes Police Complaint.No.LR.No.2623898/2 026 is registered.Finder contact to the above address.Using this would be illegal. Contact no-9811467772 0040881837-11

I, Sudhir chawla,S/o Late Shri J.N.Chawla, R/O A2/51, KRISHNA NAGAR,DELHI,LOST MY D.D.A,RELATED DOCUMENTS LIKE ALLOTMENT CUM DEMAND-LETTER, ETC. founder plz contact Above address mob-9873379896 0040881716-1

I, Abhishek Jain S/o Vijay Kumar Jain R/o B83, Sector XJ1 Greater Noida U.P I have lost my DRIVING LICENCE NO. (UP1620000031422), ADHAR & PAN CARD finder may please send these to my above address. Any use of any of the IDs/Document will be treated as illegal & punishable. 0071063950-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
The General Public is hereby informed that my client Sh. Dharminder Kumar S/o Late Shri Ran Nath Rao D-1458, Tagore Garden Extension, New Delhi-110027 has severed all his relations with his daughter namely Smt. Akansha Mehra W/o Sunny Mehra R/o WZ-45, Plot No 82, Mangal Bazar Road, Vishnu Garden, Delhi-110018 due to her habitual ill-treatment of her father. My above named client has also disowned and debarred his said daughter from all his moveable and immovable properties. Anybody dealing with Smt. Akansha Mehra W/o Sunny Mehra will do so at his/her/their own risk and responsibilities and my client will not be responsible, directly or indirectly, for any act, deed or dealings, whether financial or social, done by Smt. Akansha Mehra W/o Sunny Mehra. Sd/- Akash Anand Advocate Ch. No. 455, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that my client Sh. Ransh Chand Aggarwal S/o Late Sh. San Ram R/o H.No.109, Upper Ground Floor, Kewal Park, Azadpur, Delhi has purchased the half-stall property adjacent to 109 Sq. Yds situated in Khasra No. 1019/9/2 in Village Burari, Aboli Kuan as C-Block, Gali No.29, West Kamal Vihar, Burari, Delhi-110018 from Sh. Ajay S/o Sh. Ram Lal R/o D-130, Block D, Agar Nagar, From Nagri-II, Kirti, Sulekha Nagar, Delhi-110086 and Sh. Pawan Kumar S/o. San Ram Lal R/o Khara No.97/12, Ground Floor, Sector No.15, Block-F, Tomar Colony, Barari, Delhi-110084 on 19/09/2026. Sh. Ransh Chand Aggarwal is absolute owner and in settled and exclusive possession of the aforementioned property. No person has any interest on the said property or any part thereof, by way of Sale, exchange, mortgage, gift, trust, inheritance, bequest, possession, lease, lien, easement or otherwise. Sd/- MAYANK YADAV Advocate Ch. No. 567, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, BRENDERI AWANA, W/o, MAHESH AWANA, resident of House No. 27-32, Meethapur Extension, Badarpur, New Delhi-110044 do hereby inform the general public that my name has been incorrectly mentioned as "BIRENDRI AWANA" in my Passport bearing Passport No. P279524. That the aforesaid spelling, "BIRENDRI AWANA" appearing in my Passport is an inadvertent/clerical error. My correct and actual name is "BIRENDERI AWANA". It is further declared that my correct name "BIRENDERI AWANA" is already duly mentioned in my Aadhaar Card and PAN Card and other relevant documents. I hereby declare that "BIRENDRI AWANA" and "BIRENDERI AWANA" refer to one and the same person, i.e., myself, and there is no difference in identity between the two names. All concerned authorities, departments, institutions and members of the public are hereby requested to take note of the aforesaid declaration and treat BirenderiAwana as my correct name for all purposes. BIRENDERI AWANA W/o: MAHESH AWANA From MAHESH AWANA

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, MAHESH AWANA, S/o Late Shri Gopi Chand Awana, resident of House No. 27-32, Meethapur Extension, Badarpur, New Delhi-110044, hereby give public notice that my correct and actual name is MAHESH AWANA, as appearing in my Aadhaar Card, PAN Card and other official documents. It is hereby declared that my name has been inadvertently/incorrectly mentioned as "MAHESH KUMAR AWANA" in my Passport records. I hereby declare that "MAHESH AWANA" and "MAHESH KUMAR AWANA" refer to one and the same person, i.e., myself, and there is no difference in identity between the two names. All concerned authorities, departments, institutions and members of the public are hereby requested to take note of the aforesaid declaration and treat MAHESH AWANA as my correct name for all purposes. From MAHESH AWANA

PUBLIC NOTICE
My client Rajesh S/o Sh. Rakhamram R/o 40, Khurampur, Kasampur, Meerut Cantt, Uttar Pradesh-250001 severed all relations and debar his son Aman from entire moveable / immovable properties due to his misconduct, arrogant and hostile behaviour. My client shall not be responsible for his any acts resulting into any complaint/case, debts and deeds in future. Aman Giri (Advocate) Office: 4/112, Rama Market, Saraswati Vihar Delhi.

**GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA**

Sl. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK/NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSGAD YAMUNANAGAR	CONSTRUCTION OF VARIOUS LINK ROADS IN THE NOTIFIED AREA OF MARKET COMMITTEE RAGHUR IN RAGHUR CONSTITUENCY (GROUP-1) ROAD ID 12763, 12765, 12767, 12776 AND 1277A IN DISTT. YAMUNANAGAR	24/09/2026 30.10.2026	3,64,58,296/-	http://tenders.hry.nic.in	927010001 ncnss2323@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in **No. 49905/HRY**

**कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम, रतलाम**

01, कालिंज रोड, रतलाम (Pin-457001)
Email- commratlam@mpurban.gov.in | Contact:07412-270555 | Website- www.rmcratlam.in | ULB Code-802222

क्रमांक/67/स्व.भा.वि./2026

प्रथम विविधा आलंत्रण

रतलाम, दिनांक 30/09/2026

नगर पालिक निगम, रतलाम में सार्वजनिक निजी जनभागीदारी मोड के आधार पर निम्नांकित निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसके चयन करने हेतु mptenders.gov.in के माध्यम से अवलोकित करें। कार्य का विवरण निम्नानुसार है।

क्र. ऑन लाईन निविदा क्र.	कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की समाप्ति एवं लागत	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य एवं EMD	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
1 2026- UAD- 539734	Selection of Concessionaire for The Work of Development of A Municipal Solid Waste Processing Facility in Design Built Finance Operate and Transfer (On PPP Model) Which Include Waste to Compressed Bio-Gas Plant and MRF Facility at Julwaniya Municipal Solid Waste Processing Plant Hatlam for Municipal Corporation, Hatlam on A Public Private Partnership Basis With 20 Years Operation and Maintenance. सार्वजनिक निजी जनभागीदारी (PPP) मोड के आधार पर नगर पालिक निगम रतलाम मध्यप्रदेश के जुलवानिया ठोस अपशिष्ट प्रसंस्करण केंद्र पर प्रतिविनि निकलने वाले नगरिय ठोस अपशिष्ट के प्रसंस्करण किये जाने हेतु कम्प्रेस्ड बायो गैस संयंत्र एवं आर. एफ. पी.स्ट सुविधा का विकास कार्य एवं इसका 20 वर्ष की अवधि के लिये संचालन एवं संभक्षण कार्य के निविदा कोषयन्त्र का चयन। (कार्य से संबंधित विस्तृत विवरण संलग्न विस्तृत कार्य योजना एवं आर एफ.पी. अनुसार) नोट:- कार्य के नाम की विवरण की भाषा हिन्दी व अंग्रेजी में किसी भी प्रकार की विसंगति होने पर अंग्रेजी भाषा के विवरण को अंतिम माना जाएगा।	1- अनुबंध दिनांक से 21 माह प्लॉट स्थापना से संबंधित समस्त कार्य एवं तद उपरांत 20 वर्ष (संचालन/संभारण) (240 माह) 2- 20,61,56,413	1-50,000/- 2-10,30,782/-	1-30/10/2026 17:00

नोट - निविदा से संबंधित किसी प्रकार के संशोधन का प्रकाशन ऑनलाइन <https://mptenders.gov.in> की वेब साईट पर ही किया जाएगा, पृथक से समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित नहीं किया जाएगा।

नौडल अधिकारी
स्वच्छ भारत मिशन नगर पालिक निगम, रतलाम

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
PWD(R&B) DIVISION VIJAYPUR
ABBREVIATED NOTICE INVITING TENDER
e-NIT No. 60 of 2026-27 Dated. 05-10-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works

S. No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost of Work (in Lacs)	Cost of Tender Doc. (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Time allowed for completion	Class of Contractor
1	Const. of ACR at Govt. Middle School Sanger and Const. of Boundary Wall at Govt. Middle School Sanger.	18.02	600	2% of Adv. Cost	6 Months (incl. all rainy days)	"A, B & C"
2	Const. of road from main road village Sanger to ST Mohalla, Pyt. Purmandal. (2 nd Call)	58.20	1500	2% of Adv. Cost	06 Months (incl. all rainy days)	"A"

Position of AAA :- Accorded
Position of T.S :- Sanctioned
Project Authority :- S.No. 01 Under SAMAGRA Shiksha and S.No. 02 Under Road Sector (New Works) Capex Budget 2026-27.

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	05-10-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	



GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
HIGHWAYS DEPARTMENT
Construction & Maintenance Circle, Dharmapuri.

Tender Notice
Tender Notice No. 1 /2026-2027 / SDO /Dated: 30.09.2026.

For and on behalf of the Governor of Tamilnadu Two Cover System of Percentage tender through online only will be received upto **10.11.2026** 11.00 hours (as per system server clock) by the Superintending Engineer (H), Construction & Maintenance Dharmapuri Circle under the Scheme **CRIDP (CMRDP)** for the year **2026-2027** – “Widening from Two Lane to Four Lane and Strengthening at Km 0/0 4/0 of Malur Hosur Adhiyamankottai Road including CD Works (SH-17)” in Hosur (H) Construction & Maintenance Division.

Details of works, approximate value of works, EMD, availability of tender documents and all other details are available from **09.10.2026** onwards in the Government web site <http://tntenders.gov.in>. If any changes / Corrections etc in the tender, it will be published on the above website only.

Superintending Engineer (H),
Construction & Maintenance Circle,
Dharmapuri

DIPR/ 3020 /Tender/2026

ICAR - Indian Institute Of Soil Science			
Nubagh, Berasia Road, Bhopal - 462 038 (M.P.) Tel. No. (0753)273775 FAX:8379807374223 (Ext. No. 101 & 224) Fax. No. (0755) 2733310			
TENDER NOTICE			
Online Bids are being invited for purchase of instruments through GeM portal. The details of bids are also available on Institute website https://iiss.res.in .			
Sl. no.	Name of Instrument	Bid no./Date	Due Date
01.	Flow Injection Analyzer	GEM/2026/B/8006487 Dated 17-09-2026	08-10-2026
02.	High Performance Liquid Chromatography (HPLC)	GEM/2026/B/8060409 Dated 23-09-2026	14-10-2026
03.	Scanning Electron Microscope (SEM)	GEM/2026/B/8023175 Dated 24-09-2026	15-10-2026
04.	BET Surface Area and porosity Analyzer	GEM/2026/B/8060550 Dated 28-09-2026	19-10-2026
05.	Nanoparticle Tracking Analyzer (NTA/PTA)	GEM/2026/B/8060536 Dated 29-09-2026	20-10-2026
06.	Nanoparticle Size & Zeta Potential Analyser	GEM/2026/B/8061581 Dated 29-09-2026	20-10-2026
07.	Microwave Digestion System	GEM/2026/B/8071718 Dated 30-09-2026	22-10-2026
Administrative Officer			



ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL
SADAR BAZAR ROAD, DELHI CANTT-110010
www.apsdelhicantt.com

TENDER NOTICE

Sealed tenders are invited from reputed firms having professional expertise and experience in providing Security Services at Army Public School, Delhi Cantt. Tender Forms/RFPs along with detailed specifications and terms & conditions may be downloaded from the school website. The duly completed Tender Form/RFP, in all respects, must be submitted to Army Public School, Delhi Cantt by 21 Oct 2026 at 1030 hrs, along with the prescribed DD towards Tender Form Fee and EMD, as specified in the RFP, in favour of Army Public School, Delhi Cantt. For any queries, please contact Army Public School, Delhi Cantt at 25693777 / 25692720.

Presiding Officer



COTTON UNIVERSITY
Panbazar, Guwahati- 781001

Notice Inviting Bids
“ NIB No. CU/S&P/2026/12 Dt. Oct 05, 2026 ”

Bids in sealed cover are invited from OEMS or authorized dealers/ suppliers/vendors or business partners in two bid system for “**Supply, Installation and Commissioning of Observation based and App enabled Hazard Advisory System**”.

The last date of bid submission is October 30, 2026. For details, please visit www.cottonuniversity.ac.in

DIPR/CF/IXP/17946-OCT-26

S/d, Registrar./i/c



NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

The Divisional Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work:

Name of work with its location	Supplying and stacking, loading and unloading of 31240 Cum of 65 mm gauge machine-crushed hard stone ballast conforming to Railway Specification IS/RDSO-GE/0001:2023 (February 2023) and latest correction slips, from Ramkumarpura mining area, Village Ramkumarpura, Tehsil Khetri, District Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan, or Khanak mining area (under the control of HSIIDC), Tehsil Tosham, District Bhiwani, Haryana, or any other mining source producing similar quality machine crushed hard stone ballast as above, at Sub Depot No. 2 in Jind Ballast Depot under DEN/Track/DLI. (NIT-08-26-27-WC)
Approx Cost of work	(1) Rs.6,56,93,301.32/-
Earnest Money	(1) Rs.13,13,900.00/-
Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is Date-14/10/2026 at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is Date-28/10/2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Website particulars, published e-tender notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.reps.gov.in

No. - 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-08-26-27WC
Dated: 05/10/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

3446/2026

TENDER NOTICE

E-tenders are invited from interested and eligible Cooperative Labour & Construction Societies and other contractors/agencies for providing: Cleaning of Premises and Security Services at Pt. Neki Ram Sharma Govt. College, Rohtak, for a period of one year, subject to approval/sanction of the competent authority and availability of budget/grant.

The tenderer must fulfil all eligibility conditions prescribed in the Tender Document and applicable Government rules.

IMPORTANT DATES

Particular	Date/Time
- Date of Issue of Tender	05/10/2026 09.00 Hrs
- Date of Availability of Tender Document/ Sale Start Date	12/10/2026 09.00 Hrs to 26/10/2026 16.00 Hrs
- Last Date for Submission of Tender	26/10/2026 15.00 Hrs
- Bid Opening Date	28/10/2026 13.00 Hrs
- Pre-Bid Meeting	19/10/2026 at 12:30 PM
-Venue	Principal's office, Pt. Neki Ram Sharma Govt. College, Rohtak

Note: -

- **Tender Document Cost:** ₹1000/- (Non-refundable) and ₹1000/- plus GST as Processing fees
- **Earnest Money Deposit (EMD):** ₹25,000/- (Refundable), subject to applicable Government procurement rules.

The Principal, Pt Neki Ram Sharma Govt. college Rohtak reserve the right to accept and reject any all tenders without assigning any reason.

Sd/-
Principal
Pt. NRS Govt College
Rohtak

No. 49897/HRV



Maha Mumbai Metro
Operation Corporation

MAHA MUMBAI METRO
OPERATION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Maharashtra PSU)

4th Floor, NaMTTRI Building, Adjoining New MMRDA Building, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051.
Website : <https://mmrda.maharashtra.gov.in>, www.mmmocl.co.in

The Applications are invited for filling the following post on Contract Basis.

Sr. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post
1	Chief Security Officer	01

For the detailed advertisement, Eligibility, Qualifications and Experience, Remuneration and other instructions for filling the above job category, please visit MMMOCL website : www.mmmocl.co.in (Careers Section) OR MMRDA website: <https://mmrda.maharashtra.gov.in> (Divisions -> Administration -> Recruitment).

The last date for receipt of application is 05th November 2026.

Sd/-
(KANHURAJ BAGATE, IAS)
MANAGING DIRECTOR
MMMOCL

Date: 06th October 2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE					
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH
1	HARYANA ROADWAYS ENGG. CORPORATION LIMITED/GURUGRAM	MATERIALS FOR RESOLING OF TYRE ACCESSORIES FOR TYRE PLANT + 8 OTHERS	07.10.2026 24.10.2026	52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in					No. 49909/HRV

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE					
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION SONPAT	CONSTRUCTION OF CANO WASTE PLANT INCLUDING FOOTPATH, DRY UNIT, REET UNIT AND CC ROAD AND OTHER COMPONENT AT MANI COLLECTION CENTER AT VILLAGE REHLI PC SONPAT. + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 12.10.2026	10,85,10,49/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in					No. 49904/HRV

JHARKHAND INFORMATION CENTRE
JHARKHAND BHAWAN, VASANT VIHAR NEW DELHI-110057
VERY SHORT NOTICE NOTICE FOR INVITING TENDER BIDS

Bids are invited for empanelment of photographers to cover functions/events of State Government (Jharkhand) for a period of one year from the date of signing of agreement. The tender document may be submitted in the box kept at the reception of Jharkhand Bhawan, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi.

The general information regarding collection and submission of bids is as under:

Details of Tender	Start and Last date Time For Submission of Bids	Date, Time and Venue for Opening of Technical Bids
Tender for Empanelment of photographer/photo studio/videoographer to cover function/events of Jharkhand Government at New Delhi	05.10.2026 10:00 AM to 14.10.2026 06:00 PM	15.10.2026 11:00 AM Venue: Jharkhand Bhawan, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi.

I. Terms and conditions of Tender Document at Annexure I.
II. Forms for the Technical and Financial bids for open tender are placed at Annexure II & III respectively.
III. Detailed tender documents can be downloaded from departmental website- prdjharkhand.in

Sd/-**(Dy Director)**
Govt. of Jharkhand,
Jharkhand Information Centre
Jharkhand Bhawan, New Delhi.

PR 391138 (IPRD)26-27***D**



OFFICE OF UJJAIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Pradhikaran Bhawan, Bharatpuri Administrative Zone,
Dewas Road, Ujjain - 456010
email- udaujain@gmail.com, website- www.udaujain.org

Tender Notice

Online tenders are invited from eligible firms for the following work. Detailed tender details can be found on the website <https://mptenders.gov.in/nicep/app>

No.	Tender number & date of issue	Name of work	Last date of tender
1	UDA/ET/26/7770 DATE 29/09/2026 2026_DTCP_540407_1	EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR DESIGN , DEVELOPMENT IMPLEMENTATION OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF A STATE-OF-THE-ART EXPERIENCE CENTRE FOR SIMHASTHA 2028, UJJAIN	14/10/2026
2	UDA/ET/26/7771 DATE 29/09/2026 2026_DTCP_540395_1	EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR DEVELOPMENT, ESTABLISHMENT, OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF TEMPORARY OFFICES, DORMITORY ACCOMMODATION AND TENT STAY FACILITIES FOR SIMHASTHA 2028, UJJAIN	14/10/2026

Note: Any amendments to the tender will be published online only on the website and will not be published separately in newspapers.

Executive Engineer, UDA, Ujjain



AXIS FINANCE LIMITED
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
(Under Rule 8(6) read with Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002)
E-Auction Notice of 30 days for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the below mentioned Borrower and/ Co-Borrower, or their legal heirs/representatives (Borrowers) that the below described immovable property mortgaged to Axis Finance Ltd. (AFL), the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of AFL, will be sold on **06-11-2026** on “As is where is” & “As is what is” and “Whatever there is” and without any recourse basis” for recovery of outstanding dues from below mentioned Borrower and Co-Borrowers. The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit is mentioned below. Notice is hereby given that, in the absence of any postponement/ discontinuance of the sale, the said secured asset/ property shall be sold by E- Auction from 11:00 AM on the said **06-11-2026**. The sealed envelope containing Demand Draft of EMD for participating in E- Auction shall be submitted to the Authorised Officer of the AFL on or before **04-11-2026** till 4:00 PM.

The sale of the Secured Asset/ Immovable Property will be on “as is where condition is” as per brief particulars described herein below;

Sr. No	Name of Borrower(s) / Co-borrower(s) Legal Heir(s) / Legal Representative/ Guarantor(s)	Date of Demand Notice and amount mentioned in demand notice	Type of possession	Reserve Price	Outstanding as on 04.06.2026
1.	Monika Tyagi, Abhinav Tyagi, M/S Abhinav Industries & Global Business Services	28.05.2026 Rs. 35,76,208 (Rupees Thirty Five Lakhs Seventy Six Thousand Two Hundred and Eight only) (exclusive of TDS Calculation, and Pre-Payment Charges, as applicable) due as on 06th May 2024	Symbolic	Rs. 59,08,800/- (Rupees Fifty Nine Lakhs Eight Thousand and Eight Hundred Only)	Rs. 33,63,023/- (Rupees Thirty Three Lakhs Sixty Three Thousand and Twenty Three Only) due as on 05.09.2026

All the piece and parcel of the property bearing no- “Apartment No. 819, 8 th Floor, Block – B, having super area of 1231 sq. ft. (114.36 sq. mts.), in the group housing complex known as Bankey Bihari Sharmam, situated at Raj Nagar Extension, Village Noor Nagar, NH – 58, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh – 201017.
East : Service lane
West : Road
North : Other Government Land
South : Building of KDP Group

Note :- The bidders are advised to conduct due diligence before submitting the bid. The auction shall be subject to the outcome of the litigation, Dispute if any.

At the Auction, the public generally is invited to submit their bid(s) personally. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the Immovable Property sold.
The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 and the terms and conditions prescribed:
The E-auction of the properties will take place through portal <https://sarfaesi.auctiontigger.net/EPROC/> on **06.11.2026 11:00 a.m. onwards**. For further details please refer to the notice published in the newspapers and at website: www.axisfinance.com.
Contact Person Details & Mob. Nos.: Mr. Ayan Bhattacharya: 9811710558
Place:- Ghaziabad

Sd/-
Authorised Officer
Axis Finance Ltd.
CIN No. U65921MH1995PLC212675.



GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA, HOME DEPARTMENT (PORTS & TRANSPORT)
MAHARASHTRA MARITIME BOARD
Indian Mercantile Chambers, 2nd Floor, Ramjibhai Kamani Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai-400 001. Tel.: 022-69041777 Fax : 022-69041740
Web site : <https://mahammmb.maharashtra.gov.in>
Email : ceo.mmb@maharashtra.gov.in / ceommmb@gmail.com



E-Tender Notice
Main Portal : <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

MAHARASHTRA Maritime Board (MMB), Mumbai, hereby invites bids from the eligible agencies for the following work :

Sr.No.	Name of Work	Date and Time
1.	Request for Proposal for the Operation of Floatel in Belapur/ Panvel Creek within the port limits of Ulwe-Belapur Port - Site A	01.10.2026 @1700 Hrs.
2.	Request for Proposal for the Operation of Floatel in Belapur/ Panvel Creek within the port limits of Ulwe-Belapur Port - Site B	01.10.2026 @1700 Hrs.
3.	Request for Proposal for the Operation of Floatel in Belapur/ Panvel Creek within the port limits of Ulwe-Belapur Port - Site C	01.10.2026 @1700 Hrs.

The details can be viewed online and downloaded directly from the Government of Maharashtra E-Tendering Portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from **01.10.2026 @ 1700 Hrs.** till **15.10.2026 @ 1700 Hrs.**

MMB reserves the right to accept or reject any or all of the bids, without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Date : 01.10.2026
Place : Mumbai

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer,
Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai.

DGIPR-2026-27/3084

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE					
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH
1	GMDA GURUGRAM	ANNUAL MAINTENANCE OF MASTER ROADS AND FOOTPATH FROM SECTOR 44 TO 52 AND 57 TO 67 FOR THE YEAR 2026-27	01.10.2026 12.10.2026	3,43,51,678/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
2	GMDA GURUGRAM	CONSTRUCTION OF SERVICE ROAD ALONG SECTOR DIVIDING ROAD 102/102A (ASSET ID 129), GURUGRAM AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO. + 1 WORKS.	01.10.2026 15.10.2026	16,68,68,465/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in					No. 49903/HRV



UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Victoria Cross Vijayta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001
Telephone-(0135)2763672-76, Fax-(0135)2760289, Corporate Identity No. UA40109UP2001SGC025867/2358

E-TENDER NOTICE (NIT)
दिनांक : 05.10.2026

Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd. Dehradun invites e-tender for supply of following item: -

Sl. No	Tender Specification No.	Name of item	Quantity (Nos.)	Estimate cost (₹)	Average yearly turn Over of Precedin g Three Financia l Year (₹)	Earnest Money Deposit (₹)	Cost of tender document including GST(₹)	Last Date & time of online request for Tender and submission of tender in online & off line mode	Date of opening of Part-1 of tender in online & off line mode
1	CCP- II/16/2026-2027	33kV CT with junction box (Ratio-400-200/1A-3C)	227						
		33kV CT with junction box (Ratio-600-300/1A-3C)	33	126.856 Lakh	2.540 Crore	2.540 Lakh	11800	22.10.2026 upto 17:00 hrs.	23.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs.
		33kV/110V PT with junction box	112						
2	CCP- II/17/2026-2027	11kV Outdoor Pole mounted CT-PT Combined Unit with meter box	364	152.245 Lakh	3.050 Crore	3.050 Lakh	11800	22.10.2026 upto 17:00 hrs.	23.10.2026 at 15:45 hrs.

For further details, please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in

Superintending Engineer
Corporate (Contract & Procurement-II)

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION" Use L.E.D. Bulb to Save Electricity (Toll Free No. 1912) Pay Electricity Bill Online 24 x 7 from www.upcl.org (For information on Electricity theft, informer may report to Toll Free No. 1800 1804185 0405/Fax No. 0135-2760911)

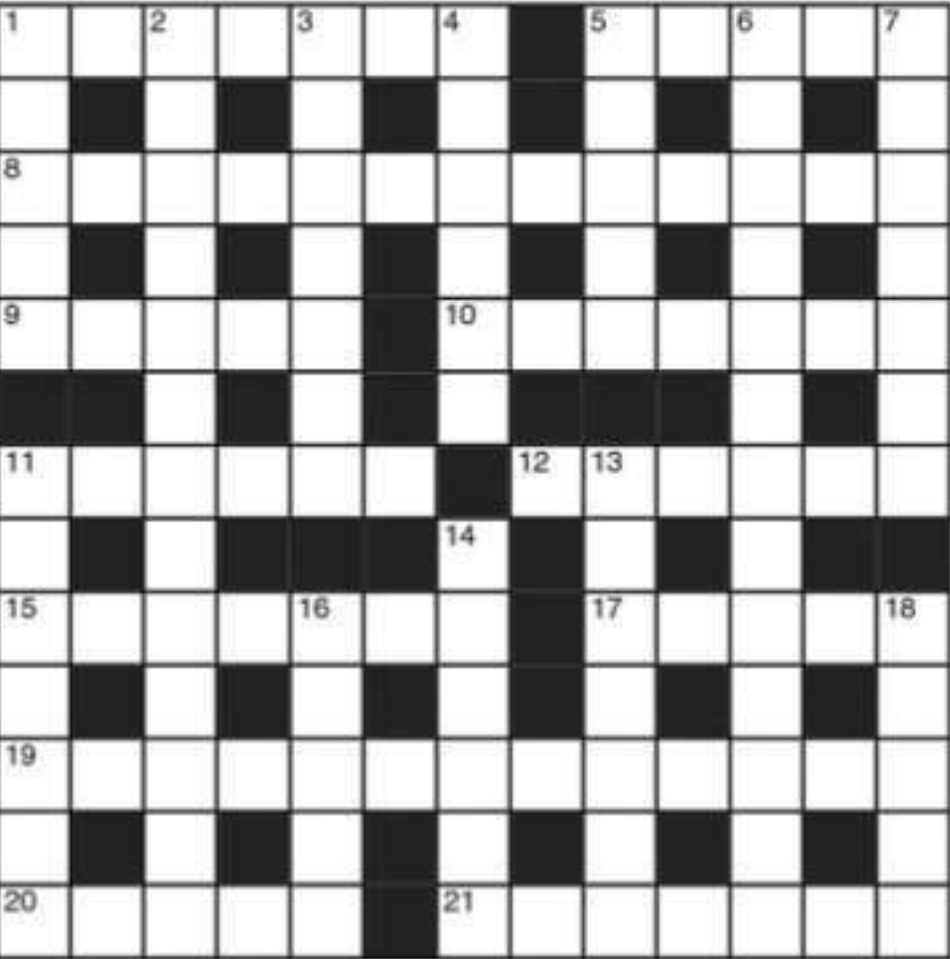
GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE					
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./A	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT OF THE SUPPLY OF PRESBYOPIIC SPECTACLES FOR ADULT IN THE STATE OF HARYANA AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	05.10.2026 12.10.2026	1,50,00,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE EYE SCREENING AND SUPPLY OF SPECTACLES FOR SCHOOL CHILDREN FOR THE STATE OF HARYANA AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	05.10.2026 12.10.2026	2,10,00,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in					No. 49927/HRV

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE				
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES
		DEVELOPMENT, MAINTENANCE, MANAGEMENT AND OPERATION OF SOUTHERN PERIPHERAL ROAD FROM NH-48 TO VATIKA CHOWK VIA ELEVATED CORRIDOR INCLUDING INTERCHANGES, LOOPS AND RAMPS ON ENGINEERING PROCUREMENT AND CONSTRUCTION (EPC) FOR PACKAGE-1: FROM KM 0+000 TO KM 4+200 (DESIGN LENGTH – 4+230 KM).	01.10.2026 19.11.2026	7,76,19,00,000/-
1	GMDA, GURUGRAM			
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in				No. 49923/HRV

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE				
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARDS/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES
1	DHVN	11 METER LONG PCC POLES, 400KG WIL NIT NO.818/DH/NM DATED 01-10-2026 (QD-999)	01.10.2026 30.10.2026	68.32 CRORES
2	DHVN	PROVIDING/HIRING OF VEHICLE ON OUTSOURCE BASIS FOR OFFICE SDO OP S/O/IN. DHVN, KINARA UNDER XEN OPERATION DIVISION DHVN, JIND IN THE YEAR 2026-27 ON THE APPROVED RATES OF NIGAM. NIT NO.2/XEN/OP/12ND/2026-27	05.10.2026 27.10.2026	4,45,000/-
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in				No. 49926/HRV

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE				
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	PROVIDING AND LAYING 14-25 GRADE RMC FROM TUBEWELL NO 2 TO SHAMSHAH GWAY BACKSIDE OF IMPERIAL AUTO FOR RESOLUTION MHARDI SADAK COMPLAINT IN NEW COLONY WARD NO.-17 (NEW WARD), BADKHAL CONSTITUENCY, FARIDABAD. + 4 WORKS	30.09.2026 07.10.2026	88,96,075/-
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR MAKING NECESSARY ARRANGEMENTS LIKE PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION OF EFFIGIES/ STATUES OF RAWAN, MEGHNA, KUMBI KARAN AND OF MAKING VARIOUS ARRANGEMENTS FOR STAGE AND LIGHTING FOR EVENT OF RAMAELA, RUSSEHRA MELA AND RAWAN DAHAN AT NET RUSSEHRA GROUND, FARIDABAD (2026).	01.10.2026 08.10.2026	24.48 LACS
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in				No. 49901/HRV

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 A willing rider (7)
5 Shelter with me in an affray (5)
8 Naomi clueless? Just mixed up perhaps (13)
9 Vehicle to travel as freight (5)
10 Going to great lengths at either end (7)
11 To step back will protect the foot (6)
12 End resistance and collapse (4,2)
15 Era when men began forging ahead (4,3)
17 He's unable to serve any longer (5)
19 Two new union members (5,3,5)
20 Choose what may be chosen (5)
21 Secure in bed yet unable to move? (7)

DOWN
1 Funny business with farmhouse victims detailed (5)
2 Very good workers do - and very bad ones! (7,6)
3 Doctor Cameron in Italy (7)
4 They're purely symbolic (6)
5 Painter's mate upset about mid-morning (5)
6 It's not bound to allow for more pages (5-4,4)
7 Could be set near China for example (7)
11 Metal cover protects the sewer (7)
13 Fast scoring rate (7)
14 A point for a writer (3,3)
16 Girl turns right to avoid something (5)
18 Frosted look seen when I'm in debt? (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6111
ACROSS: 1 Worst, 8 Parental, 9 Spilt, 10 Adenoids, 11 Using, 12 See, 16 Statue, 17 Leant, 18 Tom, 23 Vague, 24 Outshine, 25 Dirty, 26 Departed, 27 Smash
DOWN: 2 Opposite, 3 Salinity, 4 Handle, 5 Beans, 6 Staid, 7 Blast, 12 Set, 13 Elm, 14 Fatalism, 15 In quotes, 19 Ounces, 20 Words, 21 Stops, 22 Chart

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

IF I had only one sermon to preach it would be a sermon _____.
- G. K. Chesterton (7,5)

NRAAE

ADIIR

ETHNOS

EELDGP

SOLUTIONS:

Arena, Radial, Honest, Pledge

ANSWER:

If I had only one sermon to preach it would be a sermon against pride.

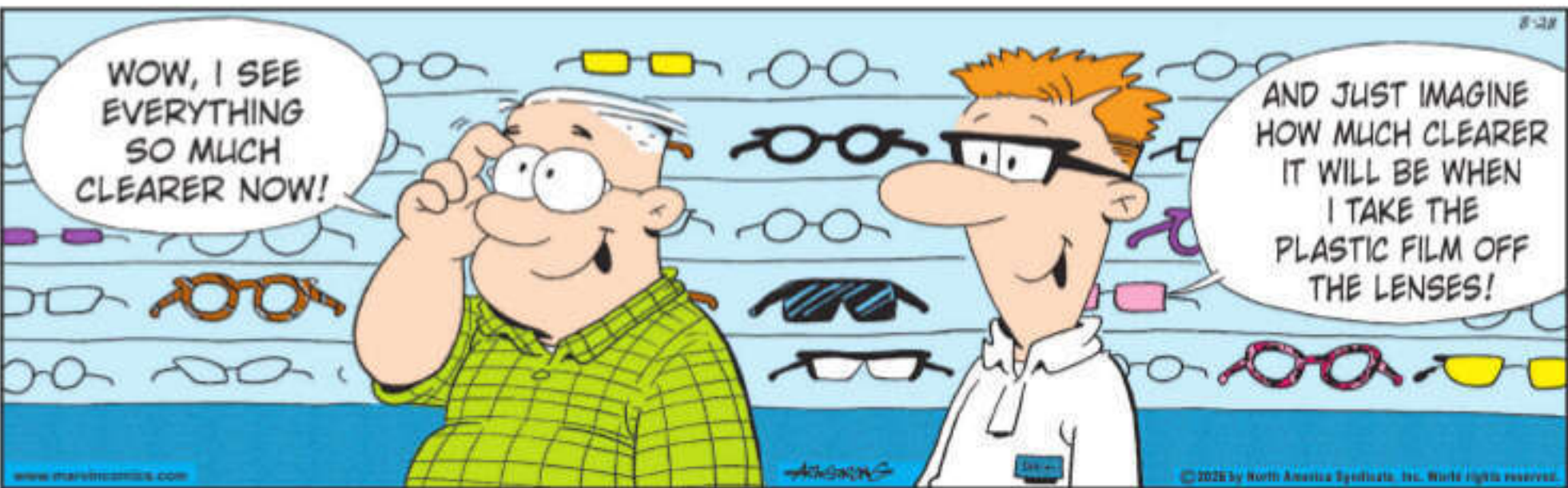
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s

INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6462

						6	7
		6	9			8	3
			5	7	1		
4		8	5			9	
6	8					2	7
9			2	7		5	
	2			3	4		
1	9					5	6
4	8						

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6462

3	5	9	2	7	1	6	4	8
7	1	4	9	6	8	5	2	3
2	8	6	4	5	3	1	7	9
4	6	8	7	3	9	2	1	5
9	2	5	6	1	4	8	3	7
1	7	3	5	8	2	4	9	6
6	4	2	3	9	5	7	8	1
5	9	1	8	2	7	3	6	4
8	3	7	1	4	6	9	5	2

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Amit S/o Rajendra R/o H. No. A-40/1 Bada Chowk Mandawali, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 59/2017 U/S 392/34 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Amit** accused of **FIR No. 59/2017 U/S 392/34 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.11.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Sachin

DP/13776/ED/2026

Room No-16

(Court Matter)

Karkardooma Court, Delhi

Form No.- 1

DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL AT LUCKNOW

600/1, UNIVERSITY ROAD,

NEAR HANUMAN SETU MANDIR, LUCKNOW

(Areas of Jurisdiction: Part of Uttar Pradesh)

DRC No. 1277/2018

NEXT DATE-22.12.2026

Notice Under Rule 2 of Second Schedule of The Income Tax Act, 1961 Read With Section 29 Recovery of Debts Due To Bank and Financial Institutions Act, 1993

BANK OF BARODA

Applicant

Versus

M/S GUPTA DAIRY THROUGH ITS PROP. MR. VINOD KUMAR To,

1. M/s GUPTA DAIRY (Borrower)

Through its Proprietor Vinod Kumar Village & Post-Maina, Mauzpur, Khurja Junction, Khurja, District-Bulandshahr

2. SHRI VINOD KUMAR Village & Post-Maina, Mauzpur, Khurja Junction, Khurja, District-Bulandshahr

DEFENDANTS

1. This is to notify that a sum of Rs. 14,79,675/- (Rupees Fourteen Lac Seventy Nine Thousand, Six Hundred Seventy Five Only) along with interest @12.00% per annum with monthly rest from the date of filing of original application 03.12.2015 till the loan is fully liquidated and cost succeeds and is hereby allowed ex parte against you the addressees as per Order dated 07.02.2018 passed by the Hon'ble tribunal in O.A 1035/2015 titled the Bank of Baroda vs. M/s Gupta Dairy and others "Jointly and severally"

2. You are hereby directed to pay the aforesaid mentioned amount within 15 days of the receipt of this notice failing which the recovery shall be made in accordance with the Recovery of Debts due to Banks and Financial Institution Act, 1993.

3. You are hereby ordered to declare on Affidavit the particulars of assets on or before 22-12-2026

4. You are hereby ordered to appear before the undersigned on 22-12-2026 at 10.30 a.m.

In addition to the sum aforesaid, you will also be liable to pay: Details of Cost

1. Amount of Application Fee- Rs.17000=00

2. Advocate fee - 13000=00

3. Misc. Expenses - 1300=00

4. Publication Charge – 10000=00

5. Clerkage - 3000=00

Given under my hand and seal at Lucknow on this 11-09-2026

Recovery Officer-II

Debts Recovery Tribunal, Lucknow

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION

Ltd., VS. VIJAYAWADA-520004

(A Govt. of A.P Undertaking)

NIT No. 995359

Name of the work: "Supply, Erection, Testing and commissioning of the latest VFD Drive assembly for gravimetric feeders compatible with existing Max-Data based DCS unit dismantling the existing Eddy current clutch drive assembly, at Unit 1 & 2 of Stage-VFD-MVR RTP" through e-procurement.

Schedule available Date & Time - 30.09.2026-17.00 PM onwards Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 15.10.2026 - 13.00 PM For other details visit the website, viz: https://tender.approcurement.gov.in/irj/portal or www.apgenco.gov.in Contact No: (0866) 2526808,2526115,2526139.

Release Order No : 54777PP/CL/ADVT/I/1/2021-22 Dt: 05/10/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Meeta, D/o: Sh. Usman Haider, R/o: Masjid Wali Gali, Gali No-01 Maujpur Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 223/2012, U/s 379/411/34IPC P.S.: Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Meeta**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Meeta**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Meeta**, accused of **FIR No. 223/2012, U/s 379/411/34IPC P.S.: Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.11.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Sachin

DP/13792/ED/2026

JMFC-03 Court No. 16 East District,

(Court Matter)

Karkardooma Court Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sंहिता-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Ajay Kumar S/o Phool Singh R/o Badi Masjid Chandan Holla New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 204/2015 U/S 454/380/411/34 IPC PS: Fatehpur Beri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ajay Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ajay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ajay Kumar** accused of **Case FIR No. 204/2015 U/S 454/380/411/34 IPC PS: Fatehpur Beri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.12.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Shivli Talwar

DP/13779/SD/2026

JMFC-01, Room No-214

(Court Matter)

Saket Courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sंहिता)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitin @ Vicky @ Hadal S/o Ranbir Singh @ Pappu R/o H.No.43 & 1379, Mazariya Pana, Transformer Wali Gali, Village Pooth Khurd, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.190/2026, Dated 19.07.2026 u/s 25 Arms Act, P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nitin @ Vicky @ Hadal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nitin @ Vicky @ Hadal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nitin @ Vicky @ Hadal** of **FIR No.190/2026, Dated 19.07.2026 u/s 25 Arms Act, P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot

DP/14043/CRIME/2026

Chief Judicial Magistrate, North, Room No.115

1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sंहिता)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Naeem, S/o Hazi Iqbal R/o Village Pasonda, PS Sahibabad, Distt. Ghaziabad, U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No.260/2013 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Alipur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Naeem** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Naeem** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Naeem** of **FIR No.260/2013 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Alipur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.12.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot

DP/14091/ON/2026

Chief Judicial Magistrate, North, Room No.115

1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

ROYAL STARS

♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a fantastic day to talk, and romance is favoured. In fact, this is the most romantic day of the week. Intimate relationships will be affectionate and exciting. Enjoy socialising, sports events and fun activities with kids. Tonight: Get organised.

♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Many of you are an excellent cook, and today is a wonderful day to entertain at home. It will please you to make a partner, spouse or someone close to you happy. Tonight: Socialise.

♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a feel-good day. You're in a positive frame of mind and ready to entertain big ideas because your confidence is strong. Colleagues at work might endorse your plans. Tonight: Relax at home.

♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a good money day for you. Jot down your moneymaking ideas, but wait until tomorrow to act on them, because today is a Moon Alert. Nevertheless, a moon alert is a creative time — just a poor day to spend money. Tonight: Lively discussions.

♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): You're out there flying your colours today because the Moon is lined up with lucky Jupiter. Plus, fiery Mars in your sign will put a spring in your step and boost your confidence. In fact, you might want to entertain at home. Tonight: Take care of your possessions.

♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Your ability to charm others with your words is wonderful today, which is why this is a great day for those in marketing, teaching or acting. However, because of the moon alert all day, restrict your spending to food and gas. Tonight: You win.

♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Enjoy your popularity today because everyone wants to see your face. Interactions with friends, groups and organisations will be successful. However, because there's a moon alert all day, don't volunteer for anything. Tonight: Enjoy peace and quiet.

♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): You're noticed today, and you look capable and affluent to everyone. You might be approached to take on increased responsibilities today. If so, wait until tomorrow to accept. (Check the moon alert.) Tonight: Be friendly.

♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This is a fabulous day to travel. Some of you might be dabbling in a secret love affair. It's a poor day to spend money except for food and gas due to the moon alert. Tonight: You're admired.

♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Be careful with financial decisions today, especially about shared property, insurance issues, inheritances, taxes and debt, because there's a moon alert all day. Be smart and postpone these decisions until tomorrow. Tonight: Explore and learn.

♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): It's a great day to talk. Enjoy the company of friends and partners. You make a great impression on everyone. You might be asked for advice about something. If so, wait until tomorrow to respond, due to the moon alert. Tonight: Check your finances.

♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Work-related travel might be on the menu today. Likewise, travel plans will intrigue you. Although you can be productive today, be aware of the restrictions of the moon alert and postpone important decisions until tomorrow. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

DISPATCHES FROM THE FAR EAST

Lost under Nagoya station, & politely found

Bus drivers who thank every passenger, a uniformed woman with a thumbs-up and a city that kept its distance from the Games



Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, October 5

DAY 0: CARE, CAUTION

ILAND in Nagoya, pick up my credentials and receive a media kit. I think of the Tokyo Olympics, my last trip to Japan.

The welcome kit for those pandemic Games came with dozens of tubes, bottles and QR codes, all tied to the daily ritual of Covid-19 testing. This time, there is no reminder to spit into those tubes before even brushing. Instead, there is earthquake and tsunami safety guidance.

Navigating earthquakes, it turns out, is one of the trickier parts of living here. Around 1,500 earthquakes are felt across the country each year, most of them harmless. But the government warns of a magnitude 8-9 Nankai Trough earthquake in the next 30 years, and Nagoya, sitting in the Nankai region, is among the areas considered particularly vulnerable.

So, the warnings are everywhere. Evacuation zones are marked outside the athletes' plaza. Safety advisories sit inside railway stations. Competition venues have their own instructions. Before play begins, the giant screen invariably flashes a reminder of what to do, and what not to do, in the event of an earthquake or tsunami.

On the first day, I notice every one of them. Twenty-four hours later, I barely register them.

The media kit contains another, more thoughtful item: masks for neck, shoulder and leg pain. Because the other hazard of these Games is much less dramatic: the walking.

As the days pass, the step count keeps climbing. It peaks on October 1, when I travel between Nagoya, Obu and Okazaki, using the train-bus-train combination that has become something of a recurring feature of these Games.

By the end of the day, I have covered 15.02 km on foot. If nothing else, these Games are going to do wonders for my annual step-count target.

DAY 1: LOST IN THE MAZE

Nagoya Station is the sort of place that makes me question my own sense of direction.

Above ground, there are trains, towers, roads and people moving in every direction. Below ground is another city: platforms on different levels, underground passages disappearing around corners, shopping arcades, staircases, escalators and exits that seem to multiply the further I walk.

While returning from a venue, I am completely lost. Google Maps suggests a train, then a bus to another station that would take me to Kinjofuto, where the main media hub is and the cruise liner for athletes is docked.

I am used to the coarse *pudhe chala* (move ahead) of BEST conductors in Mumbai, the instruction delivered at full volume, with the assumption that I will somehow figure out the rest. Here, the woman bus driver wears a face mask, a crisp white shirt and a black jacket. At the Tokai-dori stop, she picks up the microphone and individually thanks every passenger who gets in.

Arigato gozaimasu. There are perhaps 13-15 of us who get in. She thanks all of us.

By the end of the day, at around 11.30pm, I am lost again somewhere underneath Nagoya. I am standing at a Kintetsu platform, staring at my phone and trying to work out whether the train waiting on Platform 1 will take me to Komeno, from where my apartment is a 7-minute walk.

I find a uniformed woman and show her my phone. She squints at the screen. Nods. I hop in, and three minutes later, hop off. Then, just as the doors are about to close, the same woman steps out of the captain's cabin.

She looks at me. Checks that I have got off at the right station. Gives me a thumbs-up. Gets back in. The train chugs away into the darkness.

I stand on the platform wondering if she really comes out just to make sure the lost foreigner gets off at the right station.

DAY 3: EARLY MORNING TREK

The city gradually disappears. The bus windows lose the towers and dense buildings. Then come fields, little houses, narrow roads, wooded slopes. By the time it drops us off, I am in a sleepy rural corner of

Toyota City, with another kilometre to walk to the venue.

It is early morning. The road is quiet. On either side are dense stands of trees, the hills rising behind them in layers of green. There are stretches where the only sound is my own footsteps.

And somewhere inside this landscape is a shooting range. The venue is secluded, surrounded by the forest. It is a beautiful setting for a sport that demands a Zen-like state from its athletes.

Reaching the venue and getting back takes up an entire day, but you don't really mind. By afternoon the weather changes, it starts to drizzle, then, almost theatrically, the sky turns orange and a rainbow appears across the hills.

After making me trek into the middle of nowhere, Aichi decides to show off.

DAY 4: THE LAST COOKIE

The chocolate cookies at the venues are a hit. A serious hit. They disappear almost as soon as they arrive, which means that after a few days, spotting a fresh batch creates the sort of urgency usually reserved for breaking news.

Late evening at the main media centre, I walk towards the lounge for a coffee and spot one last cookie sitting there. From the opposite direction, I notice a Malaysian journalist heading for the same cookie. He has seen it too.

We continue walking, each pretending this is a perfectly normal stroll and not a race for the final chocolate cookie of the evening.

We reach it at almost exactly the same time. There is a brief moment of politeness. He offers it to me. To him. He insists. I insist. Eventually, I take it. India wins.

DAY 6: 100 NOT OUT



A friend points me to a report in *Japan Today*, which says the country's population of people aged 100 or older has crossed one lakh for the first time.



LOOK UP: A CITY'S FIGHT AGAINST SCREEN TIME

I watch the queue inch forward, but almost nobody looks up. Heads are bowed, thumbs flicking, faces lit by the glow of phone screens. A few feet away, people are waiting together, yet each seems to be somewhere else.

It feels familiar. We see the same thing all the time in India. But here in Japan, at least one politician has decided to do something about it. Or, more accurately, try.

In Toyoake, a city in Aichi, the local government introduced a guideline last year encouraging residents to keep leisure-time smartphone and electronic-device use to about two hours a day. It isn't a ban, there are no penalties, and the city isn't asking people to abandon their phones. The idea is simply to make them look up a little more.

The concern, the mayor, Masafumi Koki, tells me, is what gets displaced by those hours: sleep, exercise, hobbies and face-to-face conversations. "A survey conducted among residents revealed that there is a certain correlation between prolonged smartphone usage and feelings of loneliness," Koki says.

A year on, the city is still trying to find out whether the experiment has worked. "With 43.2 per cent of participants reporting some behavioural changes or shifts in awareness following the enactment of the ordinance, it is viewed as having been sufficiently effective," Koki says.

DAY... I LOSE TRACK

Toyota is supposed to be the land of cars. Instead, somewhere between the factories and farms, there is a little piece of Brazil.

I know it is Brazil because a football (*futbol*), rather than base sits amid open farmland, with low buildings, fields and long stretches of green around it.

Then I start noticing the signs. Portuguese. On trains. On hoardings. Around the neighbourhood. Some 60,000-odd Brazilians live in the Aichi prefecture, the highest of any prefecture in Japan. The Brazil-town is not announced with a grand landmark. It is simply there, woven into the landscape. For a few minutes, rural Japan feels slightly Brazilian.

WHEN THE GAMES LEAVE

Usually, the last day of a Games feels like a small bereavement. The venues begin to empty. People who have shared trains, buses, press tribunes and hurried coffees for a fortnight begin saying their goodbyes.

There is usually a strange emptiness in the air, the feeling that a little travelling circus is packing itself up and leaving town. This time, I don't feel it. I don't really feel sad that these Games are over.

Perhaps because these have been among the strangest Games I have covered. For much of the fortnight, I have had the feeling that Aichi-Na-

goya does not really want to host the Asian Games, but is far too polite to say no. So it does what Japan does so well: accommodates. Tens of thousands of athletes, officials, volunteers, journalists and support staff arrive, and the city makes room for all of them.

But it never quite feels as if the city is curious about them. People don't seem particularly interested in discovering new sports or watching athletes from countries they know little about. The stands remain patchy. The city centre, around which almost everything here seems to revolve, never really feels as though an Asian Games is happening around it.

There are no crowds spilling into the streets. No obvious sporting frenzy. No sense that the city has been taken over by the Games.

It's strangely fitting then that at the closing ceremony, the biggest cheer comes when Qatar's equestrian rider enters the stadium on horseback, takes the Asian Games flag, and then rides out with it.

Maybe Nagoyans are simply thrilled by the sight of a horse. Maybe, for a brief moment, the spectacle finally cuts through. Or maybe they are happy that the fortnight is over. On Monday morning, Nagoya gets back to being Nagoya. The trains fill up, and people head to work, as if the Games never happened.

City that treats manhole covers as works of art and records of history

Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, October 5

THE CITY has castles, skyscrapers, samurai history, Toyota factories, and since last week, some of the finest athletes at the Asian Games, all competing for attention. But some of its most elaborate pieces of art sit beneath your feet.

The manhole covers are rarely just manhole covers. They carry Nagoya's landmarks, its food, its history and, increasingly, its pop culture, tiny metal postcards embedded in the pavement. For a city with such a rich visual identity above ground, it is striking how much of it has been reproduced below.

At the Meta Water Sewerage Science Museum, the city's hidden world gets an unexpectedly colourful showcase. Pipes, drainage systems and the mechanics of wastewater treatment sit alongside a dozen manhole designs, turning an otherwise invisible piece of infrastructure into something worth examining.

Suzuki Hitoya, the museum's manager, says the covers have become a way for communities across Japan to express what makes them distinctive. "There are various designs in order to produce the originals of each prefecture," he says. "If it's Nagoya, it's mackerel. If it's Mie Prefecture, it's a maguri and a bird."

Flowers, birds, animals, landmarks, local scenery: all of it finds its way onto the



(Top) Some of Nagoya's manhole covers on display at the Meta Water Sewerage Science Museum. (Left) *Shachihoko*, a mythical sea creature, (middle) the *Maneki-neko* or Japanese lucky cat and *Udon* noodles (right), a staple of Japanese cuisine. EXPRESS PHOTO

covers. Nagoya has about 198,000 manholes across an 8,000-kilometre sewer network, and nearly two dozen types of covers, according to the city administration.

The process of choosing a

design isn't always the same. Sometimes, Hitoya says, a municipality identifies something it wants to showcase - a local flower, a famous view, a landmark - and asks a manhole manufacturer to turn it into a

design. Other covers come from public or student competitions, or from designers commissioned for the job. The final choice rests with the local water and sewerage bureau.

"There are places where we

ask citizens to submit a design to everyone," Hitoya says. "And we ask a designer somewhere to make a design at the end of the gap, but the water supply and sewerage bureau is selecting it."

The idea began a little more

than a manufacturer's suggestion, an early proposal for a cover decorated with a pear flower, which drew little attention. It spread only once municipalities began using the covers to express local pride.

There was a practical motive too, Hitoya says: a nationwide effort to improve the image of sewage systems. The manhole became an unlikely canvas, popular enough now to have its own social media communities, and its own auctions. The novel use of a mundane item of urban infrastructure has become such a feature of Japanese popular culture that it has caught the eye of Major League Baseball in the United States, where several of the country's sporting heroes ply their trade.

Shohei Ohtani, Yusei Kikuchi and Roki Sasaki had custom-designed manhole covers dedicated to them unveiled in Iwate Prefecture in 2025, and more such initiatives were in the pipeline. *The Japan Times* had reported.

Nagoya's covers carry layers of the city's history. One design featured around the 1989 World Design Expo. Another marks a century of sewerage service with the Nayabashi bridge over the Horikawa river.

Then there is the ameno-bi, seen in every lane. At first glance, it looks almost extraterrestrial, round eyes, a flattened body, long legs stretched across the metal. It is, in fact, a water strider, chosen through a public competition in 1992 to mark the 80th anniversary of Nagoya's sewerage operations. Water striders live only in clean, unpolluted water, which is why

the insect was picked. It went on to become the city's sewerage mascot, and from there, a fixture on its manhole covers.

The designs are as varied as the city's identity: Nagoya Castle, bowls of miso-nikomi udon, fish, samurai figures, a bustling cityscape, a giant golden shrimp for the city's fondness for ebi. Each turns a familiar piece of Nagoya into a miniature work of street art. The designs draw on pop culture too. Amid the castles and civic symbols, there is *Pokemon*.

Nagoya has its own Poke Lid, part of a nationwide project placing specially designed *Pokemon* manholes across Japan. The Nagoya covers sit near Nagoya Castle, its *Pokemon* chosen for the city, bringing one of Japan's oldest symbols together with one of its most recognisable modern exports.

The covers aren't all telling the same story. Some mark an event, some a landmark, some reflect local nature, others simply put a city's stamp on an anonymous piece of infrastructure. Some have become collectibles: retired covers sold as souvenirs, objects that spent decades being driven over now things people take home.

It is an unusual fate for something designed to be ignored. But together, the covers make a map of Nagoya's identity. The city's grand history is above ground. Some of its smaller stories are underfoot. You just have to look down.

No Surya in Mumbai Ranji squad despite availability



Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, October 5

THE MUMBAI selectors have not picked former India T20 captain **Suryakumar Yadav (in pic)** for their Ranji Trophy season opener despite the veteran confirming his availability for the same a week ago.

The selection committee of the Mumbai Cricket Association (MCA) announced a 16-member squad on Monday. Both Surya, under whose captaincy India had successfully defended their T20 World Cup crown earlier this year, and Yashasvi Jaiswal had informed the panel that they were available. But only the latter finds his name in the list.

Chief selector Rajesh Pawar said Surya's lack of recent red-ball match practice was behind their decision.

"He is a very big player. But he hasn't played red-ball cricket in the last one and a half years. Should he play a few red-ball games, he can definitely come into the side," Pawar said.

It was just last week that Surya was asked about his availability and willingness to play Ranji Trophy, and he took a day before confirming it. However, MCA officials claim they tried to reach out to him many times but he didn't respond to their calls. Mumbai will take on Chandigarh in their season opener at the Wankhede Stadium from October 11-14. The selection committee has appointed Siddhesh Lad as skipper for the season with opener Ayush Mhatre as his vice-captain.

Speaking on Jaiswal's return, Pawar said, "It's a good thing that Yashasvi is coming to play for Mumbai. He also needs match practice. When asked, he said he is available, so that's good for the team. There is a chance he might be in either the senior or the A team touring New Zealand; so we only announced the squad for the first match."

The squad features India batter Sarfaraz Khan. Also included is Shams Mulani, whose all-round performance against Australia A helped India A clinch their two-match unofficial Test series 1-0. Mumbai will miss the services of injured pacer Shardul Thakur.

MUMBAI SQUAD: Siddhesh Lad (capt), Ayush Mhatre (vice-capt), Shams Mulani, Yashasvi Jaiswal, Tanush Kotian, Atharva Ankelekar, Divyaansh Saxena, Tushar Deshpande, Musheer Khan, Mohit Avasthi, Sarfaraz Khan, Sylvester D'Souza, Suved Parkar, Onkar Tarmale, Akash Anand (wk), Hardik Tamore (wk).

WEST INDIES TOUR OF INDIA

After tough start, Iyer looks to go higher and higher as skipper

Shreyas has started to find his feet as T20I captain, especially in how he uses his bowlers and backs young players

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, October 5

BY THE time Shreyas Iyer turned to Shivam Dube in the fifth and final T20I against England in Southampton, there was little left to salvage. England were 225/1, with Jos Buttler and Harry Brook in control. Dube didn't bowl until the 19th over. He took two wickets, but gave away 22 runs. It was a snapshot of where Iyer was: he had the resources, but was still figuring out how to use them.

England ended with 257/3, and India lost by 56 runs. The defeat completed a 0-4 series loss and was Iyer's sixth defeat in seven matches as India's T20I captain. Southampton felt like the nadir of a difficult start. There was little then to suggest things would turn for the better.

Yet they have.

Over the next nine matches, all of them wins, Iyer may not have become a master tactician. But there seems to be a clearer identity about his captaincy, especially how he uses his bowlers.

The Ireland and England matches hinted at a captain still trying to work out which bowler fitted where. The games since have shown greater role clarity, more trust in young players and, crucially, a willingness to back them after things go wrong.

The change is perhaps best seen in how Iyer handles young

pacers when things don't go to plan. Mayank Yadav, after taking a first-ball wicket in the third T20I, was hit for a six in his next spell. Iyer still brought him back to break the fifth-wicket partnership between Wessly Madhevere and Ryan Burl and then trusted him with the 20th over.

Mayank showed enough in Zimbabwe to suggest that he could become an important cog in the attack. But there is still work to do. His pace is his biggest asset, but the next step is to trust his plans when batsmen attack him, rather than relying on pace to get out of trouble.

Prince Yadav's role seems clear: bowl hard lengths to top-order batsmen and keep going even if the ball disappears. He struck with his first ball in the second T20I against Zimbabwe and then removed Sikandar Raza in the same spell, both wickets coming from that approach. After the first game, Prince said the message from Iyer and the coaches was simple - keep bowling the right lengths and don't worry if a good ball gets hit.

With Hardik Pandya still unavailable, India are developing Nitish Kumar Reddy in the seam bowling all-rounder role. Against Afghanistan in the third T20I, he conceded 15 in his first over. Iyer did not shelve him. He brought him back in the ninth and then again in the



India coach Gautam Gambhir (L) during a training session in Lucknow on Monday. VISHAL SRIVASTAV

11th and 13th over. Nitish finished with 3/25 in his four overs.

Trust in Abhishek

Abhishek Sharma perhaps best captures what Iyer is trying to build. In the first T20I against Afghanistan in Delhi, Iyer gave Abhishek an over despite having regular bowling options and that experimentation continued at the Asian Games, despite the main bowlers having overs left. India have often played with only five frontline bowlers, and Iyer looks keen to develop a sixth bowling resource.

Sanjay Manjrekar, who has watched Iyer over the years for India and in the IPL, believed Iyer looked more settled in the role now after the early stutter.

"One thing, whatever little you can get, you know, the vibe, just being around him - did a couple of tosses with him and

just being there - he seems like he's settled into the role."

"Suddenly it seems like he has grown, you know, maturity and everything. So he must have realised after the Ireland experience that you just do your best and the results are beyond your control," he said.

Still developing

Despite the nine wins, however, Iyer's captaincy is still developing. It is too early to call him a finished product. Bigger tests lie ahead, starting with the West Indies series in Lucknow on Tuesday. Manjrekar does not see the coming challenge as simply a test of Iyer. "I think the test for this Indian T20 team will be performing in different conditions."

That makes the West Indies series important. India have played just one series at home

under his captaincy, with all three matches in Delhi. Against West Indies, across five venues and different conditions, we will see how he adapts his methods and whether the identity he is developing is long-lasting.

The early defeats showed a captain looking for the right combinations and ways to use his bowlers. Since then, he has looked more comfortable giving players responsibility and allowing them to grow into their roles. There will be missteps, and some risks will not pay off. But that is part of the process. More importantly, Iyer no longer looks to be searching for an identity. He looks to be building one.

INDIA VS WEST INDIES, first T20I, Live on Star Sports Network & JioHotstar, 7 pm.

BRIEFLY



Daniil Medvedev hit a ball into the stands in frustration. REUTERS

China Open: Medvedev ousted for hitting spectator with a ball

DANIIL MEDVEDEV struck a spectator with a ball and was disqualified from his semifinal against Novak Djokovic at the China Open on Monday. The spectator was helped out of the arena holding a hand over his left eye. "I feel terribly sorry for him actually and I just hope he's OK," Medvedev said. "Hopefully I can meet him and make up for it somehow." Djokovic was serving for the match at 7-5, 5-3 when Medvedev hit the ball into the stands in apparent frustration. "It was 100% an accident," Medvedev said. AP

After dull Asiad, Indian shuttlers seek reset

INDIAN SHUTTTLERS, led by two-time Olympic medallist PV Sindhu, will look to build on the positives from their Asian Games campaign when they resume their BWF season at the USD 500,000 Arctic Open Super 500 badminton tournament on Tuesday. India's shuttlers returned from the Asian Games with just one medal and four quarterfinal finishes - two fewer medals than their tally at the Hangzhou edition. PTI

Portugal remain perfect without Ronaldo

GONCALO RAMOS is helping Portugal to forget all about Cristiano Ronaldo, while Greece took more points off Jurgen Klopp and Germany in the Nations League. Ramos fired Portugal to a 2-1 win over Norway on Sunday to keep the Portuguese perfect in Group A4 with four wins enough to book their place in the quarterfinals. Ronaldo was involved in Portugal's Nations League opener, where he was replaced by Ramos in a 1-0 win over Wales. AP

Bracewell shifts to a casual NZC contract

NEW ZEALAND all-rounder Michael Bracewell will move to a casual contract for the 2026-27 season as he pursues an opportunity in Australia's Big Bash League, the country's cricket board said on Monday. The 35-year-old Bracewell joins Mark Chapman, Finn Allen, Lockie Ferguson, Adam Milne and Tim Seifert among players who have opted for the casual contract system. REUTERS

Keep Ireland apart from Israel: Coach to UEFA

IRELAND COACH Heimir Hallgrimsson wants UEFA to keep Ireland and Israel apart in future events after their contentious Nations League games. "There is obviously a big support for Palestine in Ireland. There are not many countries that support Palestine as much as Ireland does," Hallgrimsson said. "I wouldn't wish any national team to go through what we have gone through these two weeks, so maybe UEFA just needs to do something." AP

Alcaraz rallies to reach Japan Open final

CARLOS ALCARAZ is going to play his first final since coming back from a 4-½-month layoff for a right wrist injury. The third-ranked Alcaraz lost 16 straight points at the end of the first set and the start of the second before coming back to beat qualifier Jaume Munar 5-7, 6-3, 6-1 in the Japan Open semifinals on Monday. In Tuesday's final, Alcaraz will face 19th-ranked Jiri Lehecka, who beat Valentin Vacherot 6-4, 6-2. AP

Indian archers turn focus to franchise league

FRESH FROM the Asian Games high, Indian archery stars will switch from national colours to franchise jerseys when the second season of the Archery Premier League begins on October 8. Indian archers registered a nine-medal haul, including five golds, at the continental event. Kumkum Anil Mohod, 17, became the first Indian to win an individual Asian Games gold in recurve. PTI

A triple bogey, a psychologist and Pranavi's gold

Tushar Bhaduri
New Delhi, October 5

IF SPORTS psychology looks like a luxury at the elite level, Pranavi Urs has an answer. It could be the difference between an Asian Games gold medal and nothing.

The 23-year-old had little sleep the night before the final round at the Kasugai Country Club East Course, and her anxiety wasn't helped by a triple-bogey 7 on the third hole, which wiped out her three-shot lead going into the last day and handed the edge to World No. 6 Yin Ruoning of China.

That is where her work with her sports psychologist paid off. "Going into the final round of any big event, you are bound to be nervous because you care so much," Pranavi told *The Indian Express* on Monday. "I had a session with my psychologist before the final round, where we trained my brain for all possible scenarios and focused on having fun out on the golf course."

Preparing for Murphy's Law (anything that can go wrong will



Pranavi Urs won India's first women's golf gold at the Asiad. REUTERS

go wrong) worked to her benefit. "It (triple bogey) was the worst thing that could have happened. I told myself that I had hit rock bottom and the only way from there was upwards. I just had to stick to the gameplan."

The preparation did its job. Pranavi caught Yin with a birdie on the 10th, went ahead with another on the 13th, and did not give up the lead after that. Not that Pranavi suffered from a lack of confidence going into

the competition. "Whenever you enter a tournament, you want to win, not just participate," she said. "But to go ahead and actually do it was surreal."

The psychologist's contribution was vital to the big-girl title of her career so far. She is in her third season on the Ladies European Tour (LET) and, despite contending several times, has not quite taken the final step.

What's more, her teammate

Aditi Ashok had an unenviable history at big events. At the 2023 Hangzhou Asian Games, she held a seven-shot lead going into the final round before a 5-over 77 relegated her to the silver medal. At the Tokyo Olympics in 2021, she was second going into the final 18 holes, but finished just outside the medal positions.

Pranavi said the topic remained off-limits during team discussions. "I've known both Aditi and Diksha (Dagar) for a long time. I've always looked up to Aditi. I've played together with Diksha. All three of us are good friends and in good form. When we came together at the start of the week, we were confident that we will definitely win a medal," she said, preparing to board a flight out of Japan.

"I didn't ask for any advice from Aditi, and certainly didn't bring up those two final rounds in our chats. We're friends, why would I do that? We talked about everything other than that during our dinners together." Though Aditi (14th at two-over) and Diksha (tied 23rd

at 12-over) didn't do as well individually as they would have liked, the Indian women's team did clinch a silver medal behind China.

India's first women's individual golf gold at the Asian Games is likely to give the game a shot in the arm, and could help the golfer from Mysuru in her own development.

"I'm in a better headspace now and feel more confident now. This gold medal is definitely a boost for me. The next step is to win on the LET," she said. That she beat some of the top players in the women's game augurs well for her growth. Apart from Yin (World No. 6), bronze medallist Shannon Xuan Yin Tan of Singapore is the 2025 LET Order of Merit winner.

"It's great to win an event beating such players and a good sign that my career is going in the right direction. Now I have complete clarity that my game is in great shape," said Pranavi, who will play the Women's India Open at the DLF Golf & Country Club in Gurgaon later this month.

MIRROR, MIRROR

Cracks appear: Jesus won't bend and Ronaldo can't be bent

Sandip G
New Delhi, October 5

SOME TIME next week, or next month, Cristiano Ronaldo will reveal his side of the story. Of his latest, dramatic falling out with Portugal coach Jorge Jesus. The coach has offered glimpses of his version in a press conference: that the country's greatest footballer didn't suit the tactical demands of the game.

Rumours have swirled like a juicy whodunit. Spanish journalist and Ronaldo's close friend Edu Aguirre claims the footballer felt betrayed.

There supposedly was a closed-door meeting between the Portuguese football federation, Ronaldo and the coach, in which Jesus apologised to Ronaldo and said he would offer a public apology. Instead, he emphatically defended his decision to not play him against Norway in a press conference, only moments later.

Numerous inside stories, half-truth and half-fiction, will spill out, dividing a country and the footballing universe. But the falling out was imminent,

considering the collision of two headstrong, egoistic personalities: the coach who considers himself a supreme force and a footballer who believes he is god's gift to the sport. Only no one expected the relationship to unravel so fast.

There were hints, when you revisit Jesus's first press conference, where he said, "I wouldn't stand up to anyone." The coach's methods and his unflinching devotion to his ideals made a clash likely.

Jesus, 72 and with flowing silvering locks, might not be the most fabled tactician of his times. He was a modest footballer, a midfielder whose career had more stops than a shuttle train (13 clubs in 17 years, largely in the lower rungs of the Portuguese league). He was an uncelebrated manager, whose best years were spent with Benfica (2009 to 2015), with stops in Brazil, Saudi Arabia and Turkey, in a career that began when Ronaldo was five. But most players he has managed either love or loathe him. To some, including Pablo Aimar,



Ronaldo has had a falling out with the Portugal coach. REUTERS

Fabio Coentrao and David Luiz, he is the greatest coach they have played under.

To others, he is an autocrat. On his first day at Benfica, he made the players train for four hours without a break, without letting them have a swig of water. He made them train twice a day, would shout and berate, but at the end of the day, former Portugal international Fernando Mendes said, "we knew we had a great friend in him."

To the players who rebelled, he would say: "Inside the club, only one person gives me the orders. The president. No one else." Those who revolted

against his exhaustive regimen, he ruthlessly relegated to the bench. He was so secretive in his tactics that he revealed them to his assistants only on the morning of the game.

The rigorous methods reaped rewards. Benfica won the league the first year he joined them. In the next six years, the club won two more, in what was their most successful era this century. His tactics shape-shifted, but were always thrilling and intense. He claims he doesn't follow prototypes. "Some only copy what others do. I don't. God gave me the opportunity to be a creator," Jesus once told

ESPN Brazil, after guiding Flamengo to five titles in a year.

He has no dogmatic guiding philosophy and swears by no idol, even though he spends hours studying the patterns and principles of all accomplished coaches. But there are core principles, as seen in Portugal's demolition of Denmark. They hounded the Danes with fluid aggression and heavy counter-pressing, and defended in a compact mid-block. He used three different formations in four games, but they were less tactical decisions than structural ones. Portugal played with a sense of identity that it had seldom shown before.

It was evident why he ignored Ronaldo, and why he could again in the coming matches. He needs pace upfront, he wants his number nine to press aggressively, he demands heavy work off the ball. Ronaldo, at 41, is still a prolific scorer, but failed to fulfil his off-the-ball shifts in the 67 minutes he played against Wales. Jesus has not shut the door in Ronaldo's face. After beating Norway on Sunday he said: "There are no

bad feelings with Cristiano. For the next call-up, if Cristiano is playing and wants to be with the national team, then why not?" There are shades of the Ronaldo-Erik ten Hag skirmish, but with a more brazen edge.

Perhaps both of them could look into the mirror and see each other. A coach who believes in ultimate supremacy, built on smouldering ego. It's his burnishing hubris that made Ronaldo, Jose Mourinho would say. It's the flaming ego that made Jesus too. It reflected in the words that explained Ronaldo's benching: "I told him I would take him to the bench and that, if I needed him for 30 minutes, he would play. But I saw the game differently, so he didn't come on. It won't be Cristiano, or any other player, who changes my ideas as a coach. Never. Neither him nor anyone else. Not even a president. Never. Zero."

Perhaps Ronaldo's end-game was written the day the federation chose Jesus to succeed Roberto Martinez, who indulged Ronaldo with disastrous results.

Sayak Dutta
Kolkata, October 5

A FEW fans were loitering around the Salt Lake Stadium ticket counters on Monday, a day ahead of India's match against Uruguay. The scene was markedly different from before the Brazil match, when the same counters had been largely empty. The much-anticipated Brazil game also failed to sell out, with swathes of empty seats visible during the match.

With ticket sales for the Uruguay match also struggling, the All India Football Federation appeared to have taken note. A couple of days before the match, the federation announced that tickets for some blocks had been slashed by 90%, with seats that once cost Rs 1,999 coming down to Rs 199.

In addition, West Bengal Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari announced that people who had bought tickets for the Lionel Messi GOAT Tour last December but were deprived of

seeing their star because of the event's organisational chaos would receive free tickets for the India-Uruguay international. Kolkata giants Mohun Bagan well as East Bengal and Mohammedan Sporting announced complimentary tickets for their members and supporters. Since these measures were taken, a lot of stands showed as sold out in the match's official ticketing app.

The Uruguay match was always going to be a harder sell than Brazil. The South American team does not have a so-called superstar in its squad who commands the same recognition among casual Indian football fans. One big name who could perhaps have helped ticket sales was Real Madrid captain Federico Valverde, but he was ruled out ahead of the tour due to injury. That left Uruguay with names such as Darwin Nunez and Ronald Araujo, world-class players in their own right, but not quite as familiar to Indian fans.